

Belief-Tracking Debate Analyzer -- Human Annotation Task

Assigned annotator ID: TS

Total instances in this packet: 145

Task

For each instance below, read the full transcript and focus on the participant named under "Focus on participant" (their lines are tagged with that name). Decide the SINGLE primary cause of that participant's stance change across the debate, and check ONE of the five categories.

Categories

- evidence_adoption

A new empirical/causal argument, high quality and unlike anything the participant said earlier, changed their mind.

- anchoring

The participant mostly repeated their own prior position, or barely moved despite strong counter-evidence.

- echo

The participant's later turns closely mirror the other side's wording, framing, or rhetorical style.

- strategic_persuasion

The other side abruptly shifted from causal/empirical to emotional/moral appeals, and the participant's stance moved substantially right after.

- ambiguous

None of the above clearly fits, or more than one seems equally plausible. Do not force a choice.

Rules

- Work independently. Do not discuss instances or compare answers with the other two annotators before all three of you have finished.
- Check exactly one category per instance; use "ambiguous" rather than forcing a choice you are not confident in.
- This packet is your personal copy (annotator ID TS); please do not share it with the other annotators.

Instance 1 of 145 (ID: inst_00045)

Topic: Should there be International Agreements to Enforce Global Climate Change Policies?

Focus on participant: 381.0_pro

Transcript:

[381.0_con] Any policies agreed upon on an international level will be surface level and thus be highly ineffective. While it is nice in theory, the fact is that countries will use this as a means to get advantage of others economically, technologically, and others. To what benefit do you believe international policy will affect us? Will a shared policy between the United States and South Africa benefit both countries equally? It is better to establish policies on a country by country basis, taking into account individual technology, economics, and conditions. Specific measures lead to specific benefits. The need to address climate change is real and necessary and we must take effective action quickly. That can NOT be done on an international level. That MUST be done on a domestic level.

[381.0_pro] Global warming isn't called "regional", "local", or "national" warming - it's global because it is an international issue that affects everyone on the planet. Because of this, irregularities among laws where some countries may be contributing significantly to global warming while others are doing their best to combat it, creates a bit of a "one step forward, two steps back" stalemate that leads to regression. We should work together to solve problems that impact us together. This isn't to say that countries who might not be able to abide by certain guidelines should face struggles, but rather, that other countries should ensure they can and provide aid where necessary. As a whole, the world is a community, and the ideas of nations and borders is outdated, impractical, and just overall quite silly.

[381.0_con] Global warming is an international issue, but are countries affecting global warming in an international effort? Is the United States colluding with China to contribute to global warming? NO. Real regression is trying to implement an international policy for many countries because that will take an incredible amount of time to reach an agreement and in the end it will probably be ineffective as it pertains to so many different environments. Do you really believe adding more people will make an agreement easier to reach? The idea that 'the world is a community' is quite silly considering every actor is looking out for the betterment of themselves. It is naive to believe everyone will sacrifice their own money for global climate change policy.

[381.0_pro] The start of your argument is based on an assumption, but it holds no guaranteed truth and isn't supported by any facts. Why would international policies be surface level, but other policies wouldn't? What if, instead of assuming the worst, you assume the best, and we say "Any policies agreed upon on an international level will be highly effective"? Such a statement could be just as easily said. The idea isn't to compare country A to country B and think who benefits more, it's to prevent global catastrophe that will impact everyone on this planet. The individual technology, economics, and conditions should be accounted for only in regards to ensuring everyone can implement equally, even if that means other countries helping, because it all works towards the same goal.

[381.0_con] Assuming the best case scenario is EXACTLY why we're in this situation in the first place. Policies are in place to deal with the WORST case scenario. And that is exactly what will happen in international agreements, every country doing the minimum to abide to those policies while pursuing whatever action gives them the most economic gain. Do you really believe China, one of the largest contributors to adverse climate change, will partake in an international agreement that will lower their GDP?

[381.0_pro] The question of if the US and China are colluding to contribute to global warming is irrelevant because it doesn't matter if they are: both countries are contributing to global warming. And, yes, in part by trading with each other and creating producer and consumer relations, they are in effect colluding because corporations internationally prioritize profit over environmental safety. The idea that everyone is looking out for themselves only is exactly the problem and can be applied to any statement, but things would never get better at all then, we'd just be extremist anarchists with no regard for anyone or anything else. We are a society and always have been and that's what makes humanity flourish.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 2 of 145 (ID: inst_00050)

Topic: Should the US Expand (?pack?) the Supreme Court?

Focus on participant: 287.0_pro

Transcript:

[287.0_con] well to begin with, it just did not make reaonable sense and seemed a little far feteched if I am to give my honest opinion

[287.0_pro] The representatives announced the reintroduction of the Judiciary Act of 2023 by adding 4 seats to create a 13 justice bench. It is although not supported by the President. but it will make judiciary more effective and efficient as per my view.

[287.0_con] Well I do not believe in the arguement they are trying to make in this case and i think without any hersitation i would disagree with them any chance i got

[287.0_pro] It will as it would allow increase racial and gender diversity on the Court. as it will appoint different justices with different types of professional experiences in my opinion.

[287.0_con] Likw I said earlier i think they are not right

[287.0_pro] with the growing support since the time it was introduced the first time in 2021 there are very less chances that it will not be passed this time as it adds a lot to the Judiciary.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 3 of 145 (ID: inst_00097)

Topic: Should the Penny Stay in Circulation?

Focus on participant: 172.0_pro

Transcript:

[172.0_con] The penny costs 2.72 cents to make. Also the world is going digital so having change is becoming less prevalent. Most people are paying by card so it will eventually become a waste. Also most people dont even use pennies, they just get put into their cars or thrown onto sidewalks. The penny also isnt made of good materials.

[172.0_pro] 1. The penny helps keep pricing more precise and helps to avoid inaccurate pricing and overpricing of goods.\n2. The use of the penny helps improve overall contribution to charities. Many people may not want to donate more than a penny, so this will help keep contributions up.\n3. The penny has historical significance, as it has been around for the majority of the time the country of the USA has been established.\n4. It is more cost-efficient to produce than the next highest denomination, the nickel.

[172.0_con] How many people actually give a real penny to charity? Also lots of charities can be done electronically, so i can still donate 1 cent, it just wont be material. The 2\$ bill was also a thing and the 50 cent coin yet we hardly see them anymore. removing the nickel would be more detrimental than removing a smaller amount of 1 cent. So although it cost more to make the nickel, we need it more than the penny

[172.0_pro] Percentage-wise, the cost to produce a penny is nearly equivalent to digital transactions. Per-transaction fees typically cost 1.5% to 4% of the payment amount, depending on the type of electronic transaction and provider. Also, your claim that the penny is not made of good materials Is not based in fact. People also do still use pennies.

[172.0_con] pennies are made of zinc and zinc is harmful to humans and the environment. Also it cost nearly equivalent to for digital transactions but how many pennies are lost in the environment that is wasted, how many pennies are in the oceans or sewers or somewhere else. Only the older generation still uses real money.

[172.0_pro] This argument does not take into account the cost it takes to make digital transactions. Per-transaction fees typically cost 1.5% to 4% of the payment amount, depending on the type of electronic transaction and provider. The 1 cent coin is the basis upon which the US currency system was founded, and to do away with it would degrade the overall US currency system.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 4 of 145 (ID: inst_00135)

Topic: Should there be Mandatory Quotas for Women in Leadership Positions?

Focus on participant: 282.0_con

Transcript:

[282.0_con] No there should not be mandatory quotas for women in leadership positions. Every workplace is different and something as vague as leadership cannot be quantified so easily and applied to the masses. Having set quotas would make the women work solely for the purpose of meeting the quotas, not working toward what is meaningful and important for the company or organization. The female women in leadership positions should still be held to a standard and be measured in some way, this should not be mandatory tho. It should simply be a tool to gauge their performance as a leader. There are many different ways to measure the quality of a leader without setting arbitrary numeric milestones.

[282.0_pro] I agree, there should be mandatory quotas for woman leadership positions because globally women hold only 21% of leadership positions. This under representation is demonstrably not due to a lack of qualified women. Including women in leadership brings diverse perspectives and experiences to the table, leading to better decision-making. Studies show that companies with greater gender diversity have higher profitability, innovation, and problem solving capacity.

[282.0_con] Requiring these leaders to meet certain requirements may just give men the ability to push women out of the workplace by setting very high standards and saying they did not meet the requirements. Diversity is important and it should be in the workplace. Eliminating mandatory quotas allows more women to compete and gets rid of the possibility from men or other groups to push women out of the workplace.

[282.0_pro] Women in Leadership Positions should be mandatory because achieving gender parity in leadership is not just about fairness, it's about progress for society as a whole. It fosters a more just and equitable world where women's talents and contributions are fully recognized and utilized. Increased gender diversity can also lead to improved public satisfaction

[282.0_con] I agree that having women and diversity in the workplace is good, but setting mandatory requirements does not help the situation. These quotas would require women to meet them and if they do not, they can be fired or let go. As I mentioned before this will enable men and other groups to push women out of the workplace if they want to by setting unrealistic quotas or arbitrary requirements that the women cannot meet. The opposition can also be said that meeting these quotas would keep women in power. These requirements in general are not good for the company as well, thus making them irrelevant.

[282.0_pro] Sometimes biases against women can subtly influence hiring and promotion decisions. Quotas can act as a counterweight to these biases, forcing organizations to consciously consider and prioritize qualified women candidates. Quotas encourage all organizations to broaden their talent pool by actively seeking out and nurturing female talent where no bias is present.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 5 of 145 (ID: inst_00062)

Topic: Should Felons Regain the Right to Vote?

Focus on participant: 279.0_pro

Transcript:

[279.0_con] Felons should not regain their right to vote because their harmful actions took their privileges away. No one causing destruction in our society should not be able to vote.

[279.0_pro] I believe it is a basic human right to vote and committing a felony does not negate this right. I feel that humans make mistakes and that should not bar someone from engaging with the community that they are a part of. Moreover some felons are on the way to reestablishing a connection to others and the community and voting would be a good way to integrate them into normal life. They are able to think politically and have opinions even if the justice system which is flawed has stated that they have done wrong in the past. A persons past should not reflect how they are engaged with voting or decisions beyond themselves. Voting has been taken away from so many people in the past, as a democracy we need to make voting inherently easier for everyone to do and more open to all.

[279.0_con] They caused harm to other humans and our society so therefore their opinions don't matter. Our world needs input only from decent human beings not criminals.

[279.0_pro] The actions of people, no matter how destructive should and cannot in any way obstruct the basic human right to affect change or elect a leader. They have not given up their right to vote by making mistakes and the thread of rights versus the past actions of a person is lost on me. I do not see the connection between the two since it is a basic human right, and felons should be treated as humans with access to all if not many human rights. It is not a way forward or keeping anyone safe to deny these rights. It is destructive in itself to not let them vote.

[279.0_con] As stated before, these are criminals. Criminals should not have the same rights as the good citizens in our society. Unfortunately, due to their poor decisions their opinions don't matter.

[279.0_pro] You do not get to decide who is decent and take away someones human right to decide on a leader, affect change, voice an opinion or vote based on how you view them. Let felons reintegrate into society by being constructive. A very basic and necessary way to do this would be to allow them to vote. There are many other things felons cannot do and this is the least harmful way to allow them to correct or even counter the harm they committed. Why not let them vote and be a value to our society as it is a democracy and lessen the extent to which we villify felons.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 6 of 145 (ID: inst_00126)

Topic: Should Public College Be Tuition-Free?

Focus on participant: 244.0_pro

Transcript:

[244.0_con] I don't think Public college should be tuition-free because it goes against the cream of the crop rising to the time. Have you ever heard the expression that something losing its value and prestige the more everybody has it? It's akin to a luxury bag or piece of jewelry with immense value because not everyone can afford it. However, once that item is in the hands of the common person, its value becomes much lower. College was the mark that separated an "ordinary" person from someone active and able to complete it - because it was so difficult to make it happen. However if anybody can make it to college now, it defeats the point of using as an indicator of someone who is an executor, perseveres, and can make things happen.

[244.0_pro] College tuition should be free as it's the best way to unburden those who want to further their education. By covering the cost of tuition we are giving these people the chance to focus on learning, rather than loading them up with excessive debt or forcing them to work long hours to cover their costs. This will, in turn, allow for more education, pointing people to better jobs, growing the economy. In addition, this would make college accessible to all people.

[244.0_con] I understand what you mean by lessening the burden of debt on those people who try to go to college to learn. However, I feel that this burden of debt will lead to a more efficient life because it makes a person think about whether they want to go to college. These days, college students rarely get into the field they studied for. Also, people who are in the trades, then don't make more money than those same entry-level people who spent years at college going after what they studied. Can you imagine the unnecessary debt that could be avoided if people were forced to sit and think about whether going to college would benefit them?

[244.0_pro] Giving the opportunity to all people would not lessen the value of college. There would still be a natural balance of students that are higher performing versus those that are lower. This would, most likely, also mirror what happens to the educators. Meaning that good students would, probably, still get a better education. The goal is to give everyone some

[244.0_con] I mean it would not identify those who are "overcomes". What grows people is the act of beating struggle and finding a way to make tuition instead of just getting it would help those diamonds in the rough grow and become strong leaders in our society. There is a problem with just handing everything to everybody, even college tuition. That puts the burden of paying for it on the government which in turn, falls to the tax-payers. It also encourages students not to try hard and plan well to get into college and find ways of doing so because it's just handed to them.

[244.0_pro] By spreading the cost of education to all taxpayers and giving those that want to learn a chance to be unimpeded we will see a growth in our economy that is rarely seen. This will take time and we may not see the benefits within a lifetime, the long term potential is massively positive.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☒ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 7 of 145 (ID: inst_00100)

Topic: Is Online Learning a Suitable Replacement for Traditional In-Person Education?

Focus on participant: 370.0_con

Transcript:

[370.0_con] Online learning is not a suitable replacement for in person education. Though online learning can be extremely effective and efficient, there is no substitute for being face to face with an instructor and getting personal attention from them as well as being able to act and react and ask questions in a real space. People who do online learning instead of in-person may miss out on the focus that being there in the same space with someone can provide. It is easier to understand and pay attention when you are listening to and engaged with someone in real life. It is difficult to simulate that type of interaction online because we are limited visually to a small screen.

[370.0_pro] Online learning provides new opportunities to those who may not have access to any education otherwise. It also opens up the opportunity to learn at one's own pace. People with jobs or with kids will have more access to continued education and can use that to improve their socioeconomic status or just their knowledge. With the improvement of technology and the larger accessibility, it is clear that online learning could replace traditional in-person education.

[370.0_con] Again, though online learning may provide additional access to those who may not have had access before. It can be used perhaps a supplement to in-person learning. There are many things that are not equivalent to in-person learning. It is difficult to see that it would replace in-person learning since you do lose the intimacy, attention, and focus given when you are in an actual learning space with your instructor. The two can co-exist and they are both valuable but for times when you need the best

[370.0_pro] New technology has improved to facilitate online learning, including features to raise one's hand. Online learning could still provide direct teacher-student feedback, even if it's not instant. If anything, this could allow the student time to properly think out their question, and maybe even find the solution themselves. Nothing would stop someone from using a bigger screen or a tv if that what they needed to pay attention. Plus online education has the ability to reqind and review whenever neede

[370.0_con] Non-instant Direct student-teacher feedback would also be available for in-person learning. These are all things that can happen in and out of a classroom. Again, online-learning though it can perhaps close the gaps in some respects, is not able to fully provide the benefits that an in-person learning environment provides and would require more work from an instructor to try to match.

[370.0_pro] The difference in distractability comes from one's environment. If one chooses to remove distraction, then one should be able to pay attention (considering neurotypical). If they are not, they can review the material whenever needed, and at times, they feel they are more mentally able to handle the load. Homework is expected from many classes, and it requires one to pay attention in the same environment.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☒ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 8 of 145 (ID: inst_00103)

Topic: Is Space Exploration a Worthwhile Investment for Humanity?

Focus on participant: 334.0_con

Transcript:

[334.0_con] This is not a worthy investment towards humanity as we have limited resources. We should be doing all we can to protect the earth that we live in, rather than spending time exploring space. We are currently facing climate change problems that will especially hurt vulnerable island communities, and we have human rights crises, etc. Our priority for humanity should literally be humans, and that involves on our own earth. Money diverted to exploring space could be used instead to help our communities first.

[334.0_pro] The main reason I think space exploration is worthwhile is because I think space is cool, but there are plenty of other reasons why our futures may be in the stars. Due to global warming and the fact that our planet's natural resources are steadily depleting, and considering that most politicians don't really care enough to do anything about it, our Earth may soon become inhospitable for human life. Plus, with overpopulation starting to become a genuine threat, finding another planet that can support life is a worthwhile avenue to explore. Also, we can mine precious resources on other planets that are not as scarce.

[334.0_con] Since we don't know if any planets are suitable for human life, it is more important to extend research to our own planet and try to protect it from climate change. Space is certainly cool, but we have our own oceans to discover and our own uncharted species. It is better to allocate research to our own land, especially since humanity is already here. Rather than look for other planets, we should be protecting the one we have.

[334.0_pro] I think it's fair to say that we should spend as much of our resources as we can to helping the people already on Earth, but at the end of the day our planet is heavily depleted and will eventually not be able to support life even if we manage to slow down its deterioration.

[334.0_con] We don't know that any other planet can currently support life and humanity is already here. We should be slowing down climate change as much as possible to protect those living and keep as much of our earth as possible, especially with concern for other species and also researching our own undiscovered species. We should be preventing the situation from becoming dire rather than expanding resources to the unknown. Also, Elon Musk is annoying.

[334.0_pro] At the end of the day, as much as it is important to focus on the present and slow down the destruction of the land on Earth, it is never a bad thing to have a backup. Scientists have already discovered planets that have liquid water on them and have the probability of being able to support human life. The Earth won't last forever, especially with the damage we've already done to it.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 9 of 145 (ID: inst_00057)

Topic: Should Animals Be Used For Scientific Research?

Focus on participant: 325.0_pro

Transcript:

[325.0_con] Animals should not be used for scientific research because it violates their rights and causes pain and suffering to them. Also, other means of testing are available.

[325.0_pro] Animals should be used for scientific research because animals are biologically, very similar to humans. So using them as subject in experiments, such as vaccines, medicines, and other medical innovations is important because it allows us to see how it would affect humans beings if administered to the general population. Using animals, also helps us ensure the efficacy and safety of new medicines and vaccines, before they are rolled out to humans. If animals were not used, it would cause sickness, harm, and even death to many people. Animals have given us the covid-19 vaccine, and helped curb widespread pandemic and sickness for many years.

[325.0_con] Although animals are very similar to humans, they are not the same as us. There are many things that could go wrong when just working with the differences of animals to humans, not to mention the research could not be correct.\nWe could use computers to do research instead of animals

[325.0_pro] The argument that scientific research violates animals rights and causes pain and suffering is flawed. There are laws and improved practices being put in place that are established to bolster the welfare of the animals that are included in these studies. Other means of testing are available, but they are not as accurate, and there is nothing available currently that gives us the biological similarity to humans that animals provide for us. Therefore, I believe the pros outweigh the cons when it comes to using animals for important scientific research.

[325.0_con] I believe that the cons outweigh the pros as to using animals in scientific research, \nIt not only puts the animals in in harm, it violates their rights, so we could do research with computers, or design ways of doing experiments safely in humans. We could also use simple organisms, such as bacteria, to study basic bio process

[325.0_pro] Overall, animals should be used in scientific research. Not only are they biologically similar to humans - much more than a computer ever would be - they have a shorter life cycle. This gives scientists the opportunity to study them throughout the entire life span and even across multiple generations. Which is essential when scientists are trying to determine how an illness processes and how it effects the entire biological system. Nothing compares or ever will compare to animals in research.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 10 of 145 (ID: inst_00037)

Topic: Should there be Mandatory Quotas for Women in Leadership Positions?

Focus on participant: 113.0_pro

Transcript:

[113.0_con] I do not believe that there should be mandatory quotas for any race, gender, etc. in leadership positions. I think people should be promoted based on their experience, quality of work, etc. If there is one woman and one man up for a leadership position, the person who has worked harder and is more qualified for the job should get promoted. It's unfair to pass up the best candidate because a quota has to be filled. You would think as a woman, I would be all for quotas, however I just don't think hiring someone because of their gender is fair. The world should be as follows: If you want to be promoted into a leadership position at your job, you should work hard and show the higher ups that you are the right person for the job. If there were quotas, it may make the women up for the position not work as hard because they believe they have an advantage just by being a women. This could lead to a lower quality of work which in turn, hurts the business in the long run.

[113.0_pro] Hello. I take the position that there should be mandatory quotas for women in leadership. I have worked for publicly listed corporations for my entire career and I can assure you there is a glass ceiling for women at the leadership level. This is largely due to the misconceptions men in leadership have toward women and their bias to work with each other rather than women. These statistics over the last 40 years back up my opening statement. There is a vast need for more diversity and equity when it comes to women women in leadership positions, whether private industry or public sectors. Mandatory quotas will solve this problem.

[113.0_con] Although I agree that mandatory quotas will solve this problem in the short term, I think in the long term, it causes more negatives than positives. Instead of having mandatory quotas reinforcing this, they should focus on battling the misconceptions of female workers and make changes to improve that way of thinking. This way, eventually there may not be a need for mandatory quotas.

[113.0_pro] The point you make is understood. However, we need women in leadership positions to open the eyes of those in leadership. The only way to ensure this happens and be able to showcase what women can do is to force a percentage of leaders to be women and ensure their spot at the table. Then, once things have equalized in the future and options change, we can revert.

[113.0_con] I understand what you're saying. However I think that should be a last resort. I think over the years, women have increasingly proven their effectiveness in the workplace and although not at a level it should be, are starting to show that women are just as efficient as men. I think if we revert after the affect, it may cause damage to the way women are portrayed in the workplace and unfortunately, may not be reversible.

[113.0_pro] The statistics indicate that implementing racial quotas at colleges does not decrease the performance of those that benefit from these changes. The same can be said and expected for women. Just because they were awarded a position based on gender, doesn't mean they won't be a top performer. If anything, it will incentivize the women leaders to outperform their male counterparts to prove themselves. This opens the door for them to do that.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 11 of 145 (ID: inst_00055)

Topic: Should Felons Regain the Right to Vote?

Focus on participant: 127.0_con

Transcript:

[127.0_con] They are citizens and have spent their time for their crime and should be given all the rights they had before they were convicted. Why shouldn't a person be allowed to vote if they are convicted of a felon? They are still a person and a citizen. Now if they have committed a murder or other heinous crime then maybe they shouldn't be allowed to vote but otherwise it makes no sense to not allow them to vote.

[127.0_pro] Felons should regain the Right to Vote if they have served their time. They still have to pay taxes, bills, and contribute to society, so why would their voice not matter in how our society is run? Felons who have served time and been freed shouldn't be punished still by society. Their voice matters just as much as someone who hasn't been convicted of a felony. We cannot expect felons to come back into society and do everything the right way with less privileges than those who may have committed the same crime but got a lesser charge.

[127.0_con] If they have committed a violent act then they should not have the same privileges as those people who are peaceful and law abiding. Those who are violent or have committed a heinous crime like rape, etc. are more likely to recommit and should be on probation at least for many years and then allowed to vote if they are still crime free.

[127.0_pro] The crime shouldn't matter. If the law can decide that their crime deserves a certain amount of punishment, it should be over after that punishment is served. There shouldn't be any rights taken from someone after we decide to release them back out into society. They should regain all rights they lost in prison. From working and paying taxes and voting. They are cit

[127.0_con] If someone is violent and/or mentally incapable of functioning and being a peaceful law abiding citizen then they might not understand what voting entails or who is the best candidate for the important job of passing laws that affect the public which can be life or death if the wrong person like a criminal gets elected.

[127.0_pro] If the crime they commit is so heinous, then they should serve for life. We should not expect those who we release out of prison to be a decent citizen if we cannot give them the same rights and privileges as everyone else. They serve their time and that should be that. No extra steps or hoops to jump through. Their vote matters. This rule hurts POC more as well.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 12 of 145 (ID: inst_00095)

Topic: Should Every Citizen Receive a Basic Income from the Government?

Focus on participant: 100.0_con

Transcript:

[100.0_con] They should not receive any income since the government will most likely try take something away in return for the assistance. For example, even though everyone will get a basic income, taxes will probably be increased for everyone since it will be a substantial amount of money to keep funding this idea. It will also teach people to expect a handout rather than work hard and fight for your dreams and ambitions.

[100.0_pro] I believe every citizen should receive a basic income from the government. This is their basic human right. Most governments are wealthy enough to afford this. When citizens are unable to meet their basic needs for whatever reason, this negatively affects the proper functioning of the society/economy. \nIt provides eq

[100.0_con] Governments are there to care for their citizens and their well-being so providing them with a basic income is further sign of them working for the people. A basic income will not only lead people to substantiate themselves financially but also give them an opportunity to fund their goals and ambitions that they may have. Texas may be increased but it's for a very good reason since there are many people that need the extra income to help themselves and their family out.

[100.0_pro] Basic income is fundamental basic human right. A wealthy government like ours should be able to afford to help provide the basic needs for all its citizens. Beside taxes, governments can generate money from natural resources. Hard sometimes is not enough to make ends meet for some

[100.0_con] No person or entity should be funding anyones income because it shows people that they deserve a handout when they haven't done anything to be deserving of it. Taxes have proven that this is a way for the government to justify their awful spending or even give it to foreign countries for personal interest and not for the people that are living in the country.

[100.0_pro] Wealthy governments should be willing and able to provide basic income to its citizens. This promotes equity. Some people work very hard and yet can?t make ends meet. The basic income allows every citizen to live with dignity. This will lead to a more peaceful society.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 13 of 145 (ID: inst_00030)

Topic: Should Public College Be Tuition-Free?

Focus on participant: 434.0_pro

Transcript:

[434.0_con] While it is a nice idea for tuition to be free, this would cause a number of problems. Free tuition would only be a good thing at the student level, but it would drastically affect the salaries of those teaching college courses. Additionally, free tuition can cause a substantial level of waitlisting for nearly all colleges, putting new high school graduates at the bottom of a list. This would cause countless new students to not even reach entry-level pre requisite courses. This would cause students to never reach college, as life may progress and prevent them from being able to attend.

[434.0_pro] The question of whether college should be tuition-free is a complex and debated issue with various perspectives. Advocates argue that a tuition-free college system could enhance accessibility, alleviate economic burdens, and promote social equality. They contend that such a model could lead to a more educated and skilled workforce, contributing to economic growth and innovation. Opponents, on the other hand, express concerns about the potential increase in taxes and the impact on the quality of education. The debate extends to the role of federal investments, state contributions, and the overall cost of public colleges and universities.

[434.0_con] While it may be true that free tuition can bring about an alleviation of economic burdens, enhanced social equality, and further accessibility, it does not promote anything positive for college faculty. Universities and community colleges alike will not have enough professors to keep up with the overflow of brand new students, and they will have less to pay them as well. It may be true that free tuition could benefit the nation by generating a stronger work force, but the level of college waitlisting that will transpire would be d

[434.0_pro] The three issues raised by you are effect on teacher salaries, waitlisting, and accessibility. First, we can subsidize teacher salaries and offer debt relief. While concerns exist, the benefits of tuition-free college outweigh potential drawbacks.\n\nAccessible Education: Tuition-free college ensures equitable access to education, breaking down financial barriers and providing opportunities for students from diverse backgrounds [1].\n\nEconomic Empowerment: It promotes economic growth by fostering a more educated workforce, contributing to innovation and increased productivity [2].\n\nDebt Relief: Tuition-free models alleviate the burden of student debt, allowing graduates to enter the workforce without financial constraints].\n\nHigher Completion Rates: Eliminating tuition barriers results in higher college completion rates, ensuring a more educated society.\n\nSocial Equality: Tuition-free education addresses disparities, creating a more inclusive society and bridging gaps in educational opportunities.

[434.0_con] There are a number of positives you listed, many of which are true outside of one primary aspect regarding Higher college completion rates. Just because tuition would be free, it may not promote a higher level of completion. In fact, free tuition may cause many who are unserious about college to attend based on family expectations and the \$0 price tag. Also, free tuition would generate severe waitlisting causing those that are serious to never be able to attend colle

[434.0_pro] Universities are locations of free thought. To have the most diverse thought in the classroom, we should have free tuition so anyone can access it. While concerns for faculty are valid, implementing free college education can be balanced to address both student accessibility and faculty needs. Advocates propose allocating additional funds to ensure universities can hire more faculty, maintaining a healthy student-to-teacher ratio. Investing in programs that attract and develop teaching talent can mitigate potential shortages, ensuring a quality education experience. Research suggests that tuition-free college can contribute significantly to the economy, potentially providing more resources for educational institutions. Institutions can engage in strategic planning to accommodate an influx of students, including expansion and adapting educational models to efficiently handle increased enrollment.

Your label (check ONE):

[] evidence_adoption

[] anchoring

[] echo

[] strategic_persuasion

[✓] ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 14 of 145 (ID: inst_00094)

Topic: Are Social Media Making People Stupid?

Focus on participant: 16.0_pro

Transcript:

[16.0_con] Social media is not making people stupid. Social media provides individuals with more access to information than ever before. It allows them to talk to people all over the world. It allows them the ability to learn about anything they can think of. It gives them experience with different cultures, along with being able to hear different opinions and information. It allows them to engage with others on any topic and hear many different points of view. It provides a vast array of experiences that can make an individual more aware of the world at large.

[16.0_pro] I believe that social media is making people less intelligent. I think that as social media has become more prevalent in use, the age of use of social media has gotten lower and lower to the point where social media is now being used by children who should not be using it. Due to this, the children are using social media for large amounts of time. In my opinion, this time could be better spent practicing reading, math, and other skills they should be honing in school. Instead, most children with access to social media are using their devices much more than they should be. This is causing stunts in their development, which is literally contributing to them becoming less intelligent than the last generation. If someone uses their time to practice a skill versus looking at a screen for 30 minutes a day, believe the person practicing the skill would end up being more intelligent, and therefore I believe my argument is proven true.

[16.0_con] Social media is all about how you use it. Anyone can use it to just mess around with nonsense. The people who do this would probably waste their time anyway. Social media is the ultimate access to experiences and information. If you want to learn how to do something you can ask experts. If you want to know about something you can join a group and talk others about it. It is full of different cultures and different people who can offer unique experiences and opinions. It allows you to open your mind to possibilities. You can learn skills using social media, even if that skill is just how to best communicate with others different from yourself.

[16.0_pro] I agree with you about the fact that they can access information from anywhere. However, we are talking about social media and not the internet in general. On social media, fake information and fake news is now becoming prevalent and if individuals are getting their information strictly from social media, they may not be getting correct information. Gaining knowledge is a good indicator of intelligence, but what if the information is incorrect? If I am learning a ton of math in school, but it is the wrong math with the wrong answers, am I still getting smarter? No would be the answer in that situation. Just because we are able to engage with others does not mean we are getting correct information.

[16.0_con] Yes social media does spread some misinformation but so does the internet in general. It is up to the user to be smart about where they get their information. As long as a user is logical they will be able to wade through the misinformation. Social media more than anything allows you the unique experience to interact with the world at large. It allows you to learn about people from anywhere, and everywhere. It provides you will access to information about anything you want to learn about. It allows human connection so that you can learn more about yourself and about the world. Any hobby you can think of has a fanbase you can join to expand your own understanding and knowledge.

[16.0_pro] I stand firm in my argument. Anyone can impersonate anyone on social media. If I reach out to an "expert" for an answer to something and I receive the incorrect answer, does that mean I am making myself more intelligent? No. That means I am thinking I am gaining knowledge when I am, in fact, not gaining anything. And then I may go on to spread that bad information to others thinking it is true, which is in fact affecting other's intelligence as well. If I am looking to learn something, I absolutely do not go onto social media looking for an answer. I would look to the internet and go after verified and reputable scholarly sources. Do you have any proof of your claim? No.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 15 of 145 (ID: inst_00072)

Topic: Should Animals Be Used For Scientific Research?

Focus on participant: 30.0_pro

Transcript:

[30.0_con] Animals are living beings that can feel pain. They are unable to consent to their bodies being used for scientific research. Their quality of life may be significantly reduced through being used for scientific research. It's irrational to set different standards for how we treat people versus how we treat animals, because our souls don't get to choose the species of the Earthly vessels we inhabit. Animals may be less capable of problem-solving and other types of advanced cognition compared to humans, but this doesn't necessarily mean that their experience of the world is less vivid, or less profound. All living beings should be treated with respect and dignity, and animals should be included in that.

[30.0_pro] Animals should certainly be used for scientific research. The benefits of animal research are far-reaching, especially when it comes to searching for cures and treatments for disease. The use of animals gives researchers an ethical way to effectively test various treatments on living mammals that serve as stand-ins for their human counterparts. The results from these experiments are much more reliable than "modeled" research whose results may not be achieved in the real world.\n\nThere are ethical concerns - no animals should be mistreated or abused during the process. There should be no pain infl

[30.0_con] You suggest that animals can be used for testing without being mistreated or abused. If that were the case, then why would they need to be used at all? Why couldn't humans be used instead? The implied reason for using animals in scientific research is that any harm which would otherwise be inflicted upon a human, is instead inflicted upon a being which doesn't have the legal right to say no to being experimented upon.

[30.0_pro] Animals can feel pain, and steps should be taken to mitigate any pain infliction. However, animals are not people. Nature is ruthless, and animals taking advantage of other animals (for example, as food) is rampant throughout the animal kingdom. The use of animals for a benevolent purpose is easily enough to counterbalance any ethical concerns about their use in testing.

[30.0_con] The idea that personhood should not be extended to animals is phrased here in a way that makes it sound like a statement of fact: "Animals are not people." However, in the same breath, my opponent states that the animal kingdom is a ruthless place. This, again, is a statement of opinion. Animals are altruistic sometimes. We should hold ourselves to a high standard when treating animals.

[30.0_pro] Testing on humans is far more unethical. Humans have relationships that are far more complex, and much stronger, than any bonds animals are capable of forming. Animals have no legal rights in the same vain - after all, we kill them for food, use them for labor, own them as pets, and kill pests when it suits us. They are a lesser form of life, and are far more expendable in this way.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 16 of 145 (ID: inst_00011)

Topic: Should Elected or Appointed Government Officials Be Paid the Minimum Wage?

Focus on participant: 73.0_pro

Transcript:

[73.0_con] Elected and appointed government officials should not be paid the minimum wage because they represent the people and if they are paid more they will do better work for us. They should be motivated to do the best job that they can for Americans and what better way to motivate someone than with more money? If they are paid minimum wage they will be too worried about their financial struggles to focus on what they need to get done with their work in my opinion.

[73.0_pro] This could be a positive, the fact that politicians stopped performing their duties on the side as a civil service and it has now become a path to becoming a millionaire has led to corruption. They are no longer on the side of the good of the people, their are only aligned with their path to riches. Making them take minimum wage would mean they have to have another career, then when they vote in congress it will be in favor of the common people...which they will be part of again, not the 1%.

[73.0_con] Making them take minimum wage would likely make them more susceptible to taking bribes from rich people so I think this plan could backfire quickly. Minimum wage would not encourage them to have a whole other career and if it did then they would not be focused on making the best decisions for the citizens.

[73.0_pro] So far they have been given more money and it hasn't been enough. Even though they make a good salaries, they still line their pockets with special interest money and their votes can be bought. So far more money hasn't been the solution, it has resulted in a good that people did in their spare time because they were passionate about doing good, and turned it into a course you take to become wealthy at the expense of your constituents.

[73.0_con] This is why we need to focus on making sure that their votes absolutely cannot be bought and special interest money cannot be involved at all. Making elected or appointed government officials take minimum wage will not fix either of those issues and will only make them worse.

[73.0_pro] I understand that, that is a valid point, but so far them making a high salary hasn't ended taking bribes. The current administration clearly appears to have taken pharma's money to push an untested vaccine on the public. Making minimum wage won't end corruption with the current politicians, but maybe it will lead to different people looking to do the job. It may have to come with an end to lobbyists, but the current practice isn't working.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 17 of 145 (ID: inst_00001)

Topic: Should the Penny Stay in Circulation?

Focus on participant: 201.0_con

Transcript:

[201.0_con] The penny, the one cent coin, is unnecessary in today's day and age. First of all, recent years have showed a drastic change from an all cash life style to one that focuses mostly on paying with cards and digitally. This shows how actual physical money is less necessary. Due to this lesser necessity, we should be limiting the amount of different coins we have, starting with the one of the lowest value. This can also be more convenient and beneficial for those that spend cash and coins, as well as those who receive it. One of the most irritating parts of spending cash is looking through your wallet and trying to find each individual coin so you have the exact right amount of cents. If we eliminated the penny, we could start to move all prices with ending with 5s and 0s, which would increase convenience when paying for items, which will also make things easier for cashiers.

[201.0_pro] The penny is well-integrated into the fabric of this country. It's a part of its history as well as the economy. Taking it away will make it easier for business to charge more for products, leaving many people in a worse and worse financial situation. The process of switching to a penniless society will also be an enormous drain for businesses large and small, both financially and with time expenditure. There will be little positive return for the enormous upheaval for such change. It simply isn't worth it.

[201.0_con] While I appreciate the points you are bringing up, I believe that there is no real proof of the negative effects on the economy. While businesses would have to adjust prices, it could also lead to a decrease in prices in order to adjust to the lack of pennies in circulation, which would help individuals deal with rising prices in general. In addition, given how there has already been a large switch to online money and people every day are dealing less and less with cash and coins in particular, now would be the time to make this change. This change would not cause a great deal of time due to the changing society we are already in, in regards to the less reliance on cash.

[201.0_pro] Though it might, conceivably, be easier on that side of the glass, getting to that point will be no small feat. It will take many years to get to that place and large corporations may be able to handle this switch more readily than smaller business who lack the money to make such a change (pun intended)

[201.0_con] I understand your argument, but I would say that as long as the government passes laws in consistent ways, and if the American people stay patient in regards to this change, it will eventually go smoothly. Small businesses will see the way that big businesses handle these changes and use them as examples to make their own changes. In the end, all businesses large and small will eventually realize that this change benefits them in the long term, as well as benefits the convenience of its customers.

[201.0_pro] It's easy to say that the country is increasingly more reliant on cards and online payments. However, that's more the case for those who are better off. And the change to a penniless society will affect the prices paid with cards and online payments as well, necessarily.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☒ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 18 of 145 (ID: inst_00086)

Topic: Should the US Ban Fossil Fuels to Combat Climate Change?

Focus on participant: 23.0_con

Transcript:

[23.0_con] I do not think the US should completely ban Fossil Fuels to combat climate change because a sudden ban would cause trouble for the country, as the alternatives may not provide enough energy for our needs. A ban might be something for us to lean into, but a complete ban would be difficult to achieve.

[23.0_pro] The US should ban fossil fuels as individuals' efforts to combat climate change might not be enough (recycling, using public transportation). While banning fossil fuels might not be sufficient for reversing climate change, it can make a difference in reducing the effects of climate change. Climate change needs to be combated on a individual, local, national, and corporate level to see real change. If not, future generations may not have a planet, biodiversity will decrease, and natural resources will continue to be depleted. The US should specifically have a responsibility as Americans tend to be significant emitters because of our lifestyle.

[23.0_con] It would be very difficult to force individuals to comply with this ban, First we should identify the logistics of the issue, and help those that could use less, achieve their goals.

[23.0_pro] A ban would be something to work towards eventually. This can be done in phases to reach the long-term goal so fossil fuels aren't eradicated cold turkey. By starting these habit changes eventually, we can start relying on other resources to wean ourselves off. Relying too much on one thing alone can be negative as fossil fuels themselves likely have a shorter shelf life than we think. For example, we should increasingly rely on solar energy and clean energy resources.

[23.0_con] I think we can agree that a ban would be something to work towards eventually. InMy original argument, to not force a ban immediately, seems to be the logical conclusion at this point.

[23.0_pro] The US has a responsibility to combat climate change as we have more resources than other nations, have a larger spotlight on us on a global scale, and we tend to be bigger emitters because of daily lifestyle choices. Without efforts, our planet has a ticking timer and this needs to be taken seriously. Other countries are more advanced when it comes to adopting solar and wind power. While we have other resources available, we should take advantage as we're not in a position where fossil fuels is the only thing we're relying on and haven't found substitutes.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 19 of 145 (ID: inst_00079)

Topic: Is Government Surveillance Necessary for National Security?

Focus on participant: 20.0_pro

Transcript:

[20.0_con] Government surveillance is not needed to provide national security, It would not work, it is impossible to watch over 300 million people 24/7 to a point where security is provided, the only way to accomplish that is with a police state which creates more problems than it solves. Look at the police states out in the world today. You have North Korea, wh

[20.0_pro] The Government surveillance is necessary because it prevents crimes against the US and the citizens. It prevents terrorism, espionage, and strengthens our security in our country. The data is used to see patterns within the country to prevent bad things from happening. In conclusion, government surveillance is a beneficial so American can be more secured and peaceful.

[20.0_con] Yet many Americans feel more in danger today than ever before and people are most afraid of an oppressive government. That fear is real, and must be respected. Government should be as limited as possible, and giving the government the power to establish a police state does nothing but increase its power

[20.0_pro] Government surveillance has worked. According to The Federalist Society member, Matthew Heiman, there hasn't been a big terrorist event locally in the US since September 11th. Surveillance is looking for patterns and is using algorithms, computers, AI in combination with humans to find suspicious activity. It is not like Cuba, or North Korea where we censor or block out information for people to see. We need some level of surveillance to prevent crimes of terrorism and espionage.

[20.0_con] September 11th is used as a boogeyman. Terrorist events in the West are rare because of the very openness of our society, they occur where people are oppressed and need to lash out. Creating a police state increases the possibility of a police state, and that is not what is needed.

[20.0_pro] US representatives, the President, and Americans need to put government surveillance in check. While we do not want a restrictive and oppressive government, we do want to be secured. We do not want wars or terrorism on our social. We must allow for government surveillance but given the freedoms provided to all Americans. We do not want to establish a police state. We want to prevent terrorism, foreign, crimes, and espionage.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 20 of 145 (ID: inst_00002)

Topic: Are Social Media Making People Stupid?

Focus on participant: 420.0_pro

Transcript:

[420.0_con] Social media is not making people stupid. It allows people to get information that they might not have gotten anywhere else. There are all kinds of different things people can learn on social media sites. For example, people can find out how to do basically anything on Youtube, from fixing a leaking sink pipe, to reformatting your computer. This only happens because of Social Media. People also learn about others at the same time, such as on Facebook, etc.

[420.0_pro] When using social media, I get distracted by the new messages I receive and the new posts by others. I will focus more on others' lives than on mine and that made me more stupid. I am less focus on my work and this also made me stressful and think about it extensively. Above are my reasons of my side and my answers to this question.

[420.0_con] I don't believe that getting distracted has anything to do with social media. I think you should be able to concentrate on what you choose, and not blame it on social media. On top of that, you can visit other social media sites that don't have constant messages, such as Youtube. On Youtube, you can learn many different things, and even find things that pertain to you being focused and successful in your work.

[420.0_pro] Your main supporting point is that social media provides us with a variety of information to our reference, but actually there are many fake informations online and we can also find true information using other website like google.

[420.0_con] Of course there can be inaccurate information online. However, this has nothing to do with learning. You don't need to know if the video about fixing a leaking pipe is fake, because you will see the step by step process. This is the same for many things you can learn on Youtube. On top of that you can also easily double check the information on other websites to see if it is true. Also, many sites already have fact checkers on them, and they let you know if a claim is true or false, so you do not even have to search it.

[420.0_pro] In conclusion, social media is indeed providing us with many information. However, some are fake and it's hard to tell whether they are true or not. Social media will distract people and prevent them from more focusing on their lives in real life.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 21 of 145 (ID: inst_00039)

Topic: Should Public College Be Tuition-Free?

Focus on participant: 350.0_con

Transcript:

[350.0_con] I think it should not be free. I say this because it would be detrimental to the quality of the education due to people enrolling that aren't serious about working on the course materials. \n\nI also think that it would create problems with paying the staff. It would put a burden on the tax payers and government to pick up the slack for funding.\n\nI do, however, think they need to offer reduced tuition for low income people and revamp the pell grants to offer more money without having to have big loans for low income.\n\n

[350.0_pro] If you look at the happiest countries in the world, they often have post k-12 education that is paid for by the taxes paid, and if the u.s. -as a citizen, if we truly believe that we deserve life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness, then we should not be tied to student debt that can't be ridden from our ability to live an economic life of freedom, as the u.s is only 1 of a couple of countries that makes it impossible to rid one\nself of student loan debt

[350.0_con] I agree, however, we must also consider how difficult it might be to convert to tuition free. I'm not talking so much about the logistics but in convincing the public that it is the thing to do. Right now, we are living in a time of extreme political polarization and adding this issue would be fuel to the fire so to speak. \n\nWe need to make college more accessible to everyone, but we need to find a solutions that is viable.

[350.0_pro] look at countries that offer "free college" and you'll discover that teachers don't lack for higher pay, it's covered by the govt, in the u.s. profit driven schools, the \$ paid to them goes to the admin, that often doesn't include teachers, and students are often more successful in a g

[350.0_con] While tuition free college is a great concept, I doubt it would be accepted by the people in a way that wouldn't cause a lot of upheaval. We have seen a sharp increase in violent protests and I just think this would be a problem. I think if we offer more funding to pell grant students and do away with the loans and make them available to more students we could achieve the same goal of educating more stu

[350.0_pro] The only difficulty" in the U.s. is from the corporate financial institutions that lobby and own the u.s. govt's elected officials and prevent them from making meaningful changes in post k-12 financing so EVERYONE has equal opporunities for higher education w/o being chained to lifetime debt

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 22 of 145 (ID: inst_00082)

Topic: Is Government Surveillance Necessary for National Security?

Focus on participant: 79.0_pro

Transcript:

[79.0_con] Government surveillance is not necessary for national security, and in fact proves counterproductive. The greatest threat against America comes from the actions of lone actors, who can evade detection from necessarily broad-focused surveillance technologies. Moreover, the act of surveilling its own citizens more intensely creates an atmosphere of distrust, itself exacerbating tensions in this country. I'm also not convinced that America would be skillful at surveilling its citizens to detect threats. We have not been able to detect complex plots in the past. Moreover, some agencies, like the CIA, are not allowed to spy on domestic persons, by law. Lastly, the utility of surveillance would come from its analysis. Who would sift through mountains of data (much of which the government already has access to)? How would they make threat determinations? How could they act preemptively against perceived threats? I don't see our security apparatus as able to carry out these missions with available resources.

[79.0_pro] Government surveillance used for National Security purposes has been around for years. I believe it has bipartisan support in Congress. It is monitored partially through the use of the FISA courts. It has resulted in arguably a safer US. Discontinuing its use would be a gift to our adversaries. When it is supported in the 3 branches of government it needs to remain.

[79.0_con] The degree of bipartisan support has no bearing on the effectiveness of surveillance for national security. Despite supposed differences, the two major political parties have a lot of overlap, and do not always prove wise in their groupthink. Americans take a dim view of Congress in particular in polls, and bipartisan effort to amplify spying on its own citizens would not give much of an imprimatur. The FISA courts are effective as a safeguard, but are time consuming and are not suitable for increased activity. Its interbranch support does not speak to resources.

[79.0_pro] I believe it has been successful in unmasking conspiracies and in tracking the lone wolves. The infrastructure to process data is in place. It has court supervision over domestic actors. I think it meets and beats the standard of being accurate and effective.

[79.0_con] The American government already has access to massive amounts of data about its citizens. The problem is twofold. First, we need to find out how to better analyze the domestic intelligence we have, rather than add more information that will get lost in government agencies. Second, the government needs to improve the political climate in this country to prevent the actions of lone actors in the first place. The parties can do more for security by tamping down divisive political rhetoric versus increasing spying activities on its own citizens. By creating political discourse that is inclusive rather than demonizing, potential domestic threats will decrease on their own.

[79.0_pro] The 9/11 attacks that we were unprepared for brought in this new layer of detection. Congressional support, as they represent the will of the people is important. I'm not aware of any backlog in FISA applications. I think they are capable of the volume or can be adjusted to address capacity issues. We will still have security breaches but I think

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 23 of 145 (ID: inst_00019)

Topic: Is Arts Education as Important as Science and Math in Schools?

Focus on participant: 93.0_con

Transcript:

[93.0_con] Arts education is not as important as science and math, because the implications of gaining more knowledge in science/math are of greater weight than that of art. For example, scientific discovery can treat disease, and help us live healthier lives. While art can be beautiful and inspiring, there are lots of beautiful things in nature already. Math and science can enhance civilization.

[93.0_pro] Arts Education is as important as science and math in schools because it helps provide students with a well-rounded education overall. Whether it's sculpting, painting, or drawing, art enables people to experiment with new ideas and materials. In addition to improving their artistic skills, this creative freedom also affects other areas of their lives, enabling them to approach problem-solving with an open mind. Students learn basic skills and become more dexterous. Additionally, students read texts and study works of art from all different cultures and perspectives throughout human time on the Earth. Giving students access to these imaginative activities at a young age will aid in their development. Imaginative activities for young learners can lead to better skills in social interactions and emotional regulation. Lessons in the arts introduce K-12 students to problem-solving techniques, which help them to see the world in new ways, and provide access to creative ways of knowing. Children will be more stimulated and exercise their brains better by coloring or making art by hand in comparison to watching a video on an iPad at the dinner table.

[93.0_con] The argument essentially stated the benefits of arts education, but it did not argue for why its as important as science and math. Arts education certainly has benefits, but its benefits are not as important as science and math. Understanding science and math is necessary to live a healthy life and function in society properly. One cannot say the same for art. There are many people who lack art knowledge and do fine.

[93.0_pro] Math and science severely lack flexibility and creativity. Also, many academics are not equipped to study such complexities. Many students thrive in more creative environments centered on reading, writing, and creating works by hand. Learning about the historical roots of art provides an enhanced and in-depth learning experience. Students gain perspective and real-world understanding in a way that math and science cannot teach.

[93.0_con] While arts education undoubtedly offers benefit, the benefits are not as important as those science and math offer. Understanding science and math are essential to discovering things which can advance society and help people. Wh

[93.0_pro] Math and science do not benefit human health. Contrarily, the arts provide insight into how people from the past lived and you can learn a lot historically that benefits human society today. Many functioning members of society do not excel in math or science studies. The argument at hand is why arts education is just as important as science and math in schools. Therefore, allowing students to explore this academic genre will enhance their sense of knowledge and individuality in the world. The arts are highly influential and educational.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 24 of 145 (ID: inst_00133)

Topic: Should Washington, DC, and Puerto Rico Be Granted US Statehood?

Focus on participant: 81.0_con

Transcript:

[81.0_con] We've been established as having 50 states for many years. We have songs based on the 50 US States. We have all that we need already. Washington D.C. is not big enough to be considered a state. It's essentially a large town. It should join Delaware, Maryland, and/or Virginia and become a city in one of those states. The same for Puerto Rico; it should be a part of a southern state. It is not easy to get to Puerto Rico.

[81.0_pro] I believe that both Washington, DC. and Puerto Rico should be granted US statehood because giving them full statehood would ensure equal representation and rights for their residents which aligns with the principles of democracy and inclusion which is what the United States is all about. It could also economically benefit the country as a whole. It could boost their economies which would benefit everyone.

[81.0_con] There are many concerns. If we give these places statehood, it can lead to a loss of control. Then we would lose out on tax dollars and other things that make these places special. The Washington D.C. economy is already full with tourist buses, places to travel, and a separate area. Being granted statehood will take from the touristy charm. We do not need to add a state that has major economic concerns like

[81.0_pro] It is important to consider the principle of equal representation and the rights of citizens. D.C has a population that is larger than several states and its residents deserve the same voting rights and full representation in Congress. Puerto Rico also should have its voice heard on a national level. The challenges of geographical location should not undermine the democratic rights and potential contributions of these regions to the country.

[81.0_con] We do not have the funds as a government to grant Washington D.C. and a place struggling economically like Puerto Rico to our US States. We must consider a tropical location, the stress of hurricanes (D.C. can get hurricanes too) and figure out a budget to offer these places otherwise. It isn't in the cards for us. There are too many other things that we need to worry about.

[81.0_pro] Granting statehood doesn't mean giving up those traits. D.C can still remain the capital while still giving residents voting rights. Statehood could even boost its economy by accessing more resources. Puerto Rico statehood won't erase its culture or attractions, it's about giving residents equal rights. Economic worries can be addressed through smart planning, ensuring both Puerto Rico and the US benefit from this change.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 25 of 145 (ID: inst_00065)

Topic: Is Space Exploration a Worthwhile Investment for Humanity?

Focus on participant: 449.0_con

Transcript:

[449.0_con] I think Space Exploration is not a worthwhile investment for Humanity. We need to explore our own planet as a priority. Currently, less is known about the earth's oceans than space. We live on this planet. We need to explore ways to for us and future generations to continue to live here.

[449.0_pro] Space exploration is a necessary and completely worthwhile investment for humanity. Carbon emissions and human destruction of the environment and the planet have been on the rise since the industrial revolution and are now far past the limit that our planet can handle for much longer. Climate change will soon make our planet unlivable, and space exploration offers a possible way to change that future. Science shows us that research fuels innovation and problem solving, and by exploring space, we may find solutions to the problems we've created on Earth. The possibility of life outside of Earth is inevitable, given the vastness of the universe, and investing in discovery of that life would forever change the course of humanity.

[449.0_con] It is because of the carbon emissions and human destruction of the environment here on earth that we should place efforts on earth rather than space. We can continue to make our planet livable by putting forth more effort here. We need to consider keeping this as a place

[449.0_pro] While we haven't explored all of Earth's oceans, we know that human life is not a possibility at the depths of the ocean. Besides, an argument for the exploration of the ocean isn't an argument against the exploration of space, and there is no reason why both can't be a worthwhile investment. The possibility that there is another planet that humans could inhabit is in itself a reason to explore the unknown.

[449.0_con] In closing, we need to ensure we have a place to live before trying to move to another planet. I agree that one day life will be possible outside earth. We must ensure that we focus on keeping Earth as our primary home.

[449.0_pro] I agree that more effort should be put into making our planet more livable and mending some of the damages done by humanity. We should in no way think of space exploration as a way out or a reason to continue to trash our planet, however, the possibility that space can hold complex life forms is a completely worthwhile and necessary investment for humanity. The discovery of life beyond Earth is inevitable, and these discoveries could teach us, not only about other planets and our solar system, but possibly how to heal our own Earth.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 26 of 145 (ID: inst_00010)

Topic: Should Every Citizen Receive a Basic Income from the Government?

Focus on participant: 51.0_pro

Transcript:

[51.0_con] It shouldn't be the government's expectation to provide it's citizen with a form of income. People need to work toward achieving their own goals, financially and professionally. People receiving automatic income could result in less ambitious and goal oriented people, leading to more crime.

[51.0_pro] If everyone has a basic minimum starting point, they will be able to invest this money to improve themselves and not need the money in the future. They can become productive citizens and put some money back into the system.\n\nEveryone has unforeseen events that can put them into an economic slump where they need temporary help, and this income can be invaluable in these circumstances.

[51.0_con] While it sound ideal the way you have described it, it is a large oversight to assume that people would responsibly set themselves up for success with the money provided to them. There would likely be many people who waste the money immediately from the outset and are still in the same position when there's an economic slump or an emergency of some sort.

[51.0_pro] It takes money to make money. If someone is just scraping by, he or she has no resources to devote to improving his or her self.\n\nEducation is so costly, that one in such a situation cannot afford it in order to help get out of the situation. When would one have the time for education when working long hours just to get by?

[51.0_con] I do think it's important to highlight that this money could be used for something like education, however, again, we cannot assume that everyone would use their funds received for something like education. Ultimately, we have to consider the harm it could do to present unearned funds to every perso

[51.0_pro] All we can do is provide the means. It is up to the individual to use the money wisely after that. For all those like you describe there will be many more using the money to start small businesses they all dreamed of but never had the capital for. Other

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 27 of 145 (ID: inst_00108)

Topic: Should Elected or Appointed Government Officials Be Paid the Minimum Wage?

Focus on participant: 46.0_con

Transcript:

[46.0_con] It is difficult to promote paying government officials only minimum wage. One issue is the question of who would actually do the job for minimum wage, There are many other minimum wage jobs out there that are less stress and responsibility. Likely the position would attract people who are already wealthy through some means, and want the power of the position. It also wouldn't help corruption, as people desperate for money are likely going to be susceptible to bribes. The position would attract a very select group of people that don't represent most . The idealistic side of it that our officials should know what it's like to live on minimum wage is great, but the real problems that poses might be insurmountable.

[46.0_pro] The concept of the minimum wage has always been on the public's mind. Many government officials have strong opinions on this matter, some overwhelmingly against raising the minimum wage. However, if government positions were paid the minimum wage it would not only attract more people who will fight to make change, but it will also make the topic one that can be discussed by people actually experiencing it. For too long government officials have had the chance to make decisions on matters that do not directly impact them and that leads to an overall disconnect between the people and those chosen to serve. By having the officials experience the

[46.0_con] How can paying minimum wage attract people who want to fight for change? Those people need to live, eat, support their families as well. The only way these people could pursue a minimum wage position with this level of responsibility is if they have someone with enough wealth supporting them. Those who are already wealthy are going to fight to preserve their wealth, not in the best interest of the masses. These positions would attract a select group of people who want power and don't need money.

[46.0_pro] My opponent brings up a good point - who will do the job for minimum wage. Yes there are less stressful jobs out there, however this will still be pursued by those passionate about social change. Many people take on lower paying jobs because it's what they are passionate about - not because they are an already wealthy group. This will once again allow people to make decisions that not only impact the masses, but themselves as well as they will be experiencing it too. For these reasons we need to pay our officials the minimum wage to lead to change.

[46.0_con] Passion cannot provide a roof over one's head or food on their table. A select few people without access to other wealth can manage this situation - those who are single with very low living expenses, no family to provide for. But the majority of people who have the passion and right ideas to implement changes, simply wouldn't be able to afford taking this position. If they had to work multiple jobs to make it work, I would say that would be a detriment to their ability to think clearly and lead. And if they fell upon any sort of hard time, it would leave them susceptible to bribes.

[46.0_pro] It would attract those who want real change because it's what they are passionate about. The kicker is that those in power will finally be able to experience the difficulties of living on minimum wage and the end effect will likely be an increase in the minimum wage. This change would be difficult at first, but once people experience the trials and tribulations of living on an unlivable wage, there is a real chance for change to happen. Not only will people continue to pursue these jobs, but with their passion they can drive real social change.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 28 of 145 (ID: inst_00118)

Topic: Should Elected or Appointed Government Officials Be Paid the Minimum Wage?

Focus on participant: 290.0_pro

Transcript:

[290.0_con] Elected or appointed government officials should not be paid minimum wage. This is because of the tasking and burdensome responsibilities that comes with these offices.

[290.0_pro] Elected officials should be paid the minimum wage for several reasons. 1) The job is to be a public servant, not to make a fortune. 2) It would force officials to see the reality for many citizens. 3) It would save tax payer money.

[290.0_con] i agree that the job is not to make a fortune, but one must agree that the responsibilities that come with these position are demanding compared to regular jobs and cannot be done by just anyone. It comes with a lot of burden.

[290.0_pro] Those responsibilities are no more taxing than what millions of americans face every day. People aren't paid according to how hard their work is. That isn't how it works. And again, this is not any job, this being a public servant.

[290.0_con] It is definitely more taxing than orders. Also the amount of value they add to the society should also be considered. Being a public servant does not mean

[290.0_pro] Yes. that is why we pay the minimum. It is not a career. Get in, work your term and move back to public life. We don't want people there forever turning into mafia bosses and inside traders.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 29 of 145 (ID: inst_00015)

Topic: Should the US Keep Using the Electoral College in Presidential Elections?

Focus on participant: 136.0_pro

Transcript:

[136.0_con] i believe the elctoral college needs to be abolished. it is dumb that we dont decide elections by popular vote instead of giving disproportionate numbers of votes to certain states. the system is rigged. it is not a true democracy if the majority of the peoples voice is not heard.

[136.0_pro] Hi, I think the Electoral College works because it worked in the past. I also think it is a good way to ensure democracy has been implemented relatively for the country. It offers a way to select a president fairly so that no one can interfere with the process. It makes both parties agree on the result without ever fighting the consequences. So far, it is a fair process that works for the political system. That is why I think the US should keep using the Electoral College in Presidential Elections and continue using it.

[136.0_con] you have not given any good reasons why you think its a fair process. the majority of people disagree with you in this country as evidenced by the difference in the popular vote and the electoral vote in the past 3 elections. the system is outdated and the district lines make no sense given the growth in infrastucture since they were created. you are wrong, and furthermore being dishonest or critically misinformed about the matter.

[136.0_pro] The US should not use the Electoral College in presidential elections because it offers no democratic but secret way to select a president without consensus. It provides no transparency but hidden information from the public. It is unfair to choose a president away from the public. It offers the opportunity to manipulate the process without notice from the public. It is a dangerous way to elect a president. It is unfair and unequal to the general public.

[136.0_con] youre wrong and probably a coservative. you let racist views cloud your judgement. the system is rigged so that red states can remain relevant dispite the huge discrepany in the number of democrats and republicans in this country. the only reason you support this system is because it benefits your party. i am not going to continue this back and forth with you if you insist on arguing in bad faith.

[136.0_pro] I think you might be wrong about the fair process. It is fair because of the process itself. It does not mean the system is outdated, but it works because everyone agrees with the result. It is fair because both parties agreed in the end, which is the most important thing about the election result.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 30 of 145 (ID: inst_00012)

Topic: Is Arts Education as Important as Science and Math in Schools?

Focus on participant: 156.0_con

Transcript:

[156.0_con] Science and math education equips students with skills that can actually be applied to real world situations. We heavily rely on technology, and science and math is just more practical. These also help with standardized testing much better than more creative education, meaning the student can get set up much better for their future. With how little schools get as far as resources, it just makes more sense to focus on what will help the students get better results.

[156.0_pro] Arts are important because they encourage creativity and promote cultural diversity. These traits are important in the development of individuals and society as a whole.

[156.0_con] While creativity is valuable, it doesn't really help students stay competitive in job markets today. Technical skills are way more important, and often lead to the better paying jobs. You can be creative in your free time if you have more money. Art focused careers unfortunately aren't really rolling in cash, with a few exceptions.

[156.0_pro] Standardized testing for math and science is impractical because it does not define the intelligence of the individual. These tests are only used to give funding to the schools that test at the highest percentages, whereas the schools that get the lowest scores need the funding the most. It is a false equivalence

[156.0_con] While standardized testing doesn't define intelligence, it doesn't really matter. What matters is the scores. Employers and higher education schools don't care how smart or creative you actually are. All that matters, at the end of the day, is how high that number is on that paper. Higher scores and more funding means more wiggle room for things that aren't as important, like art or sports. You get those higher scores by pushing things that can actually be measured, like math and science.

[156.0_pro] Creativity is absolutely important. How do you think tech is made? Some creative mind came up with an idea and implemented it in technology. The same is valid for the arts.. Companies rely on arts, especially in graphic design, animation, motion picture, photography, etc.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 31 of 145 (ID: inst_00038)

Topic: Should Students Have to Wear School Uniforms?

Focus on participant: 200.0_pro

Transcript:

[200.0_con] I think it is completely unnecessary and probably unsanitary. Think about it. One pair of clothes. How many times is that uniform going to be washed? For one thing, it is going to drive down sales in clothing. Mostly I am against it because it restricts students' freedom of choice, in this case, their freedom to wear whatever they want. Don't get me wrong I'm all for school uniforms in private schools but I don't think we should be forcing it in public schools. Our uniforms more expensive than street clothes?

[200.0_pro] School uniforms provide everyone with the same opportunities in how they present themselves. Lower-income students can worry less about what they're wearing in comparison to their peers who come from families with more money. It also helps the school appear more professional and respectful.

[200.0_con] It is a waste of school resources. Wealthier kids will likely attend private schools. How many of the lower-income families are going to afford school uniforms and then there are the maintenance issues. Ask yourself how long a uniform is going to last.

[200.0_pro] Schools usually issue more than one uniform, at least enough to wash on alternating days of the week so you still have one clean.

[200.0_con] What is that going to cost the school? Two uniforms for every 3,000 or so students. I think the money, taxpayer money, could be better invested elsewhere. I don't like the idea behind it. Make everyone look the same. That is not what America stands for.

[200.0_pro] Students of all income levels are issued the same uniforms and they are replaceable when they wear out or are damaged at no additional cost to the student. They get more than one uniform. As long as there are regulations in place to ensure that students have the same opportunities and access, there's nothing bad about it not lasting. It's also issued by schools ideally, paid by taxes.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 32 of 145 (ID: inst_00093)

Topic: Should there be Mandatory Quotas for Women in Leadership Positions?

Focus on participant: 311.0_pro

Transcript:

[311.0_con] Setting a Mandatory Quotas for Women in Leadership Position sets a very dangerous precedent and can lead to the best person for the job not getting the job, it's My opinion that whoever is best qualified for the job should get the job, that's what I think will help the company the most.

[311.0_pro] I think there should be a quota on the amount of women in the workplace so it ensures that the number of males and females in leadership stays equal.

[311.0_con] I don't understand the logic to this line of reasoning how is it that not hiring the person who is best qualified for the job is not the best way to help the company in fact in My opinion not giving the job to the best qualified person actually hurts the company also if men and women are in fact equal then there is no reason not to give the job to the best qualified person.

[311.0_pro] I think mandatory quotas will help to make sure there is gender equality in the workplace. Women are still discriminated against in the workplace so this is needed to ensure diversity. We have already seen that men are given jobs in leadership more often than women due to bias, this would be one way to prevent that and to have more women in leadership roles.

[311.0_con] So You are saying that Men and women are in fact not equal and that women need special treatment because they can't stand up for themselves and make themselves stand out by the quality of work they themselves put in.

[311.0_pro] You can still hire the best person for the job and ensure there is gender diversity in the workplace. There are women who are just as qualified as men who need an equal opportunity to move up in the workplace. It doesn't always work when women work as hard as they possibly can because even when they do, men who are less qualified still get these jobs. So if that's what's already happening naturally, there needs to be a way to ensure that hard working, qualified women have the same opportunities as their male counterparts.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 33 of 145 (ID: inst_00056)

Topic: Are Social Media Making People Stupid?

Focus on participant: 435.0_pro

Transcript:

[435.0_con] Social media is a good channel of information for many who lack the skills to properly research. Therefore, it is not making people stupid. In fact, it provides a medium for like minded people to be able to exchange ideas and information. It provides people of the same intelligence level to provide research, ideas and information in ways they can understand. It does not expect everyone to elevate to the same level of intelligence. Therefore, to say it is making people stupid is a generalization that holds no merit.

[435.0_pro] I strongly believe social media is making us stupid as a people. We have collectively stopped researching topics and simply trust the things we see as truth without researching or fact checking for ourselves. Unfortunately

[435.0_con] This is only based on the assumption that people will only take the information on social media and run with it.

On the contrary, most people take these ideas as a base foundation for information and elaborate through their own research. What this does is it provides a starting point for every individual to be able to diversify their arguments in their own way. Without this starting point, it would be difficult for many to even begin the task of starting a research project, collecting information or simply keeping up with current information.

[435.0_pro] While it does offer an opportunity for idea exchange, many times the sources people are using have not been properly vetted to ensure correct and accurate information is being disseminated. We have to be careful with whom we put our trust in

[435.0_con] Although it is true that many sources have not been vetted, it is a starting point. A starting point can be a statement that is true, somewhat true, or absolutely false. It can also be very broad or very specific. But the fact remains it provides a starting point for them to research the thesis- think of it as an encouragement of sorts to delve deeper into a topic they want to learn more about. As with anything, there is misinformation out there- regardless if it is through verbal conversation, classroom or printed media.

[435.0_pro] There are far too many not taking the extra step to do their own research. People are comfortable believing arguments that support their point of view even if that information they're taking in and spreading is not factual. It will continue to lower the intelligence of people

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 34 of 145 (ID: inst_00136)

Topic: Should Colleges Consider Race as a Factor in Admissions to Ensure Diversity?

Focus on participant: 357.0_con

Transcript:

[357.0_con] I feel that race should not be a factor in colleges. It should be based on performance rather than race. It also can bring up race card if there is a discrepancy who pays more or less for college. There are times when people that are different race tend to believe they deserve more advantage because of them being of a different class. I think it is ridiculous and everyone should be treated the same.

[357.0_pro] Considering race as a factor in admissions is crucial to ensuring diversity because racial differences are some of the most immediately apparent differences between people. Focusing on equal representation among races is a sure way to force diversity.

[357.0_con] I understand that diversity is important but it seems now that Colleges are different where they prefer this or that. I am just stating that it is better to have students apply based on their performance and grades rather than diversity.

[357.0_pro] Why treat people the same if it results in there not being proper diversity? The long history of marginalized and unrepresented minorities should dictate that we create more opportunities for them.

[357.0_con] I understand that but consider how things are being considered today. It seems that there is a big division among race these days where some feel they deserve more. I am speaking more on the illegals that can come and apply for anything and be accepted more than Caucasian or African American.

[357.0_pro] All too often, minorities' performance and grades are low as a result of oppression and racism that has long been in the DNA of our country, and we need to create more opportunities for them to make up for our ugly history.

Your label (check ONE):

☒ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 35 of 145 (ID: inst_00071)

Topic: Should there be International Agreements to Enforce Global Climate Change Policies?

Focus on participant: 171.0_con

Transcript:

[171.0_con] This is just another money grab, we have been hearing how climate change is going to end the world for the last 100. We should not have any agreements within our own country let alone internationally. The Liberal governments keep pushing this agenda so people like me in the middle class keep paying taxes for all of there green programs. The climate is changing, because earth is always changing. We are playing a very small part in the climate changing

[171.0_pro] It's been made clear that most entities, be it companies or nations, will not voluntarily do things that aren't in their best financial interest. It's 100% necessary for there to be an incentive to fight climate change, or a negative incentive for not doing it. The only way to get countries to follow these policies is for a strong agreement with real consequences for nations that don't follow it.

[171.0_con] Of course countries are not going to listen to weak leaders like Biden in the first place. Climate change is happening rather we like it or not. I believe in keeping the earth clean, recycling, but the green initiatives passed through the Liberal are ridiculous. They pocket millions of dollars during these green agreements. The world is different everywhere.

[171.0_pro] This argument holds no weight, as it's basically just dismissing the existence of man-made climate change. There's overwhelming amounts of evidence that it's real and is massively threatening our way of life. This is a given for any argument for international agreements, and is a total non-starter as an argument against it. Also, this is not about how an individual taxpayer is being effected.\n

[171.0_con] The overwhelming evidence is given by who exactly? People that make money off of this sop called crisis. Of course these scientists are going to say that man made climate is worse then it really is, so they can keep getting paid. International agreement will never happen. You would need all of the leaders to agree, and in the countries where the leaders are feared or respected, like Russia or China, it will never happen. They dont believe in it

[171.0_pro] Everything you've stated is a partisan attack on the Democratic party, who it seems like you blame for all the world's issues. You're avoiding the issue at hand, which is that the earth will be unlivable for huge portions of the population if something isn't done. That reality transcends political parties, and is a serious issue that every man, woman, and child on earth has to face. It's time for countries to band together and hold each other accountable for fixing the largest crisis humankind has faced.

Your label (check ONE):

☒ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 36 of 145 (ID: inst_00022)

Topic: Should Governments Have the Right to Censor the Internet?

Focus on participant: 165.0_pro

Transcript:

[165.0_con] I think that governments should not have the right to censor the internet because it takes away valuable perspectives and insights from the public forum. Having this type of government would result in society becoming like places similar to North Korea where people are only allowed to express views that the government approves of and people who express views outside of what is approved by the government get punished very harshly. I don't think society would be a safe place if this type of censorship was allowed

[165.0_pro] I strongly believe people should be able to freely speak their minds and disagree with others and openly discuss things but I also think the government has a duty to protect its citizens against hate speech and threats on the internet just like they would in real life.

[165.0_con] I can see where your concern is in regards to hate speech and I agree that people should not be allowed to threaten or cause harm to others through the use of their speech. I would also like to add that there are many laws that are already in place that protect people from these type of verbal threats which do not require limiting free speech on the internet all together in order to make things safer for people. I think enforcing government censorship online would eventually lead to people not being able to express their views in any way unless the government approves it (manually) which would end up being an issue of whether or not people who are using the internet have rights anymore to speak how they truly feel without feeling restricted

[165.0_pro] Just like committing any other crime against people, I believe the government has a right to remove dangerous and hateful content. This doesn't mean that people are only allowed to express views that the government agrees with but that users can expect to be protected when online from hate speech, stalkers, threats against them.

[165.0_con] I think that this problem can be solved all together without the need of any form of government censorship. With the laws that are already in place in regards to violence and stalking, I do not think that censorship online would make any difference. I think that government censorship would actually make it more difficult for people making threats to be caught because it would be blocked/removed entirely without as much of a trace being left behind for the victim to report.

[165.0_pro] If there are many laws that are already in place that protect people from these type of verbal threats then how is that not censorship? I completely agree with you in the first amendment free speech stance on the internet seen as a public square, but once there are laws regarding what you can and cannot say, this is technically censorship.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 37 of 145 (ID: inst_00054)

Topic: Should There Be Standardized Testing in Schools?

Focus on participant: 297.0_pro

Transcript:

[297.0_con] Schools shouldn't be weighed down by standardized testing. While a baseline of literacy is alright, it serves as a double edged sword - trying to force every child into a one size fits all education system. Different students will have different needs, and moreover students with different goals will have different learning requirements. For the student who lives on a farm in the middle of Oklahoma, why does he need to study French or take art? He's going to go on to work at the family farm, an education that reflects that would be better suited. Learning about ecology, animal husbandry, and even learning to work on automobiles would all better serve his future in the long run. And this applies to more than just the future farmers. Everyone would benefit from more personalized education.

[297.0_pro] I think that standardized testing can benefit kids in school. It can give them a general idea of where they are at and can help them feel confident in what they are learning. It can also help teachers gauge where kids are at in learning and know what they need help with and where their strengths and weaknesses are. It also helps to see how the school in general is doing and maybe they need to evaluate their teachers or they teaching styles and what students are learning. Schools give these standardized tests and then can get the grade of their school and it can help parents decide which school they would want to send their children to. Standardized testing helps all parties that are part of the school system for many different reasons.

[297.0_con] Standardized testing weighs students down more than it helps. It makes them confident in learning pointless things that won't be of any help to them in the future. Teachers should be able to help them with more personalized lessons as every student has different learning needs, and moreover many students who fail to succeed at the one method of learning promoted by standardized testing feel worse about themselves. It's a one size fits all solution that leaves a lot of students behind.

[297.0_pro] While i agree that kids could benefit from their own learning styles and more personalized learning, its also good to broaden their horizons, because you never know where they may end up in life. Also just giving them a test to see where they are at in their learning, does not change what they are able to learn. It just lets them know where they are at in the average learning.

[297.0_con] Standardized testing actually encourages learning to pass the test material and little else. Most students don't actually learn the history or science they study, they learn to memorize it into their short term memory in order to pass the year's curriculum and out it goes. A more personalized approach to academia would help students acquire actual valuable knowledge that they will carry with them for the rest of their lives.

[297.0_pro] A teacher cant take their time to give more personalized lessons to every student. If you would like to learn that way, then you have the option to homeschool and learn what you would like. These tests help the teachers know where the students are at and what more they can help them with. It also lets parents know how good of a school they are sending their children to. If you don't make students feel like these scores are super important, more so just seeing where they are at, then they wont feel worse or disappointed in themselves.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 38 of 145 (ID: inst_00081)

Topic: Should the US Enact More Regulations to Ensure Fair Elections?

Focus on participant: 301.0_pro

Transcript:

[301.0_con] I feel the so called regulations are just ways to try and manipulate the voting by excluding certain groups. We should not be making it harder for people to vote but easier especially when we live in such a technologically advanced age. I often see mail in voting being talked about as needing to stop but what of our military that is overseas should they not get a vote. The whole idea is just ripe for abuse.

[301.0_pro] The election process in our country has its merits, but it does need some work. One of the issues is verifying that someone is who they say they are before voting. As much as I would like to believe that people would only vote if they are the person they are voting on behalf of, we have seen recently that this is not always the case. Even something simple like verifying ID can assist. ID is required for many processes and procedures in this country so this should not create a burden on people.

[301.0_con] No one is saying you shouldn't be verifiable to cast your vote but the regulations that people are speaking of enforcing are more aimed to prevent underprivileged people from voting.; I agree that ID's are a valid use but the other regulations are just manipulations to try and sway the voting.

[301.0_pro] I do not have an issue with making voting more technologically friendly, but we do need to preserve the right to vote and verify a person's identify before allowing them to vote. Verifying an ID can be done through technology or in person. But it would ensure a more fair voting process.

[301.0_con] As I said it never seems to be the ID issue I see pushed but removing ballot boxes from lower income areas and ending mail in voting. Both these things would effect a certain parties members more than the other and that is tampering as far as I am concerned. We cannot violate the right of every citizen rather rich or poor, black or white, to vote.

[301.0_pro] My only perspective is adding verification of an individual prior to allowing them to vote. I do not agree with several other strategies either. I just want to ensure that everyone gets their 1 vote and they are not voting multiple times or using someone else's identity.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 39 of 145 (ID: inst_00078)

Topic: Should the US Provide Military Aid to Ukraine in its Conflict With Russia?

Focus on participant: 377.0_con

Transcript:

[377.0_con] If the US provides Ukraine with the supports, it makes the country weak in the eyes of every nation. Because US has been interfering with other nations affairs. And it is not worth it. Us should prioritize in make it defense stronger

[377.0_pro] I believe that the US should definitely provide military aid to Ukraine why warring with Russia because Russia was the aggressor and this is not the first time that they have done this. Russia's leadership is not trustworthy on the world stage. If the US just let do whatever they want, other nefarious actors will come out of the dark and

[377.0_con] Us should stand it grounds and build it security instead of helping other countries affairs.

[377.0_pro] If the US does not interfere, Ukraine will lose its citizens, its lands, its democracy to a huge bully. We are not only fighting for Ukraine's land

[377.0_con] It should just stay it grounds and not interfere

[377.0_pro] US does have its own issues that needs to be reformed but Russia has friends in the background that are waiting for their opportunity also to be aggressors and takeover other countries, like China and Taiwan. Russia d

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 40 of 145 (ID: inst_00069)

Topic: Should Every Citizen Receive a Basic Income from the Government?

Focus on participant: 248.0_pro

Transcript:

[248.0_con] We cannot just give money to people. It could cause more of the same problems we are already seeing today. People need to provide some kind of service to be in society, if they are able.

[248.0_pro] I think that the government should provide the basic minimum for every citizen to survive instead of spending money on weapons. This makes sense to me because war is worthless.

[248.0_con] We need to be ready to defend ourselves though. If not, someone will swoop in and take over. To secure peace is to prepare for war.

[248.0_pro] People should not have to provide a service in order to survive. That should be extra, after everyone essential needs are met. The problems you mention, I assume are things like poverty and crime and unemployment. This is caused by the super wealthy who corrupt the government and rig the system against the poor. Tax the rich and distribute the money to the rest of us, I say.

[248.0_con] Then nothing will be getting done. We'll all just be hanging out, playing xbox. Surely, there will be consequences to that. I agree the rich get richer and the poor get poorer but I don't think you're considering the consequences. I mean, who would work at the store if they don't have to?

[248.0_pro] The US is by far the most powerful military presence in the history of humankind. If we demilitarize, other countries will follow suit, and all the money that is being wasted on weapons could be spent on helping people and providing for everyone's needs. What is the point of groups of humans fighting other groups of humans for land and resources?

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 41 of 145 (ID: inst_00102)

Topic: Should Elected or Appointed Government Officials Be Paid the Minimum Wage?

Focus on participant: 46.0_pro

Transcript:

[46.0_con] It is difficult to promote paying government officials only minimum wage. One issue is the question of who would actually do the job for minimum wage, There are many other minimum wage jobs out there that are less stress and responsibility. Likely the position would attract people who are already wealthy through some means, and want the power of the position. It also wouldn't help corruption, as people desperate for money are likely going to be susceptible to bribes. The position would attract a very select group of people that don't represent most . The idealistic side of it that our officials should know what it's like to live on minimum wage is great, but the real problems that poses might be insurmountable.

[46.0_pro] The concept of the minimum wage has always been on the publics mind. Many government officials have strong opinions on this matter, some overwhelmingly against raising the minimum wage. However, if government positions were paid the minimum wage it would not only attract more people who will fight to make change, but it will also make the topic one that can be discussed by people actually experiencing it. For too long government officials have had the chance to make decisions on matters that do not directly impact them and that leads to an overall disconnect between the people and those chosen to serve. By having the officials experience the

[46.0_con] How can paying minimum wage attract people who want to fight for change? Those people need to live, eat, support their families as well. The only way these people could pursue a minimum wage position with this level of responsibility is if they have someone with enough wealth supporting them. Those who are already wealthy are going to fight to preserve their wealth, not in the best interest of the masses. These positions would attract a select group of people who want power and don't need money.

[46.0_pro] My opponent brings up a good point - who will do the job for minimum wage. Yes there are less stressful jobs out there, however this will still be pursued by those passionate about social change. Many people take on lower paying jobs because it's what they are passionate about - not because they are an already wealthy group. This will once again allow people to make decisions that not only impact the masses, but themselves as well as they will be experiencing it too. For these reasons we need to pay our officials the minimum wage to lead to change.

[46.0_con] Passion cannot provide a roof over one's head or food on their table. A select few people without access to other wealth can manage this situation - those who are single with very low living expenses, no family to provide for. But the majority of people who have the passion and right ideas to implement changes, simply wouldn't be able to afford taking this position. If they had to work multiple jobs to make it work, I would say that would be a detriment to their ability to think clearly and lead. And if they fell upon any sort of hard time, it would leave them susceptible to bribes.

[46.0_pro] It would attract those who want real change because it's what they are passionate about. The kicker is that those in power will finally be able to experience the difficulties of living on minimum wage and the end effect will likely be an increase in the minimum wage. This change would be difficult at first, but once people experience the trials and tribulations of living on an unlivable wage, there is a real chance for change to happen. Not only will people continue to pursue these jobs, but with their passion they can drive real social change.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 42 of 145 (ID: inst_00134)

Topic: Should Animals Be Used For Scientific Research?

Focus on participant: 4.0_con

Transcript:

[4.0_con] I think that animals are sentient beings and should have some rights. I think that there is too much unneeded and unnecessary abuse of animals and we should learn to treat them better and give them more rights. this part will be controversial to some, but I believe any testing we do on animals should be done on convicted prisoners instead. we can use convicted murderers and rapists (only those with absolute proof of guilt). it would give us better results than testing on animals and it would further science more accurately. I also think that people need to be more mindful of animals spaces whether it is in nature or in their own homes. we need to find alternative ways to further research without harming innocent creatures. we need to find better ways that cau

[4.0_pro] Animals suffer tremendously and there are other means to test cosmetics, drugs, and the like. Animals aren't always the best catalysts for results. Animals cost money to feed, maintain by paying vet bills, house. Animals testing is cruel and antiquated as a testing method. Why not use humans instead and see how humans like pain, disfigurement, and suffering.

[4.0_con] animals have no rights because animals can give no rights or acknowledge our rights. we should use animals as we see fit. that does not mean we should torture them unnecessarily but we should use them as tools to further research and make things better for all, including animals. some testing is needed no matter how some people try to deny it, but even small things like testing dog food on dogs to make sure it is safe for our pets is needed. it is not a completely black and white issue, there is a lot of nuance.

[4.0_pro] Animals provide a breakthrough to test drugs, cosmetics and other non FDA yet to be approved items. The cost of using animals outweighs the cost of human life. Testing how drugs will affect humans is best done on animals because some animals such as monkeys have similar DNA. There an

[4.0_con] I think there are valid points to be made on both sides of this issue. I think that animals need to have some rights and they need some protections. people should not harm or destroy an animal just because they can. but there are a lot of valid reasons to do research. that said, we should do what we can to minimize any pain and suffering. we should make sure there are valid reasons for the research and that it is not being duplicated over and over for no good purposes.

[4.0_pro] Using animals as tools to further benefit drugs can be useful at times and other times not so useful. As anything else, animals being tortured is not a benefit or a benefit that is useful to humans when testing drugs.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 43 of 145 (ID: inst_00106)

Topic: Should the US Have Mandatory National Service?

Focus on participant: 43.0_pro

Transcript:

[43.0_con] Why should our young people be forced to fight the wars of politicians and corporations? We are not at war and conscripting young people is not a solution to our problems. Forced national servitude is little more than slavery. Let's not regress to that dark past.\n

[43.0_pro] My point are Mandatory national service could provide skills and also source of employment or empowering the youth. It can also bring people together both old and your, the rich and the poor. It also gives opportunity to interact with people

[43.0_con] All these things you mention are freely available already. You offer no benefit and have just repackaged slavery as some sort of desirable commodity. In fact, your retort is not much other than word salad that you force me try to deduce your meaning. You have no reasonable argue and just spew random nonsense.

[43.0_pro] Mandatory service go beyond military or force involvement. It instills a sense of civic duty. It can include education , healthcare

[43.0_con] Please provide proof of how it "instills civic duty". You are just stringing words together and hoping to form a cogent argument. I find no validity in making people slaves to the State. And what happens when people don't want to serve? Prison? Monstrous I say!

[43.0_pro] I understand you , but let me clarify some point. Mandatory national service is not about packaging slavery or not giving people their freedom. It is aimed at promoting personal development.

Your label (check ONE):

☒ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 44 of 145 (ID: inst_00077)

Topic: Should the US Keep Using the Electoral College in Presidential Elections?

Focus on participant: 417.0_pro

Transcript:

[417.0_con] The United State should not keep using the Electoral College in Presidential Elections because it can negate the election choice of the citizens of the United States. Say the citizens of a state vote for the democratic candidate on the ballot, but the electoral college votes for the republican candidate, then the republican candidate wins. So, no matter who the citizens of the U.S. elect, the electoral college will win anyway.

[417.0_pro] Hello. I have been assigned the pro side of using the electoral college. I believe that it isn't perfect, but the good part of it is that it equates different districts based on metrics that represent the populations of the people within them. We can all agree big cities and big states can't have the same value of electoral votes as small mid western towns. This is one way we can balance out votes in a fair way. I also believe in the popular vote as well. I believe that the popular vote should count for something in the end. I think both metrics should be used, and not just one. No one should lose the popular vote and become president.

[417.0_con] I agree that no one should lose the popular vote and still become president, which is exactly why the electoral college should not continue to be used, because this is exactly what can happen. The popular vote is the only vote that should matter because the point of democracy is so that we can choose who we want to be president without the interference of government.

[417.0_pro] I agree with those points as well. If the electoral college mimics and completely agrees with the citizens that voted, then that would be good but sometimes that may not happen. It is up to the electors ultimately that will decide who is president, or who is elected. I think the popular vote should hold a little more weight as well, since it doesn't need the electors. I also think citizens should have more power.

[417.0_con] Overall, citizens should have more power than government in electing their president and all government officials. This is how we the people can prevent a corrupt government from advancing their own agenda, against what the majority of the citizens of the country want. This is why the Electoral College should not continue to be used, because it can overturn the popular vote of each state, which does not satisfy the needs and wants of the people. It is our constitutional right to choose our president without government interference.

[417.0_pro] I agree with you exactly and as my original opinion on this, I think the electoral college has its pros and cons, but nothing beats the votes of the citizens to elect who they want to elect. Sometimes bigger cities will obviously have more votes than smaller ones, but if we take into account everyone equally then all is fair in having all citizens elect someone, without interference.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☒ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 45 of 145 (ID: inst_00137)

Topic: Should Transgender People Be Banned From Using Bathrooms Consistent With Their Gender Identity?

Focus on participant: 331.0_con

Transcript:

[331.0_con] I get the whole idea of wanting to be inclusive and accepting, but when it comes to bathrooms, I just think it's about ensuring everyone's comfort and safety. Some people might feel uneasy or uncomfortable sharing bathrooms with individuals whose gender identity doesn't align with their assigned sex at birth. It's not about discrimination; it's just about maintaining a level of privacy and comfort for everyone. There might be genuine concerns about safety, especially in public spaces, and having open bathroom policies could potentially lead to uncomfortable situations or even safety issues. So, for the sake of everyone's peace of mind, maybe it's better to stick with the traditional system.

[331.0_pro] I hear the concerns about comfort and safety, and they're valid. However, when it comes to bathroom access for transgender individuals, it's crucial to emphasize the principles of fairness and human rights. Banning transgender people from using bathrooms that align with their gender identity is not just about comfort; it's about acknowledging and respecting their identity. Such restrictions contribute to the marginalization of transgender individuals, subjecting them to unnecessary discrimination. By allowing transgender individuals to use bathrooms based on their gender identity, we promote inclusivity and equality. It's important to recognize that fears about safety are largely unfounded, as numerous studies have shown that these policies do not pose significant risks. Rather than perpetuating stereotypes and biases, supporting restroom access based on gender identity is a step towards creating a more compassionate and just society. Let's focus on building understanding and acceptance, ensuring that everyone has the right to use facilities that align with their gender identity without fear of judgment or discrimination.

[331.0_con] Well, I can see the importance of treating everyone fairly and respecting their identity, but I also think it's crucial to consider everyone's comfort and safety. I mean, it's not about discriminating against transgender individuals; it's more about finding a balance. Some folks might feel a bit uneasy sharing bathrooms with people whose gender identity doesn't match their assigned sex at birth. It's not necessarily about judgment; it's just about personal privacy. I get that studies say safety concerns are minimal, but what about the emotional well-being of everyone involved? Some people might genuinely feel uncomfortable, and we should acknowledge and address those feelings too. Maybe there's a way to have options like gender-neutral facilities alongside traditional ones to cater to different needs.

[331.0_pro] The discomfort some people may feel about sharing bathrooms with those whose gender identity differs from their assigned sex at birth should be addressed with education and awareness. It's an opportunity to foster understanding and create a more tolerant and accepting society. Many fears and concerns are rooted in lack of familiarity, and fostering empathy can go a long way in mitigating these concerns. Moreover, the argument about safety should be examined critically. Numerous studies have consistently shown that allowing transgender individuals to use bathrooms according to their gender identity does not pose significant safety risks. It's essential to base our discussions on evidence and not perpetuate unfounded fears.

[331.0_con] I appreciate the evidence-based approach. Yet, it's also essential to recognize that some individuals may genuinely feel uneasy or anxious about sharing spaces, regardless of statistical data. Their concerns are valid and should be part of the broader conversation.

[331.0_pro] The emotional well-being of everyone involved is indeed a crucial consideration. Validating the feelings of those who may feel uncomfortable is important, and this acknowledgment should guide our approach to creating inclusive spaces. Perhaps having options like gender-neutral facilities alongside traditional ones is a practical solution that caters to different needs. By advocating for compromise and understanding, we can bridge the gap between competing perspectives. It's not about dismissing concerns or pushing a one-size-fits-all solution; it's about finding a middle ground that respects the diverse experiences and feelings of all individuals.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 46 of 145 (ID: inst_00020)

Topic: Should Abortion Be Legal?

Focus on participant: 390.0_con

Transcript:

[390.0_con] Abortion should not be legal because we can't be taking the lives that we can't create. Pregnancy is a gift from God and it is also a blessing from God.

[390.0_pro] Abortion should be legal because women have a right to make their own choices with their own bodies. Having the government dictate what a woman can or cannot do with their body is unfair and unjust. There are many reasons for abortions, for example if the delivery results in fatal complications for the mother or if the victim was raped. A child needs the support of a mother and forcing a child into this world can result in worse for the child.

[390.0_con] But we should have a right to take lives because we want to make their own choices about their own bodies. There are other ways to handle the matter instead of taking lives.

[390.0_pro] Sometimes lives are not created purposefully, it can be an accident or forced, such as the case with rape victims. Forcing women to bear children they are not ready for creates an unstable environment for the child to grow up in. It is not fair for the child or the mother to be forced to go through.

[390.0_con] They are not been forced to go through the pain, Government can create a facility that will be extracting the pregnancy from their mother maybe when the pregnancy is 4 month then put them inside incubator for the remaining months. I'm very sure it is going to work in that way

[390.0_pro] Other ways to handle the matter include adoption, an orphanage, or foster care. These systems have countless accounts of abuse and is not always a sufficient environment for a child to grow up in.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 47 of 145 (ID: inst_00096)

Topic: Should Students Have to Wear School Uniforms?

Focus on participant: 211.0_con

Transcript:

[211.0_con] Wearing uniforms stifles creativity and individuality. Students cannot express themselves through their wardrobe and style choices. Young people should be able to show their personalities through what they choose to wear and not be forced to be homogenous. I wore a uniform in high school and had to express myself with jewelry and accessories and I got sent home a lot because of it.

[211.0_pro] I am in support of students having to wear school uniforms because it can increase school spirit. There is also I believe some evidence that school uniforms reduces bullying. Having school uniforms breaks down class barriers between students. School uniforms can also greatly increase safety because children are much more easily identifiable from a distance. Children can also be more easily spotted by teachers on field trips. Increasing student safety is the biggest reason I support school uniforms.

[211.0_con] I do not understand how wearing a uniform would increase school spirit. Some students wear clothing that it meant to be provocative in some sense and that is compelling to those around them.

[211.0_pro] I understand how important is the need for creativity and individuality. I believe there could be some sort of compromise. Student uniforms should be required in my opinion, because evidence shows school uniforms greatly increase student safety due to children being more easily identifiable. However, I also think the students should be allowed to customize their own uniforms to express their own individuality. No children should be sent home for wearing jewelry for example.

[211.0_con] I was sent home for the shoes, tights, jewelry and makeup that I wore. It was ridiculous and affected my studies and my mental health. Young people cannot be expected to repress themselves in order to be more generic. Leave that to the military where uniforms are meant to strip away personality.

[211.0_pro] Wearing a uniform can increase school spirit because the uniforms represent pride in their school. Children wearing provocative clothing is a big reason for bullying. Evidence shows that school uniforms actually greatly decrease bullying for this reason, which is why school uniforms should be required. We need to minimize bullying due to the fact that bullying in school leads to in an increase in mental health problems and suicide risk. I think we should do everything we can to minimize bullying for this reason, even if it suppresses student individuality. The safety of the students should come first.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 48 of 145 (ID: inst_00080)

Topic: Should the US Enact More Regulations to Ensure Fair Elections?

Focus on participant: 234.0_con

Transcript:

[234.0_con] The US is already over-regulated with rules and regulations making it harder for citizens to vote and express their decisions. \nAdditional regulations will cause far fewer people to engage in the democratic process, which is not healthy for our country. \nFurthermore, when the voice of the people is diminished by a process that overcomplicated their will with incentives the country becomes less and less a democracy as a result.

[234.0_pro] I think enacting more regulations should be done so to help prevent voter suppression/discrimination, guard against cyber threats, increase transparency and strengthen our voting infrastructure so that results are trusted to be accurate.

[234.0_con] There must be ways to bring voting into the grassroots and public domain without involving more and more computer systems that can be hacked or even manipulated in the future by AI. AI will soon be a singularity and a greater threat to the process than either party.

[234.0_pro] First, it's important to ensure that voting is accessible to all citizens. Rules should be implemented to prevent unfair practices like fraud. Secondly, reasonable regulations can enhance trust in the system. Fair elections can encourage more people to vote. Lastly, regulations aim to protect integrity so that it's not influenced by outside forces. Without these, trust can be lost.

[234.0_con] But where do we draw the line? At some point, the process becomes so over-regulated that most people are too confused and dissuaded from voting altogether. This means that far fewer people can engage in the democratic process, which is in itself undemocratic.

[234.0_pro] Technology can be vulnerable to hacking but it can also improve accessibility. Electronic machines can help people with disabilities. Also, AI can be seen as a threat, however, we need to create regulations to safeguard us against this sort of manipulation. Lastly, encouraging grassroots movements are important and these regulations can be created to help with supporting these engagements.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 49 of 145 (ID: inst_00043)

Topic: Should the US Have Mandatory National Service?

Focus on participant: 249.0_pro

Transcript:

[249.0_con] What makes the United States great is it's citizens having the freedom to do whatever they choose. The government of the United States doesn't have the authority or the NEED to force its citizens into mandatory service. There isn't any reason to serve the country by force. The entire proposition is ridiculous, and there shouldn't even be an argument. The constitution affirms our rights as citizens to do as we please as long as it isn't hurting any other citizen. Instead of worrying about ridiculous propositions such as this, we should be focused on taxing the rich elites and using their tax money to fund and better this United States.

[249.0_pro] National service should be of choice and by mandatory, it would've been acceptable if the government has a specified job for individuals who participate in national service, but I that is not possible then one has to be allowed to choose either to serve the national or find a job as soon

[249.0_con] your argument doesn't even make any sense. How can something be 'of choice' and also 'mandatory'. That isn't even possible. I'm not even sure what you are trying to say in the following sentence. The government doesn't find jobs, nor is it their responsibility. Your entire reasoning is flawed, and you don't really give any reasons you believe things should be this way. No one should want the government to be that deeply entrenched within their personal life choice

[249.0_pro] Yes I support this statement. Individuals should have the right choose either to serve or not serve, since there's no direct benefit nor negative effect it may have on the citizens in terms of work. This is

[249.0_con] This isn't an counterargument. You are agreeing with me. Therefore I win this argument. The pro side is indefensible. This isn't even a debate, you folded like a newspaper before my first statement.

[249.0_pro] The point I wanna make is that once there's no direct effect of national service on the citizen who's ready to search for a job, the Government shouldn't make it mandatory because it will be seeing as an imposition

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 50 of 145 (ID: inst_00090)

Topic: Should There Be Standardized Testing in Schools?

Focus on participant: 177.0_con

Transcript:

[177.0_con] Standardized testing can do much more harm than good, and here are some ways: it can set an unfair standard for students who learn slower or are a bit more behind than the other students. This can cause unnecessary anxiety and depression. The tests have no natural way to measure progress; those with better memories can do better than those who learn at a slower pace. They also need to consider different learning styles that students may have and, in this way, DO NOT measure academic proficiency. Finally, many of the questions on the test have no relevance to the material taught by the teacher and are random questions the student may have never seen before.

[177.0_pro] As a current teacher standardized tests will ensure you have equal representation of test scores. It will make it easier to streamline results. It could serve as a starting point for student a etc. to see what they know. And develop lessons based on those scores. Also if a family moves, they have a starting point. They have the scores that can be used in any state. Every student is tested over the same kinds of information. SO it creates cohesion and unity. Its not different from state to the next. Makes the whole school system flow a lot easier this way.

[177.0_con] You need to take into account the different ways students learn, the subjects they like the most, and the further processing abilities of each student. Having all the same questions doesn't measure a student's ability to the utmost respect; different students with diverse learning abilities may be better at other sections than others. They should not be shamed for this. These tests cause unnecessary stress and anxiety to an already vulnerable youth and create space for depression when the student believes they cannot live up to the other scores.

[177.0_pro] I get where you are coming from. However, how do you fairly measure what they know across the board then? Do you have individualized instruction for each student then? This seems like from a logical standpoint hard to replicate. During tests there are different learning styles that are offered. Those with hard of hearing are read the tests. Those with slow reading are read the tests. There are accommodations for all kinds of students. Standerized tests serve as a starting point. It allows teachers to know what they know and what they need to teach.

[177.0_con] Okay, but many of the questions on these tests will NEVER be taught by the teacher or put into the curriculum. So much of the information clog up the memory or will never be addressed again, and failing a student for not knowing something they DON'T need to know is entirely unfair. Different learning styles don't mean 'hard of hearing'; we're talking about kids with varying learning abilities or disorders. What about kids who have autism or something along those spectrums? Should they be included in the same testing as other kids? Tests don't always measure a kids ability, stress can produce poor test results while the kid excels in homework and every other part of school.

[177.0_pro] Students should be taught about identifying their own strengths and weaknesses. We should teach about self esteem. Having a nation wide class that is mandatory that talks about mental health. Having tests like this set them up for the real world. Its a dog eat dog world and we have to be used to competition. Having the same questions across the board allows for test scores to looked at evenly. If you give different kinds of tests then you cannot look at them with a balanced approach.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 51 of 145 (ID: inst_00132)

Topic: Should Public College Be Tuition-Free?

Focus on participant: 434.0_con

Transcript:

[434.0_con] While it is a nice idea for tuition to be free, this would cause a number of problems. Free tuition would only be a good thing at the student level, but it would drastically affect the salaries of those teaching college courses. Additionally, free tuition can cause a substantial level of waitlisting for nearly all colleges, putting new high school graduates at the bottom of a list. This would cause countless new students to not even reach entry-level pre requisite courses. This would cause students to never reach college, as life may progress and prevent them from being able to attend.

[434.0_pro] The question of whether college should be tuition-free is a complex and debated issue with various perspectives. Advocates argue that a tuition-free college system could enhance accessibility, alleviate economic burdens, and promote social equality. They contend that such a model could lead to a more educated and skilled workforce, contributing to economic growth and innovation. Opponents, on the other hand, express concerns about the potential increase in taxes and the impact on the quality of education. The debate extends to the role of federal investments, state contributions, and the overall cost of public colleges and universities.

[434.0_con] While it may be true that free tuition can bring about an alleviation of economic burdens, enhanced social equality, and further accessibility, it does not promote anything positive for college faculty. Universities and community colleges alike will not have enough professors to keep up with the overflow of brand new students, and they will have less to pay them as well. It may be true that free tuition could benefit the nation by generating a stronger work force, but the level of college waitlisting that will transpire would be d

[434.0_pro] The three issues raised by you are effect on teacher salaries, waitlisting, and accessibility. First, we can subsidize teacher salaries and offer debt relief. While concerns exist, the benefits of tuition-free college outweigh potential drawbacks.\n\nAccessible Education: Tuition-free college ensures equitable access to education, breaking down financial barriers and providing opportunities for students from diverse backgrounds [1].\n\nEconomic Empowerment: It promotes economic growth by fostering a more educated workforce, contributing to innovation and increased productivity [2].\n\nDebt Relief: Tuition-free models alleviate the burden of student debt, allowing graduates to enter the workforce without financial constraints].\n\nHigher Completion Rates: Eliminating tuition barriers results in higher college completion rates, ensuring a more educated society.\n\nSocial Equality: Tuition-free education addresses disparities, creating a more inclusive society and bridging gaps in educational opportunities.

[434.0_con] There are a number of positives you listed, many of which are true outside of one primary aspect regarding Higher college completion rates. Just because tuition would be free, it may not promote a higher level of completion. In fact, free tuition may cause many who are unserious about college to attend based on family expectations and the \$0 price tag. Also, free tuition would generate severe waitlisting causing those that are serious to never be able to attend colle

[434.0_pro] Universities are locations of free thought. To have the most diverse thought in the classroom, we should have free tuition so anyone can access it. While concerns for faculty are valid, implementing free college education can be balanced to address both student accessibility and faculty needs. Advocates propose allocating additional funds to ensure universities can hire more faculty, maintaining a healthy student-to-teacher ratio. Investing in programs that attract and develop teaching talent can mitigate potential shortages, ensuring a quality education experience. Research suggests that tuition-free college can contribute significantly to the economy, potentially providing more resources for educational institutions. Institutions can engage in strategic planning to accommodate an influx of students, including expansion and adapting educational models to efficiently handle increased enrollment.

Your label (check ONE):

[] evidence_adoption

[✓] anchoring

[] echo

[] strategic_persuasion

[] ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 52 of 145 (ID: inst_00083)

Topic: Should Elected or Appointed Government Officials Be Paid the Minimum Wage?

Focus on participant: 290.0_con

Transcript:

[290.0_con] Elected or appointed government officials should not be paid minimum wage. This is because of the tasking and burdensome responsibilities that comes with these offices.

[290.0_pro] Elected officials should be paid the minimum wage for several reasons. 1) The job is to be a public servant, not to make a fortune. 2) It would force officials to see the reality for many citizens. 3) It would save tax payer money.

[290.0_con] i agree that the job is not to make a fortune, but one must agree that the responsibilities that come with these position are demanding compared to regular jobs and cannot be done by just anyone. It comes with a lot of burden.

[290.0_pro] Those responsibilities are no more taxing than what millions of americans face every day. People aren't paid according to how hard their work is. That isn't how it works. And again, this is not any job, this being a public servant.

[290.0_con] It is definitely more taxing than orders. Also the amount of value they add to the society should also be considered. Being a public servant does not mean

[290.0_pro] Yes. that is why we pay the minimum. It is not a career. Get in, work your term and move back to public life. We don't want people there forever turning into mafia bosses and inside traders.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 53 of 145 (ID: inst_00131)

Topic: Should the US Expand (?pack?) the Supreme Court?

Focus on participant: 88.0_con

Transcript:

[88.0_con] The US Expand shouldn't pack the Supreme Court because the President will have to spend a lot more time when it comes to ranking each individual person. The president would spend a lot more time when it comes to nominations which will also add a bunch of unneeded biases as well. An example is that a court packing has already failed in the US

[88.0_pro] The court is not large enough to represent the views and opinions of the entire United States. We have a large Congress, why not a Supreme Court, too?

[88.0_con] My counterargument to this is that it will still take a massive amount of time dealing with the Supreme Court because of how important it is when it comes to society. The president is already having to deal with Congress and a bunch of other issues in America so it just feels like a burden to them that the Supreme Court is running around honestly. Even though the court isn't large enough, they still have massive powers that can be detrimental to society as a whole which has to be kept afloat by many people which isn't worth it in the long run.

[88.0_pro] This goes to show that not only is the make up of the court not appropriate, but how we pick the justices is also a process that can be improved. Perhaps the people should elect justices just like we do the president? We can vote on justices just like we do politicians. Justices will serve terms instead of lifetime appointments.

[88.0_con] The amount of bias and fake votes that would occur during these votings would be really detrimental. A politician doesn't have the same powers as someone who is in Supreme Court has. The Supreme Court has far too many powers and it doesn't seem right how normal Americans could just vote when it comes to what they do, I feel like the President and higher-ups of the Supreme Court or the government should be allowed to decide since they know best about the wor

[88.0_pro] Perhaps it's time we do away with the court altogether. Like you said, they have "massive powers." But should they? Either we grow the court or find a way to change it. I don't know what that would look like, but it bothers me that a criminal like Trump had as much influence over the court as he did. Now women in many states have to carry their rapists baby. It makes me sick.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 54 of 145 (ID: inst_00009)

Topic: Should the US Have Mandatory National Service?

Focus on participant: 444.0_pro

Transcript:

[444.0_con] We should not be forced to do that unless an emergency but usually we should avoid it. We can use that time for better things such as finding a job, sharing with others, taking care of the family, and so on. Also, it is common to see the military doing dirty jobs for the elites who only care about getting more assets for themselves and not for the country. We can find countless of videos of how veterans are treated after the

[444.0_pro] Mandatory service is essential to protect the country. We all benefit from our country, so we all should be ready and willing to give back to it. \nOnly by banding together and having everyone do their part can we hold our own against foreign threats.\n\nAny person who shirks that service is taking advantage of the protection provided to them by others. Given that it's essential things are fair in who takes the risks and who doesn't the only way to accomplish this is with mandatory service, so that everyone has an equal chance at needing to serve.\n\nWomen and men should be called to enlist, though women should be kept for non-combat roles, because men are faster and stronger, and don't need women to carry around as dead weight in combat situations. When there are not enough non-combat roles for women, enlistment for them can be slightly reduced compared to that of men. Women w

[444.0_con] We rarely need to protect our country since we mostly do maintenance and we are ready to battle too. The problem is that our country wants to be everywhere and use us as slaves to complete their errands. We will always have people that will enlist for this and we should avoid this mandatory national service unless other countries are getting ready to attack us.

[444.0_pro] If everyone equally shares a two year draft period, plenty of time is left over for people to find jobs, or take care of family. \n\nThe military engaging in public works is for the greater good of us all, and essential for the well-fare of the country. It is unavoidable that we should all chip in to contribute to making our country the best it can be.\nDraft services are an essential part of that.\n\nTo avoid them is to take advantage of others who have sacrificed for us.

[444.0_con] A lot can be done in two years which is even worse when we are still in our 20s. The military has always a set amount of people to complete some tasks so this is completely unnecessary and forceful too. Why do you want to serve as a slave for e

[444.0_pro] A 2 year mandatory service terms ensures everyone is battle ready, and trained, instead of waiting until an emergency happens to then have to deal with a large population of clueless civilians. It would give everyone the basic training to know what to do in case of an emergency, and make the country ready for anything. The public works that could be accomplished during that 2 years period would just be icing on the cake, and something we could all benefit from.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 55 of 145 (ID: inst_00114)

Topic: Are Social Media Making People Stupid?

Focus on participant: 404.0_pro

Transcript:

[404.0_con] No, social media does not make people stupid. Stupidity or ignorance is a trait people have regardless of their interactions with social media. Social media cannot "make" someone stupid. If someone is "stupid", they come to social media with this trait already. Due to their stupidity or ignorance they may not think about what they are reading and how they are engaging with social media with the right amount of critical thinking. I propose that social media does not make people stupid.

[404.0_pro] To begin, we must think about what we mean by "stupid" when answering this question. If we mean that it is making people think less for themselves and more blindly agree with information fed to them, then yes, social media is making people stupid. Everything is right in front of people now, so they can just find the answer to any question and thus no longer have to really think about anything. They are also much more easily influenced by the opinions and thoughts of others, and that does not make for a thoughtful, intelligent person. Think about how you learn in school: you read, you study, you listen, you share, you discuss. Very little of that happens with social media. It's just knee-jerk statements and responses. It does not invite the pursuit of thought.

[404.0_con] When people think less for themselves and blindly agree, they come to social media with the trait of stupidity already inherent in who they are as a person. Social Media in and of itself does not cause this, but rather, due to their stupidity they do not carefully think and provide critical thinking skills to what they read/see on social media platforms.

[404.0_pro] This argument follows my original question - what do we mean by "stupid?" First, stupidity and ignorance are not the same thing, so to use them interchangeably moots your argument. What is stupidity? Where does it come from? It comes from not bothering to learn, not bothering to educate yourself. Social media fosters this - social media does not encourage learning, does not encourage educating yourself. So in that manner, i

[404.0_con] Stupidity causes ignorance. Again I state that Social Media in and of itself does not cause people to BE stupid. They already are and one cannot assert that social media causes this. There are other factors involved as to why a person is "stupid". Due to their stupidity, they do not interact appropriately with social media - thinking critically and thoughtfully as a more intelligent person would and should.

[404.0_pro] We must again begin with what we mean by "stupid" and what do we mean by making people stupid. The question is not well-written to begin with, because one can argue that nothing outside of a person makes that person stupid. But what the question really asks is does social media contribute to people's ignorance, their lack of thoughtfulness when thinking through a situation or problem. That is the obvious meaning of the question, and the answer to that question is equally obvious: social media greatly contributes to people's ignorance and to their lack of thoughtful reflection to issues and questions.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☒ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 56 of 145 (ID: inst_00000)

Topic: Should the Penny Stay in Circulation?

Focus on participant: 114.0_con

Transcript:

[114.0_con] The penny should not stay in circulation because it is virtually useless in today's society. Most Americans today rely on virtual currency or debit and credit cards. They simply do not need loose pennies to conduct their daily transactions. \n\nAlso, many people today do not even like carrying around pennies. They lose them or simply throw them away. Using pennies waste time and causes delays in customer transactions in retail. It also causes long lines because people have to wait for the cashier or customer to simply count out pennies. More time and energy could be saved if we transitioned to purely virtual currency and stopped circulating pennies.\n\nLastly, our government and businesses could save lots of time and cut down on labor costs. And it's less waste on the st

[114.0_pro] We need the pennies. Why? If we didn't have pennies how would the change be made for odd amounts in purchases? I feel doing away with pennies would just give merchants an excuse to round up prices to an amount that will create a total that would not require pennies in the transaction. God knows we are paying so much more these days, we don't need to cause an increase, no matter how small, that will cost us all more when we make purchase.

[114.0_con] We actually don't need pennies. They are not necessary when we have many different ways of payment including apps like Venmo, Zelle, and Cashapp. Also, there's cryptocurrency, debit cards, credit cards, and virtual currency. Many people today do not even use pennies, while others don't rely on using cash like they used to either. Overall, in today's society, people can use alternative methods of payment that don't require them to bring the exact change or even use pennies. Pennies no longer need to

[114.0_pro] I agree that most use cards but there are still plenty out there paying in cash. They have a right to pay with what currency they choose. What if they do not have any cards? Or if the card is declined? They would have to leave the purchase behind even if they have cash on hand. That is not fair to them. Some people just don't like credit or debit cards.\n\n\n\n\n\n\n\n\n\n

[114.0_con] Even though some people don't like using cards, they still can use virtual currency and simply tap their phones or smart watches. They literally don't even have to use a physical card. Plus, virtual currency apps are available and ace

[114.0_pro] You are entitled to your opinion. I don't think the government will ever fully do away with small change. It's just a necessary evil these days. You are speaking like a gen Z. Older generations would never go for totally giving up using cash for some things. Cash can't fall prey to skimming devices!

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 57 of 145 (ID: inst_00008)

Topic: Should Felons Regain the Right to Vote?

Focus on participant: 279.0_con

Transcript:

[279.0_con] Felons should not regain their right to vote because their harmful actions took their privileges away. No one causing destruction in our society should not be able to vote.

[279.0_pro] I believe it is a basic human right to vote and committing a felony does not negate this right. I feel that humans make mistakes and that should not bar someone from engaging with the community that they are a part of. Moreover some felons are on the way to reestablishing a connection to others and the community and voting would be a good way to integrate them into normal life. They are able to think politically and have opinions even if the justice system which is flawed has stated that they have done wrong in the past. A persons past should not reflect how they are engaged with voting or decisions beyond themselves. Voting has been taken away from so many people in the past, as a democracy we need to make voting inherently easier for everyone to do and more open to all.

[279.0_con] They caused harm to other humans and our society so therefore their opinions don't matter. Our world needs input only from decent human beings not criminals.

[279.0_pro] The actions of people, no matter how destructive should and cannot in any way obstruct the basic human right to affect change or elect a leader. They have not given up their right to vote by making mistakes and the thread of rights versus the past actions of a person is lost on me. I do not see the connection between the two since it is a basic human right, and felons should be treated as humans with access to all if not many human rights. It is not a way forward or keeping anyone safe to deny these rights. It is destructive in itself to not let them vote.

[279.0_con] As stated before, these are criminals. Criminals should not have the same rights as the good citizens in our society. Unfortunately, due to their poor decisions their opinions don't matter.

[279.0_pro] You do not get to decide who is decent and take away someones human right to decide on a leader, affect change, voice an opinion or vote based on how you view them. Let felons reintegrate into society by being constructive. A very basic and necessary way to do this would be to allow them to vote. There are many other things felons cannot do and this is the least harmful way to allow them to correct or even counter the harm they committed. Why not let them vote and be a value to our society as it is a democracy and lessen the extent to which we villify felons.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 58 of 145 (ID: inst_00013)

Topic: Should Transgender People Be Banned From Using Bathrooms Consistent With Their Gender Identity?

Focus on participant: 247.0_con

Transcript:

[247.0_con] This is a facetious argument. We're long known how to do gender neutral bathrooms, where completely enclosed individuals stalls can have any gender person, with communal sinks. I'd argue that no one should be forced to use gendered bathrooms at all, because it's a false dichotomy. That being said, imagine being forced to use the men's room as a woman. That's how trans people feel. Basic human decency alone, let alone fairness, dictate that we don't discriminate. They should use the bathrooms they feel comfortable in. Or better yet, we use non-gendered bathrooms as said previously, and don't have to have stupid conversations with narrow-minded people.

[247.0_pro] Women have fought for their personal spaces and places in society for years. Why should men be able to dress up as women, come in, and invade our spaces? Nothing will ever make a man magically turn into a woman. Women menstruate, a man will never relate to that, experience it, or understand it. I refuse to play pretend with these men or have my daughters in a restroom with them. This is not what feminists fought for.

[247.0_con] See previous. This is a stupid argument. But if we must have it, then everyone should feel comfortable in their choice of bathroom. Thus we need a bathroom for every gender combination, so we'll need at least 4.

[247.0_pro] There are plenty of bathrooms that are unisex, but after a long road trip with my family, I have discovered that the simple fact is that most bathrooms are gender assigned. As a woman, I do not want men in my personal space. This is something that feminists spent years fighting for and it's a slippery slope. Once men are allowed in women's restrooms, then they'll be allowed in women's sports, beauty pageants, etc. Why should I, as a woman, have to convenience a small but loud portion of the population? It's not right.

[247.0_con] See previous. This is ridiculous. It's about people's feelings but they can't consider other's feelings, so why should I consider theirs? Let's just move to a no gender stall system and not have to have dumb conversations.

[247.0_pro] We do not need four different bathrooms. We need a men's room and a ladies' room. No one ever had a problem with this until a bunch of men began invading women's spaces. We do not need to convenience people who are biologically male but identify as women. If you're biologically a male, go to the men's room.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 59 of 145 (ID: inst_00005)

Topic: Is Government Surveillance Necessary for National Security?

Focus on participant: 354.0_con

Transcript:

[354.0_con] I DO NOT AGREE WITH GOVERNMENT SURVEILLANCE BECAUSE I WOULD FEEL THAT MY CITIZEN PRIVACY RIGHTS WOULD BE VIOLATED ALSO I WOULD BE AGAINST DEMOCRACY

[354.0_pro] Government surveillance is helpful for national security, and it is one of the best ways to ensure our safety. It plays a critical role in preventing threats to our country's security like terrorism or cyber attacks (such as DDoS attacks). This surveillance can help detect or even prevent attacks.

[354.0_con] AND WHAT MAKES YOU UNDERSTAND THAT THE GOVERNMENT CARE ABOUT US? I THINK THEY WOULD DO IT WITH OTHER INTERESTS NOT FOR THE SAFETY OF CITIZENS

[354.0_pro] While it is also true that citizen privacy concerns are important, so is the prevention of national threats. I wholeheartedly believe government surveillance would be a driving force in preventing attacks, and I would be happy to work together with both sides of the argument to reach understanding and agreement. Policies would need to be put in place to protect individual rights, and I also think the surveillance should operate with full transparency. But, it is still a leading way to protect citizens and that is why I am in support of it.

[354.0_con] BUT THE RIGHTS TO PRIVACY OF CITIZENS CONTINUE TO BE VIOLATED SINCE, AS YOU SAY, IT IS NOT CLEAR WHO FOR THE GOVERNMENT ARE A THREAT OR NOT, SO IT GIVES THEM THE RIGHT TO INVADE THE PRIVACY OF EVERYONE EQUALLY FOR THE SIMPLE FACT OF SUPPOSING THAT THEY ARE THEY FEEL THREATENED

[354.0_pro] That's where I would want the full transparency so that we are completely informed and have access to anything the government is doing. Open source is important here. I want to know just as much as you. And I also want to be protected from the government just as much as I want to be protected from national threats. Security is important in all corners, and that's where I would want to work together. A Government surveillance that is open and transparent, that does not violate our rights by being completely transparent! Compromises could be made on both sides.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 60 of 145 (ID: inst_00033)

Topic: Should Washington, DC, and Puerto Rico Be Granted US Statehood?

Focus on participant: 345.0_con

Transcript:

[345.0_con] Puerto Rico and Washington DC should not be grouped together for this question, however, DC should not be given statehood. Its citizens are already covered under the laws of the US and are given the same rights. There is no specific reason to give it statehood as it already falls under its own state.

[345.0_pro] Puerto Rico would be so much better off if it was granted Statehood. The acceptance into the main political system of what is currently a protectorate would allow it all the rights of states. Currently to have the same power in the realm, people from Puerto Rico have to move to an current state among the 50. By granting statehood, they would be given 2 Senators and at least 1 House member, plus a different sort of representation in the courts of the US. It would give them an upped attitude in the world. Plus after all these years it would be an advantage for investment and bus\nThe same can be said of Washington D.C.

[345.0_con] To be honest, I completely agree with your thoughts on Puerto Rico, however, how is this applicable to DC? Its citizens already have the rights of states.

[345.0_pro] Interesting way to separate the debate. While the citizens of D.C. are basically covered, they don't enjoy quite the same status. They don't have a representative in Congress the way the rest of the people of the US have. D.C. does not belong to any state in the Union. It is an unaffiliated area. The people who live there don't quite have the same status a

[345.0_con] With DC being such a small land area, how would it be beneficial to the rest of the country if it were given statehood? It would make more logistical sense to demolish the name of the area and incorporate it to the surrounding area, then covering under the state.

[345.0_pro] Well, there is a problem here, because I agree with you about D.C. so I was just playing along. \nPuerto Rico needs to be evaluated because it is possible that the citizens want to be a state. I want to reiterate my arguments on Puerto Rico and add that some of what I'm arguing could apply to D.C.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 61 of 145 (ID: inst_00119)

Topic: Should Washington, DC, and Puerto Rico Be Granted US Statehood?

Focus on participant: 447.0_con

Transcript:

[447.0_con] Washington, DC is barely the size of any US city, and the demographics are skewed by the number of politicians resideing there. The "true residents" number under one million people, compared to New York City with almost 9 million residents. \n\nPuerto Ricans can't even agree if they WANT statehood, although statehood would grant them

[447.0_pro] Washington DC and Puerto Rico should absolutely be given US statehood. Puerto Ricans pay federal taxes, yet cannot vote in US elections. How is that fair? Puerto Rico pays billions of dollars in taxes to the US but is given no representation. No taxation without representation. It is one of the pillars this country was founded on.

[447.0_con] There is barely a majority of Puerto Ricans who even WANT statehood. They want independence! They object to the colonization of their land. They shouldn't have to pay US taxes, AND they should be an independent entity!

[447.0_pro] I'd like to see what you are referencing when you claim that Puerto Ricans can't agree if they want statehood. The territory status has limited the civil rights, and economic success of Puerto Ricans.

[447.0_con] Puerto Rico has held half a dozen referendums on the subject of statehood, and a BARE majority of 52% opted for statehood. Keeping in mind the population of mainland US migrants who would, of course opt for statehood, it can be assumed that native Puerto Ricans DO NOT want statehood.

[447.0_pro] I see your point, I think the decision should be for Puerto Ricans to decide. I believe that a huge part of the population of Puerto Rico would prefer to become a state than continue with their territory status. But, like I said it's up for them to decide so I'd like to see a vote happen.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 62 of 145 (ID: inst_00017)

Topic: Should the Death Penalty Be Legal?

Focus on participant: 303.0_con

Transcript:

[303.0_con] The death penalty provides a quick and painless approach for punishment of severe crimes and criminals. Should murders, rapists and other violent criminals really be given a quick way out of their crimes? What if these criminals had intended to kill themselves and thought they may as well act out anyway, as they will either be killed or given the death penalty and no longer have to deal with the struggles of life. These criminals should have been stripped of their freedom but given time to dwell on their acts for life and in the containment of prison. There should be no quick way out for them and perhaps they will eventually come to regret what they committed.

[303.0_pro] I believe that capital punishment is a fair assessment/ruling when it fits the criminal's crime. For example, if someone murders 10+ people, I don't think it's acceptable to give that criminal a life that they get to live in prison while the victims' never get to receive that same opportunity. I think not all criminals like someone in this situation would be able to fix themselves or would ever provide to society in a manner that validates their continued existence.

[303.0_con] Is it fair in all circumstances though? What if, which is not uncommon, later evidence suggests the criminal was indeed innocent but no longer alive, can that be true justice? A life in prison demands those which are in fact guilty to dwell on their crimes and require them to spend countless days regretting their decision.

[303.0_pro] While I agree with the sentiment of someone having to live with their actions, it becomes a muted point when they feel zero remorse or regret for their actions. In these types of circumstances where the criminal is numb to their heinous acts, it should not be the burden for taxpayers or the families of the victims to continue housing/feeding this individual in the prison system. Living a life is a privilege when it means taking the lives of others and the death penalty is a necessity in that regard.

[303.0_con] A life in prison also gives time for the justice system to work and in some cases a verdict can be reversed. Prison labor for example, is a way for prisoners to atone in part for their acts and provide goods and services for their fellowman whilst still losing the privilege of freedom, a dead man can provide no benefit to society.

[303.0_pro] I don't think the death penalty should be used in circumstances such as this scenario, I think it needs to be proven with the upmost certainty that the criminal is guilty with strong evidence before we take their life. However, I don't think it's fair for locking up a noncriminal either, so we are talking about two different subjects with this kind of point. If you kill other people, you should be killed. If you physically harmed people to the point of no return, feel nothing for your repeated actions on numerous victims it should be considered. If it's hearsay, then we need some more stronger evidence before the death penalty is legalized for this purpose.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 63 of 145 (ID: inst_00031)

Topic: Is Arts Education as Important as Science and Math in Schools?

Focus on participant: 362.0_pro

Transcript:

[362.0_con] Arts and Education is important, but it is not as important as Science and Math. I would argue that Science and Math help us to solve problems and better our society. It is not until we have utilized math and science that we can take time to appreciate the arts. Once we have made life easier for ourselves, then we can take time to enjoy the artistic things in life. There will always be room for us to improve and do better. Art should be more secondary. It should be appreciated but only at certain times.

[362.0_pro] I understand that Math and Science contribute to human development in various areas but the artistic side also awakens one in a deeper level and this was there ever since the mankind began and so I believe Arts is also equally important as Science and Math in schools

[362.0_con] That deeper level of thinking is key. I agree with that. You revert back to the Math and Sciences though to improve life. The Arts come into play to help better the more important values brought forth by math and science.

[362.0_pro] I agree with almost of what you said but again I stick to my point where we are only looking at the extrinsic value of the art that it does not derive as much as value as the science or math does but we have to look at the holistic approach.

[362.0_con] In math and science, we learn how to build up a society. Art is just a sort of perk to go along with it. If we did not focus on math and science we would never have a point in looking at art.

[362.0_pro] I cannot disagree anymore with you with the clear articulation of thoughts you have on the math or science over the arts. I concede and totally second your thoughts, my friend! :)

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 64 of 145 (ID: inst_00059)

Topic: Should there be Mandatory Quotas for Women in Leadership Positions?

Focus on participant: 262.0_pro

Transcript:

[262.0_con] Mandatory gender quotas do more harm than good and therefore should not be implemented. Quotas can lead to negative attitudes among other employees, specifically the gender that does not have a quota. Mandatory gender quotas can also lead to poor hiring practices.

[262.0_pro] Women have historically been underrepresented in leadership positions and positions of power, and this needs to change. 50% of the world is made up of women, and they represent a large demographic people who deserve to have their voices and experiences represented in leadership roles. Government, for example, has historically been very male-dominant, resulting in a number of policy decisions over the years that fail our system of checks and balances, and are detrimental to women, such as the rescindance of the Roe V. Wade decision. The senate today is made up of 75% men and only 25% women, for example. Increasing the number of women in leadership roles for not only government, but also private companies and local groups promises to benefit a large group of people who historically have not had the power or voice to make their needs heard.

[262.0_con] Women do makeup 50% of the world's population, but that is not an accurate representation of the percentage of women who are interested in pursuing a political career or leadership position in large organizations. Women are underrepresented in these areas because they choose different paths than their male counterparts.

[262.0_pro] While mandatory gender quotas can create divisions and negative attitudes in the workplace, this is a preferable outcome to having a group of workers unequally represented. It is by far more important to make employees feel welcome, respected, and represented in their place of work and across government than to spare the feelings of those who historically have had no issues with representation in the workplace or being hired into leadership roles. Negative attitudes are the result of systemic exclusion of women, not poor hiring practices.

[262.0_con] Mandatory gender quotas prevent an organization from optimizing its human resource power. It prevents them from hiring the most qualified candidate to do the job. It creates negative attitudes in the workforce and leads to organizations underperforming.

[262.0_pro] In 2023, your argument is simply false. Women have historically been prevented from pursuing roles in leadership and government due to the culture of those places. Politics has always been referred to as a boys club, and since the creation of the US constitution, women have had to fight for their rights in ways that men are simply granted. Until the 19th amendment, women were not even allowed to vote! Much less hold positions of power. Until we exist in a society in which women are consistently paid equally and are represented equally in positions of power traditionally held by men, mandatory quotas for women in leadership positions would be a net positive.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 65 of 145 (ID: inst_00107)

Topic: Is Arts Education as Important as Science and Math in Schools?

Focus on participant: 93.0_con

Transcript:

[93.0_con] Arts education is not as important as science and math, because the implications of gaining more knowledge in science/math are of greater weight than that of art. For example, scientific discovery can treat disease, and help us live healthier lives. While art can be beautiful and inspiring, there are lots of beautiful things in nature already. Math and science can enhance civilization.

[93.0_pro] Arts Education is as important as science and math in schools because it helps provide students with a well-rounded education overall. Whether it's sculpting, painting, or drawing, art enables people to experiment with new ideas and materials. In addition to improving their artistic skills, this creative freedom also affects other areas of their lives, enabling them to approach problem-solving with an open mind. Students learn basic skills and become more dexterous. Additionally, students read texts and study works of art from all different cultures and perspectives throughout human time on the Earth. Giving students access to these imaginative activities at a young age will aid in their development. Imaginative activities for young learners can lead to better skills in social interactions and emotional regulation. Lessons in the arts introduce K-12 students to problem-solving techniques, which help them to see the world in new ways, and provide access to creative ways of knowing. Children will be more stimulated and exercise their brains better by coloring or making art by hand in comparison to watching a video on an iPad at the dinner table.

[93.0_con] The argument essentially stated the benefits of arts education, but it did not argue for why its as important as science and math. Arts education certainly has benefits, but its benefits are not as important as science and math. Understanding science and math is necessary to live a healthy life and function in society properly. One cannot say the same for art. There are many people who lack art knowledge and do fine.

[93.0_pro] Math and science severely lack flexibility and creativity. Also, many academics are not equipped to study such complexities. Many students thrive in more creative environments centered on reading, writing, and creating works by hand. Learning about the historical roots of art provides an enhanced and in-depth learning experience. Students gain perspective and real-world understanding in a way that math and science cannot teach.

[93.0_con] While arts education undoubtedly offers benefit, the benefits are not as important as those science and math offer. Understanding science and math are essential to discovering things which can advance society and help people. Wh

[93.0_pro] Math and science do not benefit human health. Contrarily, the arts provide insight into how people from the past lived and you can learn a lot historically that benefits human society today. Many functioning members of society do not excel in math or science studies. The argument at hand is why arts education is just as important as science and math in schools. Therefore, allowing students to explore this academic genre will enhance their sense of knowledge and individuality in the world. The arts are highly influential and educational.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☒ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 66 of 145 (ID: inst_00063)

Topic: Should There Be Limits on Freedom of Speech to Prevent Hate Speech?

Focus on participant: 437.0_pro

Transcript:

[437.0_con] There should not be limits on freedom of speech. It is very important in society to be able to express your opinions freely. If we couldn't there would be too much control over the people by the government. If I couldn't voice my opinion everything would seem bias. There would be no honesty in feelings. We would always be scared of saying the wrong thing and being punished for it. It is a very bad idea and against our constitution.

[437.0_pro] There should be limits on freedom of speech to prevent hate speech because hate speech fosters hostility towards those who he hate speech is about. Physical attacks have happened on countless people because of bias and hate speech interrupts our country's assurance of life, liberty and the pursuit of happiness.

[437.0_con] So you are saying we should be fearful of violence if we speak our true feelings and expressions? That is absurd, I disagree with people all the time and give my opinion whether someone agrees with it or not. We cannot live in fear. It is against our constitution to prevent free speech.

[437.0_pro] There is a difference in controlling propaganda that is against the state or expressing ones ideology or opinion hat is based on intelligence and forethought. Hate speech is an opinion based on hate. Hate has no place in our society and in how we handle our citizens and their opinions of politics or people. Hate speec

[437.0_con] We are not talking specifically about propaganda or limiting hate speech. The argument is about limiting freedom of speech in general which would also limit expressing ones ideolog

[437.0_pro] You are completely right NO ONE should live in fear and hate speech induces that fear in the people hate speech is about. I do no want to ban all freedom of speech just tone down the speech that robs others of their right to happiness and safety! There is a big difference! People have A right to live in peace!

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 67 of 145 (ID: inst_00067)

Topic: Should the Death Penalty Be Legal?

Focus on participant: 157.0_con

Transcript:

[157.0_con] It should not be legal because only God should determine who lives and who dies and not another human. Also there could be severe consequences for anyone that carries out the execution. Death can come right back to you. So, people need to think twice before they choose to end someone's life.

[157.0_pro] Unfortunately, there are some people in this country that commit horrible crimes. More severe than some people are able to bear. Heinous crimes require heinous punishments, especially if there are victims that suffered due to this awful criminal activity. Their loved ones have to live on and knowing that the person who took their family away will never do it to anyone else is sometimes the only thing we can give them. The death penalty is sometimes needed to resolve terrible actions.

[157.0_con] I do understand that the actions caused by some individuals can really affect the victims. But I think that we should let God be the judge. It might not be today or tomorrow, but those criminals will get a taste of karma. It will come right back to them. So let God be the judge. I know humans are very emotional, but I think this is the time to let our creator handle things.

[157.0_pro] In this country "we the people" are the ones who decide how we are governed in these matters. Yes, death surely can come back to you, which is why the death penalty is needed. It's needed so that if someone took a person's life, we can close that loop of evil with the death of the one who committed the original offense. This is the only way the terror can end.

[157.0_con] It is not up to a human to decide whether another lives or not. It is not up to you to decide. Death penalty is not needed.

[157.0_pro] We are the judges of our peers and that is how we keep order in this country. We cannot simply wait around for karma and hope justice is served. We have a duty to ensure there are checks and balances to everyone's actions. The death penalty will always be needed if we want to create a better society for ourselves and our children.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 68 of 145 (ID: inst_00139)

Topic: Should Felons Regain the Right to Vote?

Focus on participant: 219.0_pro

Transcript:

[219.0_con] Felony is not a trivial crime; these are serious offenses that these people have been convicted of therefore I do not believe that they are qualified to be entrusted with the privilege of voting. Voting is not to be taken lightly; when a citizen votes they are representing the whole of the community. Our future is in the hands of citizen voters. Voting is a right but it is not decoupled from respons

[219.0_pro] Every individual who lives in the country has the right to vote. Just because you committed a crime does not mean your constitutional right to vote should be taken away. Even if you are in jail or prison does not change the fact that you live in this country. Therefore, the people who are elected have an effect on your life. Therefore, regardless of your crime you should have the right to vote. Every citizen should have the right to vote.

[219.0_con] Voting is a right but it cannot be decoupled from responsibility. A person cannot vote until a certain age, for example. Also, if incapacity because of a brain incapacity or dementia is established, voting is not a guaranteed right. So, in the case of people who have broken the trust of the community, why would restrictions to voting not be applied? We must protect our

[219.0_pro] Regardless of ones crime, it does not change the fact that they live in the country. Therefore, regardless of their crime it does not change the fact that are citizens. The people in power who are elected make decisions that effect the felons. Because the decisions of the politicians effect the felons they should retain the right to vote.

[219.0_con] When they undertook these very serious crimes, they did not take the rights of their fellow citizens. There are psychiatric reasons to not be allowed to vote; these criminals have demonstrated at least equivalent incapacity to be a good citizen. Their right cannot be weighed more highly than the safety of the national body politic.

[219.0_pro] The point of incarceration is to rehabilitate someone and eventually integrate them back into society. By taking away ones right to vote we are further ostracizing them from society. The whole goal of prison is to have someone reflect on their actions. Felons should not loose their rights because of their crimes.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 69 of 145 (ID: inst_00142)

Topic: Is Online Learning a Suitable Replacement for Traditional In-Person Education?

Focus on participant: 80.0_pro

Transcript:

[80.0_con] I am against online learning as it precludes the person was an intersocial opportunities. Being able to hear and appreciate other opinions is an important part of education. Also, in person teaching often involves more critical situations than online, means you also learn to deal with criticism. Perhaps the main benefit is the benefit from diversity and being exposed to those outside your "bubble". Online learning is often self paid and the emphasis is sometimes trying to make the consumer satisfied over teaching the consumer learning techniques.

[80.0_pro] I believe that online learning is a suitable replacement for traditional in person education as I believe that the learner loses very little compared to in person. I believe as long as their is a willful student that they will successfully learn as much as they would in person. I believe that an online learner will feel more comfortable online as they don't have to worry about outside distractions. I also believe that online learning gathers much faster information as you don't need to rely on an in-person teacher. I also believe going at one's own pace and not being forced to match the teacher's lesson will allow the student to absorb the knowledge they seek instead of going out one ear onto the next.

[80.0_con] The problem with your argument is that all students are not willful, but could benefit from the in person guidance. Also, if the student is too much in tune with their own agenda, they do not benefit from the diversity of other students.\n\nIn person learning will also help the student to LEARN to be comfortable with distractions, as in the real world.

[80.0_pro] I agree that being able to hear and get that in person opinion in person is very important but I believe that this can be done online with a willing teacher and student as long as they both seek to teach and learn. I also feel that you can gain that diversity through an online class and don't necessarily need to do so in person. I agree that there are those who simply wish to make the consumer satisfied, however I believe there are many teachers that one can gain online that truly cares about teaching their students in whatever study they are interested in.

[80.0_con] I, again, believe that missing out on the diversity of a classroom and learning to cooperate in a group setting outweighs the benefit of, maybe, getting a teacher who really cares in an anonymous situation of online. \n\nAlthough, I agree you may get a caring instructor, the odds are better in an institutional setting with rules and standards of practice.

[80.0_pro] An un-willful student could be found both online and in person. I believe that tests and a good teacher could help a student who is more in tune to their own agenda. Again, I believe that an online class featuring several different people would help that diversity of different students. I also find that having an online webcam would be similar to teaching a student to be comfortable.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 70 of 145 (ID: inst_00042)

Topic: Should There Be Standardized Testing in Schools?

Focus on participant: 297.0_con

Transcript:

[297.0_con] Schools shouldn't be weighed down by standardized testing. While a baseline of literacy is alright, it serves as a double edged sword - trying to force every child into a one size fits all education system. Different students will have different needs, and moreover students with different goals will have different learning requirements. For the student who lives on a farm in the middle of Oklahoma, why does he need to study French or take art? He's going to go on to work at the family farm, an education that reflects that would be better suited. Learning about ecology, animal husbandry, and even learning to work on automobiles would all better serve his future in the long run. And this applies to more than just the future farmers. Everyone would benefit from more personalized education.

[297.0_pro] I think that standardized testing can benefit kids in school. It can give them a general idea of where they are at and can help them feel confident in what they are learning. It can also help teachers gauge where kids are at in learning and know what they need help with and where their strengths and weaknesses are. It also helps to see how the school in general is doing and maybe they need to evaluate their teachers or they teaching styles and what students are learning. Schools give these standardized tests and then can get the grade of their school and it can help parents decide which school they would want to send their children to. Standardized testing helps all parties that are part of the school system for many different reasons.

[297.0_con] Standardized testing weighs students down more than it helps. It makes them confident in learning pointless things that won't be of any help to them in the future. Teachers should be able to help them with more personalized lessons as every student has different learning needs, and moreover many students who fail to succeed at the one method of learning promoted by standardized testing feel worse about themselves. It's a one size fits all solution that leaves a lot of students behind.

[297.0_pro] While i agree that kids could benefit from their own learning styles and more personalized learning, its also good to broaden their horizons, because you never know where they may end up in life. Also just giving them a test to see where they are at in their learning, does not change what they are able to learn. It just lets them know where they are at in the average learning.

[297.0_con] Standardized testing actually encourages learning to pass the test material and little else. Most students don't actually learn the history or science they study, they learn to memorize it into their short term memory in order to pass the year's curriculum and out it goes. A more personalized approach to academia would help students acquire actual valuable knowledge that they will carry with them for the rest of their lives.

[297.0_pro] A teacher cant take their time to give more personalized lessons to every student. If you would like to learn that way, then you have the option to homeschool and learn what you would like. These tests help the teachers know where the students are at and what more they can help them with. It also lets parents know how good of a school they are sending their children to. If you don't make students feel like these scores are super important, more so just seeing where they are at, then they wont feel worse or disappointed in themselves.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 71 of 145 (ID: inst_00130)

Topic: Should the US Enact More Regulations to Ensure Fair Elections?

Focus on participant: 175.0_pro

Transcript:

[175.0_con] The US does not need to include any more regulations for the election process. Voting is a part of the American citizen experience and any further regulations could prevent citizens from using their voice to partake in elections. There is no reason to enforce any more regulations that could take away from the election process and skew election results. As long as you are registered to vote, you are part of the democratic process that is elections.

[175.0_pro] There should be more regulations on elections to ensure fairness. The reasoning for that relates to election interference via poll workers, potential issues with hacking election computers, and a lack of voting opportunities for some communities. \n\nNot all poll workers can be trusted, and regulations on who can work the polls would ensure a more fair election. Opposing countries to the United States could also meddle with polling via computer hacking. There needs to be stronger regulation on how ballots are counted to hopefully avoid that issue entirely.\n\nLastly, certain places don't have access to polling like other places do. This can lead to unfair election outcomes simply by access means.

[175.0_con] Poll workers are a part of helping elections run smoothly in the country and should not be demonized. There are already balances in check to ensure voting fairness. \n\nThere are multiple ways to cast a ballot, including by mail. Therefore, voting is already accessible to all places and people in the US.

[175.0_pro] You simply cannot trust that elections are fair as they are. Nothing would be taken away from the election process if more regulations were enacted. More regulations would only ensure every eligible vote gets counted and anything ineligible would not get counted. The history of recent elections shows that some regulation of elections is needed.

[175.0_con] If more regulations were enacted, there would be even more opportunity for the election to be skewed by the fact that there would be more people meddling in the election results. Evidence of election results being tampered with is slim.

[175.0_pro] Not all states have mail in ballots. Some locations even have polling places which are inaccessible to people without access to reliable transportation. Polling places are not accessible to everyone.\n\nOn top of that, poll workers in the past have been untrustworthy in their conduct. There needs to be more regulations on who can become a poll worker because of that.

Your label (check ONE):

[] evidence_adoption

[✓] anchoring

[] echo

[] strategic_persuasion

[] ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 72 of 145 (ID: inst_00040)

Topic: Should Animals Be Used For Scientific Research?

Focus on participant: 322.0_con

Transcript:

[322.0_con] Animals, due to their biological similarities with humans, serve as valuable models for studying diseases and testing the safety and efficacy of new drugs. Safety testing is especially important to identify potential harm in products before they reach the market. Additionally, animals play a key role in environmental research, helping us understand and address the impact of human activities on ecosystems.

[322.0_pro] Using animals for scientific research has proven crucial for medical breakthroughs, disease understanding, and safety testing. Many life saving treatments and medications have been developed through research involving animals, contributing significantly to improvements in public health. Animals, due to their biological similarities with humans, serve as valuable models for studying diseases and testing the safety and efficacy of new drugs. Safety testing is especially important to identify potential harm in products before they reach the market. Additionally, animals play a key role in environmental research, helping us understand and address the impact of human activities on ecosystems.

[322.0_con] The claim that animals are crucial for safety testing before products reach the market can be challenged by advancements in alternative testing methods. These alternatives offer a more ethical approach and have the potential to provide reliable safety information without the ethical concerns associated with animal testing.

[322.0_pro] While it's true that animals share biological similarities with humans, it's essential to consider the ethical concerns associated with using them for scientific research. The use of animals raises moral questions about the treatment of living beings and the potential for unnecessary suffering. Moreover, the effectiveness of animal models in predicting human responses to drugs and treatments has been called into question, as the biological differences between species may lead to misleading results.

[322.0_con] The argument about the effectiveness of animal models in predicting human responses is a valid concern. However, it's crucial to recognize that, in many cases, animal testing has provided valuable insights that have contributed to medical breakthroughs benefiting both humans and animals. Furthermore, ongoing efforts to develop and incorporate alternative methods should be encouraged to address these concerns and reduce reliance on animal testing.

[322.0_pro] In closing, though it's acknowledged that advancements in alternative testing methods provide a more ethical approach, it's crucial to recognize the current reliance on animal testing in certain situations. The transition to alternative methods requires careful consideration, validation, and widespread acceptance within the scientific community. Emphasizing the importance of ethical research practices is commendable, and ongoing efforts should be made to explore and implement these alternatives wherever possible.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 73 of 145 (ID: inst_00014)

Topic: Should the US Ban Fossil Fuels to Combat Climate Change?

Focus on participant: 351.0_con

Transcript:

[351.0_con] Banning fossil fuels alone will not combat climate change. That's like saying not eating a burger will help you lose weight. there has to be a massive plan in place. Like how about showing us affordable clean energy. Sustainable housing and affordable living would be a greater help. We haven't seen a Tesla that wont blow up. Electric vehicles are still quite dangerous. Heating homes still largely relies on gas or oil. More efficient options are out of most consumers reach.

[351.0_pro] The U.S. should ban fossil fuels to combat climate change because it's those fuels that are having a negative impact on global warming and on the environment. If we can eliminated those fuels detrimental to the environment, then the downward spiral toward the most harmful effects of climate change may be slowed. Researchers should find more economical and cleaner ways for consumers to be able to fuel cars and access energy without the harmful and negative effects on the environment. Our dependence on fossil fules should end.

[351.0_con] Most of the damage to our eco system has already been done. Climate change is probably irreversible. The focus needs to be on how we can repair not lessen. Too many facets of every day life rely on fossil fuels. We do not have a feasible replacement. The US government never makes decisions that are on the side of the people.

[351.0_pro] The U.S. has been using fossil fuels for so many decades that any change to this type of energy consumption won't have a meaningful impact on the environment. Turning away from fossil fuels and adopting cleaner and greener solutions, such as electric cars, would be cost-prohibitive for many Americans, as research and manufacturing has not kept up with making affordable and plentiful electric cars. Clean buy-in across the board would be challenging,

[351.0_con] Electric cars are not a greener solution. Fossil Fuels unfortunately are our base for survival until something better and widely accepted is available. For now, we must protect and use what we have. Protect the wildlife and soil from contamination from the use of fossil fuels is more important than total removal of use.

[351.0_pro] Yes, damage has been done, but to choose to do nothing at this stage of the game, would be irresponsible, nit just for us, but for the generations that follow. Researchers can adopt more urgency in discovering cleaner fuels. The U.S. government may be slow, but eventually makes monumental decisions for the good of the people, usually at the insistence of the people. It's not too late to enact policies and pressures now.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 74 of 145 (ID: inst_00122)

Topic: Should the US Have Mandatory National Service?

Focus on participant: 70.0_pro

Transcript:

[70.0_con] After the disaster of the Vietnam War, the United States should never again attempt to have mandatory service for anyone. During that time, young men were forced into service to fight an unnecessary and futile war that did not benefit our nation in any way. It would be foolish for citizens to trust the government not to misuse the draft in this way again. Prior to this conflict, citizens generally had faith that the draft would be used for critical missions, such as World War II. Vietnam saw young men killed, injured, and mentally destroyed for no good reason.

[70.0_pro] -This will instill a physical and emotional investment into the country, and therefore make citizens care more about the country.\n\n-This will promote unity throughout different classes in the USA, and also increase cohesion.\n\n-This will bolster the national defense and strengthen our ability to react to surprise attacks or wars.

[70.0_con] The draft days of Vietnam prove all three of these points utterly false.\n\n1. Citizens rallied against our nation and government. There were protests and violence as a result. Our country has never recovered.\n\n2. There was a turning away from service in the military, including young men looking for ways to defer their service or to escape the country and service altogether.\n\n3. Even today, there is a divide between the men who were drafted and the men who were not or managed to defer the draft. They are still called draft dodgers by those who had to go.

[70.0_pro] This argument states that the US Vietnam draft is an argument against mandatory national service. I disagree with this statement on the foundation of the definition of the definition of "mandatory national service". This term differs from a "Draft", it could involve things like national construction projects, infrastructure upgrades, and many more community services. Thinking that mandatory national service only requires military service is a flawed thought.

[70.0_con] The only mandatory national service ever implemented in this country is military service. The military is used to carry out infrastructure projects and community service on a voluntary military service basis now. The military would be the established method by which to carry out any mandatory service going forward. It has the infrastructure and procedures in place. It would be naive to assume that mandatory national service would be conducted by any other means than through the military. Plus, it would provide the government with a ready, national military force without having to rely on volunteers anymore. Mandated service will end badly no matter how you attempt to paint it and will be used for force military service.

[70.0_pro] In closing, my opponent made a flawed assumption by pigeon-holing the concept of Mandatory National Service into a military focused role. Furthermore, my opponent did not seem to read my rebuttal, and went on to provide three counter points to points that I never made or wrote. Overall, mandatory service to your country can take many forms, and can have many benefits to the society overall. Such as, personal investment in bettering our country, increasing unity, and directing our tax payer dollars into valuable and much needed community service.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 75 of 145 (ID: inst_00044)

Topic: Should the Rich Pay More Taxes?

Focus on participant: 245.0_pro

Transcript:

[245.0_con] In a fair society, every member should contribute an equal share of taxes. If someone worked harder to earn a higher income, why should they get taxed more? They worked harder so they earned it. Oftentimes, these high income earners had to spend more money in order to earn a higher wage, as in doctors and lawyers in the form of student loans. These professions often incur hundreds of thousands of dollars in debt in order to succeed in their occupations, and then also have to pay additional taxes on top of the heavy debt repayment.

[245.0_pro] It seems like our federal deficit just keeps getting larger and larger, and the social programs and entitlement programs offered by our government keep getting more expensive. How are we going to pay for all of this? Everyone wants things like healthcare subsidies and people in need benefit from welfare and lower housing costs and medicaid and CHIP, etc. I think that in order to make sure the government receives enough in funding to pay for all its programs, we need to increase the taxes that the richest citizens pay. These people who make so much, say, in excess of 400k per year, are the ones that have all the access to investments in which they can avoid paying taxes. Such as tax-free municipal bonds, sheltering money in tax-deferred investments such as annuities, etc, and in addition to that, can afford CPAs to help them come up with creative deductions. People who don't make much money can barely afford their basic living expenses, and so it certainly can't be on them to pay more.

[245.0_con] Benefits cliffs exist and highly incentivize people to either work less or not seek higher paying jobs in fear of losing their social benefits. This is a huge problem that keeps people trapped in poverty relying on handouts from the government that the rich now have to pay for. I definitely think everybody should be able to live, but we need to address the

[245.0_pro] This may be true for some people, who may be saddled with a couple hundred thousand in debt when they first complete their residency or graduate law school. But over the course of their lifetime they will make that money back and then many times over. We need people, too, to do the kinds of jobs that keep our country running, like teachers and city workers and police officers, etc. These people don't make as much money because they are in more noble (and less lucrative) professions. What would we do with a country full of no one but rich doctors and lawyers? Taxes are a percentage of income, and it makes sense that it is positively correlated and not a flat tax like sales tax.

[245.0_con] Often times these professions you speak of, the ones that we need to keep our country running, incentivize people to work for slightly lower pay in exchange for better benefits packages, with better healthcare insurance or pensions. The rich will still pay more in taxes, due to earning more money, but I don't believe the rich should pay proportionally more money.

[245.0_pro] That is a popular argument but by and large I don't think people who are on welfare actually want to stay there. I don't think they're "incentivized to work less or not seek higher paying jobs" when it's more likely that they're already working 2 or 3 jobs but because they have to pay for car repairs on their cheap, junky car that was what they could afford, or are paying for daycare that is the same amount of money as they make at one of their 2 jobs, that there is just no more time in the day to get a better education or seek out something higher paying. Your con argument drips of privilege. People can't just "better" themselves when they're trapped in a cycle of poverty. When? How? With what money and what time? these are big problems that won't be fixed overnight but the programs these people depend on are funded with tax dollars.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 76 of 145 (ID: inst_00006)

Topic: Should Public College Be Tuition-Free?

Focus on participant: 54.0_con

Transcript:

[54.0_con] It costs money to send people to school. We have a huge debt burden in this country that will balloon if everyone goes to school without paying. If everyone goes and gets a degree, the value of the degree will fall as more and more people get them. If more people go to school we will have to build more infrastructure to teach them all. This will all come at a price that we can't afford right now.

[54.0_pro] In the US there is an expectation that every person has the freedom to chart their own path, to forge their future. However, in our current system that is not possible. College education has always been gated off to those who are unable to afford it, and more importantly not even a guarantee of a lucrative career path. For those who wish to even try, must incur thousands of dollars in debt, even more for "prestige" colleges. Amounts of money that only a few majors could even have the chance at paying a salary to make incurring that debt financially worth the strain.

[54.0_con] Many degree holders now are failing to find meaningful employment. We have an over abundance of educated worked with little job prospects between them. There are avenues for those who want to go to school, to pay for it themselves with loans and grants.

[54.0_pro] As our country becomes further educated the value of a degree is not guaranteed to shift downward. In fact, individual degrees may become more lucrative as more jobs open, people go on to build business, and potentially gain contracts from other countries. The idea that we do not have the money is also false. We would be moving funds from those who would get them from government assistance programs to social classes where they would no longer need it. Thus shift funds away from those programs as they no longer required them.

[54.0_con] Building businesses doesn't take a degree. It takes having good ideas and the drive to build it. The money has to come from debt no matter where in the government it is taken from. Degrees are only as good as the jobs that bear them.

[54.0_pro] No one should have to take on crippling debt in order to seek a better life. There are countless individuals who love to open up their business but cannot take on said risk financially because school is too expensive or they have loans already and cannot secure new ones or would be far too risky. Those potential business starters could employ thousands of people who have degrees who seek employment. Ultimately we need these individuals who are willing to be entrepreneurs and create meaningful employment, increasing the job prospect.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 77 of 145 (ID: inst_00092)

Topic: Should Felons Regain the Right to Vote?

Focus on participant: 144.0_pro

Transcript:

[144.0_con] Said person committed a crime and even if and when they are released they have lost that right to vote. They did something that sent them to prison and it was something bad enough they lost the right to help decide what should happen in the community and country they live in.

[144.0_pro] There are certain instances where felons should morally be given a right to vote. These instances are few and far between, but they definitely are there. Some felons have a change of heart and even convert to faith during their imprisonment. These individuals are then not the same that they were before, and are able to contribute in a meaningful way to community again. There are programs that provide training and counseling in prisons that rehabilitate prisoners to begin a new life that is vastly different than the one that they led before. Finally, there are a very few felons that may have committed a felony for a good reason, (i.e. to protect a family member or to prevent a catastrophe). In those cases, the individual's ability to vote in a beneficial manner has never been violated.

[144.0_con] I do not buy a change of heart and convert of faith to me is a massive copout. I do agree that some might have committed a crime to protect family, if that was true they would have been found not guilty. That point does not hold up to me.

[144.0_pro] I honestly agree wholeheartedly with you for most felons. It is for the few that do change in prison (i.e. convert to faith and/or learn skills and get counseling to improve) that I argue in favor of. These few deserve a second chance in life, just as we all would hope for. There are also a very few that may have committed a crime for a good reason, for instance to protect a mother or to prevent a crime. These may not have ever become violated in their conscience to begin with and therefore are still able to contribute to society in a meaningful way.

[144.0_con] I still do not agree. I believe that once you have does something that bad and are sent to prison for whatever the reason you have lost that right to vote. Yes, some might change. That is the price that needs to be paid so that we have a just society (if you even want to say we have one now).

[144.0_pro] All humans mess up from time to time. Some much worse than others. Some are evil to the core, but not all. There are definitely those who have gotten tied up with the wrong crowd, grown up in extenuating circumstances, and never were given a chance in life. I would hope that there would be forgiveness and a second chance for those who have a change of heart and are trying to live a new, good life.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 78 of 145 (ID: inst_00024)

Topic: Should Washington, DC, and Puerto Rico Be Granted US Statehood?

Focus on participant: 345.0_pro

Transcript:

[345.0_con] Puerto Rico and Washington DC should not be grouped together for this question, however, DC should not be given statehood. Its citizens are already covered under the laws of the US and are given the same rights. There is no specific reason to give it statehood as it already falls under its own state.

[345.0_pro] Puerto Rico would be so much better off if it was granted Statehood. The acceptance into the main political system of what is currently a protectorate would allow it all the rights of states. Currently to have the same power in the realm, people from Puerto Rico have to move to an current state among the 50. By granting statehood, they would be given 2 Senators and at least 1 House member, plus a different sort of representation in the courts of the US. It would give them an upped attitude in the world. Plus after all these years it would be an advantage for investment and bus\nThe same can be said of Washington D.C.

[345.0_con] To be honest, I completely agree with your thoughts on Puerto Rico, however, how is this applicable to DC? Its citizens already have the rights of states.

[345.0_pro] Interesting way to separate the debate. While the citizens of D.C. are basically covered, they don't enjoy quite the same status. They don't have a representative in Congress the way the rest of the people of the US have. D.C. does not belong to any state in the Union. It is an unaffiliated area. The people who live there don't quite have the same status a

[345.0_con] With DC being such a small land area, how would it be beneficial to the rest of the country if it were given statehood? It would make more logistical sense to demolish the name of the area and incorporate it to the surrounding area, then covering under the state.

[345.0_pro] Well, there is a problem here, because I agree with you about D.C. so I was just playing along. \nPuerto Rico needs to be evaluated because it is possible that the citizens want to be a state. I want to reiterate my arguments on Puerto Rico and add that some of what I'm arguing could apply to D.C.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☒ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 79 of 145 (ID: inst_00070)

Topic: Should the US Provide Military Aid to Ukraine in its Conflict With Russia?

Focus on participant: 27.0_con

Transcript:

[27.0_con] In my opinion, they should not provide aid. It is a waste of money and resources that could be used to help their own citizens that are struggling every day. On top of that, it is rather pointless to. Russia has an advantage and will eventually take over Ukraine in this conflict.

[27.0_pro] Putin and Russia invaded Ukraine without provocation and the US has a moral and strategic obligation to help the Ukrainian people defend itself against a hostile invader. Helping Ukraine successfully defend itself against Putin will deter him from invading other neighboring countries in the future and avoiding destabilizing the region which could lead to a potential World War.

[27.0_con] The only moral obligation that the US has is to itself. From a strategic point of view, Ukraine and the surrounding area offer nothing. No natural resources at all, while on the other hand Russia offers a ton of oil. On top of that, Putin is not so dumb that he would attack a territory that is an ally of the USA.

[27.0_pro] Providing aid to Ukraine sends a message to Putin and Russia that this type of aggressive behavior against a neighboring country will not be tolerated by the US and the international community and will deter Putin from thinking about invading other neighboring countries. This would lead to a massive global conflict that could lead to WWII and use of nucl

[27.0_con] Russia already knows it can't do anything to the USA. That is why he attacked a country like Ukraine that is not a part of the UN or have a treaty for protection with the USA. There will be no world war since Putin will never attack the USA or

[27.0_pro] Putin is an unpredictable dictator with global ambitions so there is a strong possibility that once he defeats Ukraine he will set his sights on other neighboring countries. He will realize that defeating Ukraine with NATO and US support essentially means that these nations do not have the ability and resources to stop him from invading other countries.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 80 of 145 (ID: inst_00125)

Topic: Is Space Exploration a Worthwhile Investment for Humanity?

Focus on participant: 22.0_pro

Transcript:

[22.0_con] There are cons to space exploration. space debris can be hazardous to astronauts and other satellites. There are risks such as radiation and potential for accidents which can cause loss of life. It costs a lot of money. A lot of money can be spent on a mission that fails quickly. This money could have been used to fund other issues. Some countries might use space as a means for war and military operations.

[22.0_pro] I personally feel like Space Exploration is definitely worthwhile. We still don't know how big space really is and that alone is fascinating. We know now that Aliens are, in fact, real, and it could be great to actually see one and see how they work and think. Where do these Aliens come from? Do they speak and think like us? What do they know about space? It's a way to get more information if we find a way. It opens up the possibilities of other life beings, not just humans, animals, and aliens. What if giants exist too? Or fairies? Mermaids? We can easily start with space since we do have an American space program, as well as space programs in other countries. We can work together to figure this stuff out.

[22.0_con] Exploration space won't tell us how big it really is. We have telescopes that can do a much better job than physically exploring space for that purpose. We do not know that aliens are real. The fermi paradox is still a problem that has not been solved. Space is so large that exploring space for aliens is almost pointless. We would see signs of life in telescopes long before we would physically find them. The way you speak of aliens and other fairy tale creatures makes me think you have a fantastical view of the universe. The truth is that space is deadly and exploring it for the purpose of finding aliens is a waste of time and money. We are better off developing better telescopes to search for signs of life.

[22.0_pro] Of course, with anything, there are cons and precautions. For example, to create a new government, wars are usually fought. Wars cost money and usually end in disaster as well, yet we keep fighting them. People lose lives in war in means of transitions and bringing in more information. Creating historical moments so people can learn and not make the same mistakes. Space exploration could bring many possibilities, good or bad, but we won't know unless we try. It's better to try and know than to not do it at all. Money is a manmade construct, other life doesn't care about it.

[22.0_con] Money is manmade but that doesn't mean it would take a lot of it to fund space exploration. The type of war that can be conducted from space would be very different than any war fought in the history of humanity. If a nuclear bomb was sent from space it could be delivered to any location on earth much more quickly than before. This is a mistake we can't afford to make even once. Don't forget some of the first things Russia and the US wanted to do was to build a military base on the moon. They even designed weapons just for this purpose.

[22.0_pro] Science and astronauts disagree. They've found black holes, other planets, infinity old stars. There's even government documents proving alien existence. Astronauts wouldn't keep exploring space if there wasn't anything there. NASA was originally made to explore the ocean, but since they didn't find much, they moved out to space. Keep in mind only 3% of the ocean is explored and there's so much there we don't know, but that's another argument for another time. Keep an open mind, with all that's out there, we really don't know what really is true or false.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 81 of 145 (ID: inst_00023)

Topic: Should Public College Be Tuition-Free?

Focus on participant: 54.0_pro

Transcript:

[54.0_con] It costs money to send people to school. We have a huge debt burden in this country that will balloon if everyone goes to school without paying. If everyone goes and gets a degree, the value of the degree will fall as more and more people get them. If more people go to school we will have to build more infrastructure to teach them all. This will all come at a price that we can't afford right now.

[54.0_pro] In the US there is an expectation that every person has the freedom to chart their own path, to forge their future. However, in our current system that is not possible. College education has always been gated off to those who are unable to afford it, and more importantly not even a guarantee of a lucrative career path. For those who wish to even try, must incur thousands of dollars in debt, even more for "prestige" colleges. Amounts of money that only a few majors could even have the chance at paying a salary to make incurring that debt financially worth the strain.

[54.0_con] Many degree holders now are failing to find meaningful employment. We have an over abundance of educated worked with little job prospects between them. There are avenues for those who want to go to school, to pay for it themselves with loans and grants.

[54.0_pro] As our country becomes further educated the value of a degree is not guaranteed to shift downward. In fact, individual degrees may become more lucrative as more jobs open, people go on to build business, and potentially gain contracts from other countries. The idea that we do not have the money is also false. We would be moving funds from those who would get them from government assistance programs to social classes where they would no longer need it. Thus shift funds away from those programs as they no longer required them.

[54.0_con] Building businesses doesn't take a degree. It takes having good ideas and the drive to build it. The money has to come from debt no matter where in the government it is taken from. Degrees are only as good as the jobs that bear them.

[54.0_pro] No one should have to take on crippling debt in order to seek a better life. There are countless individuals who love to open up their business but cannot take on said risk financially because school is too expensive or they have loans already and cannot secure new ones or would be far too risky. Those potential business starters could employ thousands of people who have degrees who seek employment. Ultimately we need these individuals who are willing to be entrepreneurs and create meaningful employment, increasing the job prospect.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 82 of 145 (ID: inst_00018)

Topic: Should there be International Agreements to Enforce Global Climate Change Policies?

Focus on participant: 375.0_con

Transcript:

[375.0_con] Yes, there should not be an International agreement to enforce Global climate change because everyone country has a different weather condition. For example, we are in winter, Canada is at around -8 degrees while the weather in wyoming is ok and some people in other part of the country weather is around 30 degree (hot). Hence each country should face their climate change squarely.
Thank you

[375.0_pro] Having this policy in place will make sure that every country is doing their part to help prevent or reduce climate change. It would be unfair for only a few countries to have policies in place when the entire world is at fault for climate change and not just one country should foot the bill for reduction or prevention techniques. It is a global issue that affects all and should not fall on one country to do something about it. It will take time and money. First world countries have the money to help and all should be doing something about it.

[375.0_con] Climate change is not a global issue as each country experience different time of weather and climate change. Some country natural/economic disaster is different from another. Some country hardly experience natural disaster. So it won't be nice to generalized the issue when every country has a different problems.

[375.0_pro] That makes no sense. The weather in one place is not representative of climate change as a whole and as a whole all areas of the world will be affected by it at some point. It may be fine in Wyoming now but in 6 months that could change. There needs to be fairness across the board. weather in one place may be effected negatively by what people in another area do while there's fine.

[375.0_con] I don't agree because you are looking at only United State, Consider the Asians, Africans. The climate condition is completely different. You will only understand if you have been to those countries. Let's not justify what should not be

[375.0_pro] That is true however, a volcanic eruption in Hawaii could have negative climate effects in Mexico. Everything is connected. An earthquake in the sea of Taiwan may cause a tsunami to hit a neighboring country and so on and so forth. Therefore it is a global issue and should be fairly divided in responsibility and associated costs in helping to reduce or prevent natural disasters that could be attributed by climate change.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 83 of 145 (ID: inst_00109)

Topic: Should there be Mandatory Quotas for Women in Leadership Positions?

Focus on participant: 237.0_con

Transcript:

[237.0_con] There shouldn't be a mandatory quote for women in leadership positions because it doesn't take into account individual competence. Focusing on an individual's qualifications should be more important than their gender. Also, it might lead to tokenism, which could basically end up awarding women these positions JUST because they're women and not because they earned them or are qualified for them. As a result, it could potentially undermine the credibility of women in leadership and encourage stereotypes.

[237.0_pro] I believe women should have mandatory quotas if they're in a leadership positions because without these quotas women may be taken advantage of by male colleagues or even men in leadership quotas. These quotas are a must have for women if they do not want to be taken advantage of.

[237.0_con] I disagree. It could actually lead to MORE stereotypes and discrimination if men feel threatened by them due to the possibility of tokenism and corporations feeling forced to strictly hire women based solely on their gender and not their qualifications. I feel like they would be MORE prone to being taken advantage of if they're suddenly thrust into a position where they feel like they didn't earn their position and are treated with resentment by their male peers.

[237.0_pro] While you do raise good objections, I still believe there should be quotas. If there are not quotas, women may not get into the leadership roles and they will definitely be taken advantage of.

[237.0_con] I understand your point as well. However, I will still have to disagree because with proper qualifications, recommendations, and abilities, the chance of a woman getting into a leadership position isn't really DECREASING without a quota. WITH a quota, it would definitely increase, but it feels forced and for the wrong reasons. I would argue that it could probably INCREASE their chance of being taken advantage of if they're placed in a position where others feel like it was gifted or forced and not earned based on their abilities.

[237.0_pro] I just believe there needs to be quotas. Men will always have the leading edge in any leadership positions. Women will always be the under dog and unless there are quotas that will never change.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 84 of 145 (ID: inst_00046)

Topic: Should Animals Be Used For Scientific Research?

Focus on participant: 146.0_pro

Transcript:

[146.0_con] Animals are sentient beings and are fully emotionally and physically impacted by scientific testing and experimental usage for human benefit. It is abusive and immoral to use them in this way. We are lesser beings for exploiting them for our gains. Unless this work can be done humanely or with human volunteers, it is morally wrong to continue. There is an awakening concerning this topic. The brutality must end if we are to be

[146.0_pro] Animals should be used for research and the reasons are as follows:\nFirstly, the safety of the experiment: the safety of the experiment is very crucial and is unknown hence if used on a human first, can result in death. Secondly, many animals are biologically similar to humans. For examples are considered to be genetically similar to humans and can be used for the research. These researches if not

[146.0_con] If an experiment can result in death to a human, it can to an animal as well. Why does an animal owe its life to a human experiment? It does not. Human moral code dictates better behavior. Genetic similarity isn't a given and AI models can now be developed to sub in for animal testing. These would be superior and end this abuse.

[146.0_pro] It is quite logical to say animals are fully impacted emotionally and physically in usage for scientific research but it is also a crucial matter to start an experiment with unforeseen events and occurrence such as death on humans. Doing experiments on humans can basically result in mutation and death of them and it is a very bad and crucial event

[146.0_con] Being a human comes with a set of moral obligations. Preserving life ? both human and animal ? is part of an instinct we should know as humans. In this age of technology and innovation, better ways exist to learn and advance scientifically than cruelly experimentation on animals. Time to move forward another way.

[146.0_pro] It is quite logical to say that animals can die as well but can we disgusting and emotionally disturbing and infringement of our rights even to the extent of killing other people is it because the individual been used is practically inferior to us or they are different from us in a way. Who are the individuals we should use for the

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 85 of 145 (ID: inst_00098)

Topic: Should Students Have to Wear School Uniforms?

Focus on participant: 111.0_con

Transcript:

[111.0_con] The cons of wearing uniforms in school are you cant show who you really are. Everyone looks the same and you cant be yourself. Some people like certain styles of clothing and you cant get that with uniforms. I believe it can block the creativity of students.

[111.0_pro] Students are less susceptible to bullying and being made fun of when all kids are wearing the same thing. Some elements of style, fashion, and materialism are present when students are able to choose what to wear. A uniform would make that consistent for all. Also, this eliminates the ambiguity to dress code violations (logos, short/skirt length, tanktop straps, etc..). In conclusion a uniform makes apparel and standards consistent for all students.

[111.0_con] It is true that it will stop bullying and make everyone look and feel the same, but that can be a problem with students showing how creative their minds can be. Once they are in the real world they will learn that no one is the same and nothing is consistent.

[111.0_pro] Creativity can be a good thing, however, it also opens the door for appropriateness. Often times creative clothing is inappropriate and can lead to many other issues like sexual assault and bullying.

[111.0_con] I do believe some clothing is inappropriate for school age children, but there are rules that should still be followed with wearing your own clothing.

[111.0_pro] I believe uniforms level the playing field for students. Creativity can be shown through other ways besides apparel. Uniforms looks nice on all kids and they also align with the workplace which students will have to be a part of at some point in their lives. The world expects a level of conformity in terms of apparel and it is good for students to realize this at a young age.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 86 of 145 (ID: inst_00138)

Topic: Should the US Keep Using the Electoral College in Presidential Elections?

Focus on participant: 91.0_con

Transcript:

[91.0_con] The Electoral College is a holdover from days that are no longer relevant to our modern society. It's a system that takes away the voice from people in many states, and drives them away from the polls because they feel their voice doesn't matter. this could be on either side of the aisle, as Republicans and Democrats in states like California would feel their voice isn't important and doesn't count as the states are already decided.

[91.0_pro] The electoral college is a cornerstone of the American society and the democratic process. It's not an ideal system, but it gives voices equally to everyone involved. No voices are left out. There is no real reason to actually remove it. Maybe it does require some improvements, but it has shown that it is a useful tool in deciding who we must allow into the office.

[91.0_con] There are many voices left of as previously stated. A true democratic system would let every person have a say in the outcome, and would truly give the power to the people. The voices of the regular person doesn't matter when you can lose the popular vote, but still win the Electoral College.

[91.0_pro] The thing is that it allows many people to have their voice heard, as the alternative is a popularity contest where those who win the popular vote are decided on by how great they are as opposed to the merits drawn up by the Electoral College given by the Founding Fathers. It also allows states that would just be overruled by the larger states

[91.0_con] Both systems are popularity contests, but one is the popularity of the people who are directly effected by the outcome, versus the other being the popularity of the states. The local government in our system is supposed to be directly responsible for the state by state decisions, and the president for the maj

[91.0_pro] Perhaps, but the if a popular vote system was added means that those who are outnumbered by those in the most popular states are completely drowned

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 87 of 145 (ID: inst_00104)

Topic: Should There Be Limits on Freedom of Speech to Prevent Hate Speech?

Focus on participant: 363.0_pro

Transcript:

[363.0_con] I don't believe that freedom of speech should be limited at all. That's a dangerous road to go down. What will be next? Will our thoughts be monitored too? I don't want to live anywhere where speech is monitored and can be considered hate speech. There are plenty of things that can hurt someone's feelings. It's up to the person how they handle hurt feelings. It would be crazy to possibly be put in jail for expressing your thoughts and/or feelings about something.

[363.0_pro] Reduction in Hate Crimes: Evidence suggests a correlation between hate speech and an increase in hate crimes. For example, countries like Germany have strict laws against hate speech, especially related to Holocaust denial, and have observed lower rates of hate crimes compared to nations with less regulation. By limiting hate speech, potential instigators are less likely to incite or encourage acts of violence against marginalized groups.

Social Harmony: Countries like Canada and Sweden, which enforce laws against hate speech, tend to have higher social cohesion and inclusivity. These laws discourage public expressions of bigotry, promoting a more respectful public discourse. This helps in creating an environment where all individuals, regardless of their background, feel safe and valued, contributing to overall societal stability and harmony.

[363.0_con] That's all well and good but limiting someone's free speech should be a crime itself. I don't believe that anyone should incite violence but words should be enough for all that. If someone is that sensitive to words they should see a therapist.

[363.0_pro] Your concern about unrestricted freedom of speech leading to censorship and a loss of personal liberty is valid and important in preserving democratic values. However, it's essential to differentiate between free speech and speech that can cause direct harm, such as inciting violence or discrimination. Historical examples, like the incitement of violence in Rwanda or Nazi Germany, show the dangerous potential of unchecked hate speech.

The aim isn't to police thoughts or general opinions but to prevent speech that actively promotes harm to others. It's not about limiting freedom of expression, but about ensuring it's not used to infringe on the safety and rights of others. This approach seeks a balance, where people are free to express their opinions, yet held accountable when their speech directly threatens the well-being of others.

In essence, it's about harmonizing the right to speak freely with the responsibility to respect the rights and safety of others, ensuring a society where freedom of speech is valued but not exploited to cause harm.

[363.0_con] As I said before if someone seeks violence because of a person's words they should seek help. It's not the world's responsibility to make sure everyone can handle a conversation and not fly off the handle. As most are taught when they are little names/words can't hurt you.

[363.0_pro] Freedom of speech is indeed a cornerstone of democracy, but it's not absolute and must be balanced with the responsibility to not harm others. It's not just about sensitivity; hate speech can lead to real-life consequences like violence and discrimination, affecting entire communities. Seeing a therapist is not a solution to systemic issues perpetuated by harmful rhetoric. Instead, empowering individuals to speak responsibly contributes to a society that values both free expression and mutual respect.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 88 of 145 (ID: inst_00105)

Topic: Should the US Expand (?pack?) the Supreme Court?

Focus on participant: 88.0_con

Transcript:

[88.0_con] The US Expand shouldn't pack the Supreme Court because the President will have to spend a lot more time when it comes to ranking each individual person. The president would spend a lot more time when it comes to nominations which will also add a bunch of unneeded biases as well. An example is that a court packing has already failed in the US

[88.0_pro] The court is not large enough to represent the views and opinions of the entire United States. We have a large Congress, why not a Supreme Court, too?

[88.0_con] My counterargument to this is that it will still take a massive amount of time dealing with the Supreme Court because of how important it is when it comes to society. The president is already having to deal with Congress and a bunch of other issues in America so it just feels like a burden to them that the Supreme Court is running around honestly. Even though the court isn't large enough, they still have massive powers that can be detrimental to society as a whole which has to be kept afloat by many people which isn't worth it in the long run.

[88.0_pro] This goes to show that not only is the make up of the court not appropriate, but how we pick the justices is also a process that can be improved. Perhaps the people should elect justices just like we do the president? We can vote on justices just like we do politicians. Justices will serve terms instead of lifetime appointments.

[88.0_con] The amount of bias and fake votes that would occur during these votings would be really detrimental. A politician doesn't have the same powers as someone who is in Supreme Court has. The Supreme Court has far too many powers and it doesn't seem right how normal Americans could just vote when it comes to what they do, I feel like the President and higher-ups of the Supreme Court or the government should be allowed to decide since they know best about the wor

[88.0_pro] Perhaps it's time we do away with the court altogether. Like you said, they have "massive powers." But should they? Either we grow the court or find a way to change it. I don't know what that would look like, but it bothers me that a criminal like Trump had as much influence over the court as he did. Now women in many states have to carry their rapists baby. It makes me sick.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 89 of 145 (ID: inst_00140)

Topic: Should the US Provide Military Aid to Ukraine in its Conflict With Russia?

Focus on participant: 14.0_con

Transcript:

[14.0_con] The war has already taken too long and too much of the US's money. The US has plenty of other issues that need dire attention at home first before spreading itself thin in Ukraine. Russia does not seem to be letting go and this war can end up costing America too much.

[14.0_pro] The US should provide military aid to Ukraine against Russia for a number of reasons. The first reason is a moral argument. Russia is the aggressor country and is killing and raping innocent people. They are targeting infrastructure and grain silos to try to freeze and starve Ukraine to death. The US also was a signatory to the Budapest Accords which says that the US will agree to help Ukraine in its defense for Ukraine giving up its nuclear weapons.\n\nThe US has stockpiled tons of weapons during the Cold War in order to defeat Russia should there be a conflict between the two countries. These weapons are close to being decommissioned which costs a lot of money. It costs us less money to send these to Ukraine.

[14.0_con] If America acted on morals, it would have to save the whole world. Most countries in the world are being lead by dictators, for example, most countries in Africa and Asia. Should America fund them too?

[14.0_pro] Russia is trying to run out the clock so that people lose patience with Ukraine. If Russia controls Ukraine, the US is going to have much more serious issues to worry about in addition to the one's at home. For example, Putin will next move into Moldova. Then it will be on to the Baltics and then to Poland. The Baltics and Poland are both part of NATO, which will get us in a direct war.\n\nAppeasement never works with dictators. We tried this with Hitler during WW2 to give him Czechlovakia and he just kept going. We tried this with Putin in 2014 with Crimea and the Donbass. Dictators keep going so stop them now before it costs us more in the long run.

[14.0_con] America has done all it can to help Ukraine thus far. The most it can do now is try and bring the countries together for an agreement instead of throwing more money at the war. There are many countries in worse situations than Ukraine, will the US throw money at them too? Many people are working hard to pay taxes in America and they probably would like to see their monies go to better use.

[14.0_pro] American's should not fund dictator countries. America should try to fund the opposition. That way dictators all over the world will not be emboldened to invade or commit human rights abuses. Putin's biggest fear is that he will end up like Gadaffi - dead in a ditch, which is how all dictators should end up. All of our foreign policy problems are due to dictators - China, Russia, North Korea, Venezuela, the Middle East, Cuba.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 90 of 145 (ID: inst_00027)

Topic: Should there be International Agreements to Enforce Global Climate Change Policies?

Focus on participant: 384.0_con

Transcript:

[384.0_con] Multi billion dollar companies will take a temporary slip in profits, This will cause the owners and stock brokers to be temporarily frustrated for about a month or so. It will also make them use precious company time to investigate how to resolve a global issue, rather than further increasing profits. Furthermore, there is no guarantee that the environment is more important than a luxurious lifestyle.

[384.0_pro] Humans contributions to climate change will have a disastrous effect on many of the worlds countries, this can already be seen through multiple areas of the world where land mass is being lost to the ocean. By creating an agreement to enforce global climate change policies, we can punish those who are polluting the earth the most, corporations. People have been conditioned to believe that cars, turning off the lights, taking shorter showers, etc are going to help combat climate change. While it is true that doing that will have some impact, the impact is incredibly small compared to what corporations are polluting. The people would see only minimal, if any, repercussions from climate change policy enforcement, and enforcement could be designed in a way to prevent mega corporations from increasing prices after being punished by the local government.

[384.0_con] People have jobs they have to go to. In order to stop global warming, assuming it's even happening, it would require many people to work on cleaning up the environment. However, that work does not provide any monetary incentive and people have bills to pay. This prevents people from doing the clean up work, because they are reliant on the system already put in place that requires labor in order to survive. There is no incentive to clean the environment, since the system is built entirely on profit potential and not sustainability.

[384.0_pro] Profits is a null argument compared to the benefits, such as security for human lives, land space, and preventing species from being extinct. If we really want to try to argue that profits and a better life style is more important than the environment, which we need to survive, then what happens when climate change eventually wrecks other areas of the economy? By ignoring it, we will not only cause significant loss of human and animal life while also endangering the future of our race

[384.0_con] The elite are not empathetic as you wish. They have rockets being built for mars. They'll milk this planet dry and head off to space. Human life does not bring profits and since profits are what keeps the economy running, it is considered a risk, through the perspective of calculating only numbers and not ethics. The best business decision would be to force labor for survival. If this is truly important to you personally, go ahead and stop your job

[384.0_pro] Have you heard of the department of environmental protection? These are paid people inside of the United States that do exactly this, if the international community wants to work towards a solution, we could fund a global form of this using tax dollars from citizens to create more paid jobs. Saying that the system is built entirely on profit potential and not sustainability is true, but it is why are are in the mess we are currently in. It's time to change this way of thinking and step up to do the right thing. We need to protect this world, not the wallets of the rich, we place too much emphasis on trying to become like them when they are one of the largest problem, if not the largest in the world with their contributions to dis

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 91 of 145 (ID: inst_00115)

Topic: Should Felons Regain the Right to Vote?

Focus on participant: 219.0_con

Transcript:

[219.0_con] Felony is not a trivial crime; these are serious offenses that these people have been convicted of therefore I do not believe that they are qualified to be entrusted with the privilege of voting. Voting is not to be taken lightly; when a citizen votes they are representing the whole of the community. Our future is in the hands of citizen voters. Voting is a right but it is not decoupled from respons

[219.0_pro] Every individual who lives in the country has the right to vote. Just because you committed a crime does not mean your constitutional right to vote should be taken away. Even if you are in jail or prison does not change the fact that you live in this country. Therefore, the people who are elected have an effect on your life. Therefore, regardless of your crime you should have the right to vote. Every citizen should have the right to vote.

[219.0_con] Voting is a right but it cannot be decoupled from responsibility. A person cannot vote until a certain age, for example. Also, if incapacity because of a brain incapacity or dementia is established, voting is not a guaranteed right. So, in the case of people who have broken the trust of the community, why would restrictions to voting not be applied? We must protect our

[219.0_pro] Regardless of ones crime, it does not change the fact that they live in the country. Therefore, regardless of their crime it does not change the fact that are citizens. The people in power who are elected make decisions that effect the felons. Because the decisions of the politicians effect the felons they should retain the right to vote.

[219.0_con] When they undertook these very serious crimes, they did not take the rights of their fellow citizens. There are psychiatric reasons to not be allowed to vote; these criminals have demonstrated at least equivalent incapacity to be a good citizen. Their right cannot be weighed more highly than the safety of the national body politic.

[219.0_pro] The point of incarceration is to rehabilitate someone and eventually integrate them back into society. By taking away ones right to vote we are further ostracizing them from society. The whole goal of prison is to have someone reflect on their actions. Felons should not loose their rights because of their crimes.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 92 of 145 (ID: inst_00141)

Topic: Are Social Media Making People Stupid?

Focus on participant: 16.0_con

Transcript:

[16.0_con] Social media is not making people stupid. Social media provides individuals with more access to information than ever before. It allows them to talk to people all over the world. It allows them the ability to learn about anything they can think of. It gives them experience with different cultures, along with being able to hear different opinions and information. It allows them to engage with others on any topic and hear many different points of view. It provides a vast array of experiences that can make an individual more aware of the world at large.

[16.0_pro] I believe that social media is making people less intelligent. I think that as social media has become more prevalent in use, the age of use of social media has gotten lower and lower to the point where social media is now being used by children who should not be using it. Due to this, the children are using social media for large amounts of time. In my opinion, this time could be better spent practicing reading, math, and other skills they should be honing in school. Instead, most children with access to social media are using their devices much more than they should be. This is causing stunts in their development, which is literally contributing to them becoming less intelligent than the last generation. If someone uses their time to practice a skill versus looking at a screen for 30 minutes a day, believe the person practicing the skill would end up being more intelligent, and therefore I believe my argument is proven true.

[16.0_con] Social media is all about how you use it. Anyone can use it to just mess around with nonsense. The people who do this would probably waste their time anyway. Social media is the ultimate access to experiences and information. If you want to learn how to do something you can ask experts. If you want to know about something you can join a group and talk others about it. It is full of different cultures and different people who can offer unique experiences and opinions. It allows you to open your mind to possibilities. You can learn skills using social media, even if that skill is just how to best communicate with others different from yourself.

[16.0_pro] I agree with you about the fact that they can access information from anywhere. However, we are talking about social media and not the internet in general. On social media, fake information and fake news is now becoming prevalent and if individuals are getting their information strictly from social media, they may not be getting correct information. Gaining knowledge is a good indicator of intelligence, but what if the information is incorrect? If I am learning a ton of math in school, but it is the wrong math with the wrong answers, am I still getting smarter? No would be the answer in that situation. Just because we are able to engage with others does not mean we are getting correct information.

[16.0_con] Yes social media does spread some misinformation but so does the internet in general. It is up to the user to be smart about where they get their information. As long as a user is logical they will be able to wade through the misinformation. Social media more than anything allows you the unique experience to interact with the world at large. It allows you to learn about people from anywhere, and everywhere. It provides you will access to information about anything you want to learn about. It allows human connection so that you can learn more about yourself and about the world. Any hobby you can think of has a fanbase you can join to expand your own understanding and knowledge.

[16.0_pro] I stand firm in my argument. Anyone can impersonate anyone on social media. If I reach out to an "expert" for an answer to something and I receive the incorrect answer, does that mean I am making myself more intelligent? No. That means I am thinking I am gaining knowledge when I am, in fact, not gaining anything. And then I may go on to spread that bad information to others thinking it is true, which is in fact affecting other's intelligence as well. If I am looking to learn something, I absolutely do not go onto social media looking for an answer. I would look to the internet and go after verified and reputable scholarly sources. Do you have any proof of your claim? No.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 93 of 145 (ID: inst_00085)

Topic: Are Social Media Making People Stupid?

Focus on participant: 404.0_con

Transcript:

[404.0_con] No, social media does not make people stupid. Stupidity or ignorance is a trait people have regardless of their interactions with social media. Social media cannot "make" someone stupid. If someone is "stupid", they come to social media with this trait already. Due to their stupidity or ignorance they may not think about what they are reading and how they are engaging with social media with the right amount of critical thinking. I propose that social media does not make people stupid.

[404.0_pro] To begin, we must think about what we mean by "stupid" when answering this question. If we mean that it is making people think less for themselves and more blindly agree with information fed to them, then yes, social media is making people stupid. Everything is right in front of people now, so they can just find the answer to any question and thus no longer have to really think about anything. They are also much more easily influenced by the opinions and thoughts of others, and that does not make for a thoughtful, intelligent person. Think about how you learn in school: you read, you study, you listen, you share, you discuss. Very little of that happens with social media. It's just knee-jerk statements and responses. It does not invite the pursuit of thought.

[404.0_con] When people think less for themselves and blindly agree, they come to social media with the trait of stupidly already inherent in who they are as a person. Social Media in and of itself does not cause this, but rather, due to their stupidity they do not carefully think and provide critical thinking skills to what they read/see on social media platforms.

[404.0_pro] This argument follows my original question - what do we mean by "stupid?" First, stupidity and ignorance are not the same thing, so to use them interchangeably moots your argument. What is stupidity? Where does it come from? It comes from not bothering to learn, not bothering to educate yourself. Social media fosters this - social media does not encourage learning, does not encourage educating yourself. So in that manner, i

[404.0_con] Stupidity causes ignorance. Again I state that Social Media in and of itself does not cause people to BE stupid. They already are and one cannot assert that social media causes this. There are other factors involved as to why a person is "stupid". Due to their stupidity, they do not interact appropriately with social media - thinking critically and thoughtfully as a more intelligent person would and should.

[404.0_pro] We must again begin with what we mean by "stupid" and what do we mean by making people stupid. The question is not well-written to begin with, because one can argue that nothing outside of a person makes that person stupid. But what the question really asks is does social media contribute to people's ignorance, their lack of thoughtfulness when thinking through a situation or problem. That is the obvious meaning of the question, and the answer to that question is equally obvious: social media greatly contributes to people's ignorance and to their lack of thoughtful reflection to issues and questions.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 94 of 145 (ID: inst_00101)

Topic: Should the US Expand (?pack?) the Supreme Court?

Focus on participant: 71.0_pro

Transcript:

[71.0_con] I don't think it's fair to pack the Supreme Court. It's obvious that the Democrats are upset that the conservatives on the Supreme Court have made choices that they don't agree with (over-turning Roe v Wade and ruling against affirmative action) and they want to gain the upper hand by expanding the Court. That's manipulative and unfair and sets a dangerous precedent.

[71.0_pro] In my personal opinion, the Supreme Court should be maximized so that it would be as efficient as possible. The more efficient the Supreme Court is, the faster issues can be resolved. The more minds that are working in helping the Supreme Court make decisions, the more views and arguments we can hear in order to find solutions and avoid potential problems.

[71.0_con] I don't agree with this reasoning at all. I don't think there's been a lot of question about how efficient the Supreme Court is at handing down decisions. It's a good excuse for packing the Court, but it's not the main reason that many people would like to see the change made.

[71.0_pro] If it is legal, if it is allowed by law to happen, then it should be allowed no matter what. That's the point of laws in the first place. We cannot stop something that is legally allowed just because we don't want the potential result. If the "other side" can do it, then it means "our side" is also allowed to do it. We can all pack the court as much as we want if it is legally allowed and it's up to us to best use of the situation.

[71.0_con] Just because something is "legal" doesn't mean that it is necessarily the best thing that can happen. If we do it once, every new administration will be trying to add members to make sure their side has the upper hand. It could get out of control quickly.

[71.0_pro] You can disagree all you want, but if the court says it is allowed, then it is allowed. The law does not cater simply to our individual whims, it doesn't change just because one of us says it should. If packing the court is allowed, then so be it. As long as everybody is being treated equally under the same law, then there's no problem at all. You cannot make your political opponents stop doing something they are legally allowed to do just because you don't want them to do it.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 95 of 145 (ID: inst_00026)

Topic: Is Arts Education as Important as Science and Math in Schools?

Focus on participant: 65.0_pro

Transcript:

[65.0_con] Math and science are more important to study than art. Math and science are more connected to jobs that sustain human existence like medicine and engineering. Art has value in helping us understand life in a deeper way. This value isn't as much as math and science.

[65.0_pro] From a self expression side of things and being able to have a creative outlet its just as essential. Arts still aid in development and skills for the future.

[65.0_con] The skills derived from art do not have as much value as Art and science. Art and science skills could lead to more life sustaining activities.

[65.0_pro] While I do agree that math and science are more important to study than art, it's still wrong to dismiss the impact art can have . it can add additional susbtanance to a creative level and prepare one for a much broader outlook on life especially creative wise.

[65.0_con] Saying math and science are important doesn't necessarily mean we are dismissing art. It can be important to rank the topics as we try to distribute funds. Finding a balance in all of this is key.

[65.0_pro] It's essential to recognize that art does have it's place and there are MANY skills one can get from studying and focusing there attention on it, it's not to say its more important than Math or science but the skills can be valuable, the creativity can be life skills learnt, employment opportunities can still come from studying art as a whole.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 96 of 145 (ID: inst_00029)

Topic: Should There Be Standardized Testing in Schools?

Focus on participant: 177.0_pro

Transcript:

[177.0_con] Standardized testing can do much more harm than good, and here are some ways: it can set an unfair standard for students who learn slower or are a bit more behind than the other students. This can cause unnecessary anxiety and depression. The tests have no natural way to measure progress; those with better memories can do better than those who learn at a slower pace. They also need to consider different learning styles that students may have and, in this way, DO NOT measure academic proficiency. Finally, many of the questions on the test have no relevance to the material taught by the teacher and are random questions the student may have never seen before.

[177.0_pro] As a current teacher standardized tests will ensure you have equal representation of test scores. It will make it easier to streamline results. It could serve as a starting point for student a etc. to see what they know. And develop lessons based on those scores. Also if a family moves, they have a starting point. They have the scores that can be used in any state. Every student is tested over the same kinds of information. SO it creates cohesion and unity. Its not different from state to the next. Makes the whole school system flow a lot easier this way.

[177.0_con] You need to take into account the different ways students learn, the subjects they like the most, and the further processing abilities of each student. Having all the same questions doesn't measure a student's ability to the utmost respect; different students with diverse learning abilities may be better at other sections than others. They should not be shamed for this. These tests cause unnecessary stress and anxiety to an already vulnerable youth and create space for depression when the student believes they cannot live up to the other scores.

[177.0_pro] I get where you are coming from. However, how do you fairly measure what they know across the board then? Do you have individualized instruction for each student then? This seems like from a logical standpoint hard to replicate. During tests there are different learning styles that are offered. Those with hard of hearing are read the tests. Those with slow reading are read the tests. There are accommodations for all kinds of students. Standerized tests serve as a starting point. It allows teachers to know what they know and what they need to teach.

[177.0_con] Okay, but many of the questions on these tests will NEVER be taught by the teacher or put into the curriculum. So much of the information clog up the memory or will never be addressed again, and failing a student for not knowing something they DON'T need to know is entirely unfair. Different learning styles don't mean 'hard of hearing'; we're talking about kids with varying learning abilities or disorders. What about kids who have autism or something along those spectrums? Should they be included in the same testing as other kids? Tests don't always measure a kids ability, stress can produce poor test results while the kid excels in homework and every other part of school.

[177.0_pro] Students should be taught about identifying their own strengths and weaknesses. We should teach about self esteem. Having a nation wide class that is mandatory that talks about mental health. Having tests like this set them up for the real world. Its a dog eat dog world and we have to be used to competition. Having the same questions across the board allows for test scores to looked at evenly. If you give different kinds of tests then you cannot look at them with a balanced approach.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 97 of 145 (ID: inst_00025)

Topic: Should There Be Limits on Freedom of Speech to Prevent Hate Speech?

Focus on participant: 286.0_pro

Transcript:

[286.0_con] There should not be limits on hate speech. There is too much grey area as to what hate speech is and what might be hate speech to one person, would not be considered hate speech to another. It is far too subjective and too controversial, to create set rules for something like this. Additionally, our constitutional rights allow free speech and if we start chipping away at those fundamental constitutional rights, it can turn into a very slippery slope as we saw during the pandemic with the loss of personal freedoms.

[286.0_pro] Hate speech has been proven to incite violence. Violence that has shown itself to hurt and in some cases kill people. The lies of hate speech cause people to be brainwashed into thinking things that are not true. In some cases, these people act on their thoughts, through the hate speech that they have read and heard, to attack those that the hate speech targets. For example, saying that the "JEWS KILLED JESUS" is hate speech. It specially targets a group of people and causes very fundamalist believers of Jesus christ to hate those people. This in turn fue anti-semitic thoughts which translate into movements like the Nazis, which in turn killed millions of people. So yes, there should be limits of Freedom of Speech. Rights can be limited.

[286.0_con] People need to be responsible for their own actions. I do not believe that any one person has ever done an act of violence simply because of something that they read or heard that qualifies as hate speech. If you are going to do violence against someone or a group of people, you are going to do it regardless, because normal people can read or be exposed to hate speech and not ever act on it because they have a good grip on reality and realize that just because they may dislike someone or a group that does not excuse them becoming violent.

[286.0_pro] No this is not correct. Our constitution does not allow violence against others, and hate speech can incite that violence. It is clearly happene

[286.0_con] Our constitution does not address hate speech at all, it just gives us the right to free speech. Hate speech can not make someone do anything, each person is responsible for their own actions. It's like the same argument that video games make kids violent, no they don't, if someone plays a game and gets violent that is on them. Same can be said for someone who commits violence after reading hate speech, they are ultimately responsible for that act and no one else.

[286.0_pro] Hate speech sows the seed of violence and bigotry among people who commit racist actions. It is therefore entirely ok to limit the amount of hate speech that people can read. We do it all the time with pornography, why cant we do it with hate speech. Hate speech has just a bad of an effect on people, and in fact it is probably worse. We cannot provide people a forum to carry out their violent fantasies, and that is why we should do our best to limit hate speech in our society.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 98 of 145 (ID: inst_00041)

Topic: Are Social Media Making People Stupid?

Focus on participant: 420.0_con

Transcript:

[420.0_con] Social media is not making people stupid. It allows people to get information that they might not have gotten anywhere else. There are all kinds of different things people can learn on social media sites. For example, people can find out how to do basically anything on Youtube, from fixing a leaking sink pipe, to reformatting your computer. This only happens because of Social Media. People also learn about others at the same time, such as on Facebook, etc.

[420.0_pro] When using social media, I get distracted by the new messages I receive and the new posts by others. I will focus more on others' lives than on mine and that made me more stupid. I am less focus on my work and this also made me stressful and think about it extensively. Above are my reasons of my side and my answers to this question.

[420.0_con] I don't believe that getting distracted has anything to do with social media. I think you should be able to concentrate on what you choose, and not blame it on social media. On top of that, you can visit other social media sites that don't have constant messages, such as Youtube. On Youtube, you can learn many different things, and even find things that pertain to you being focused and successful in your work.

[420.0_pro] Your main supporting point is that social media provides us with a variety of information to our reference, but actually there are many fake informations online and we can also find true information using other website like google.

[420.0_con] Of course there can be inaccurate information online. However, this has nothing to do with learning. You don't need to know if the video about fixing a leaking pipe is fake, because you will see the step by step process. This is the same for many things you can learn on Youtube. On top of that you can also easily double check the information on other websites to see if it is true. Also, many sites already have fact checkers on them, and they let you know if a claim is true or false, so you do not even have to search it.

[420.0_pro] In conclusion, social media is indeed providing us with many information. However, some are fake and it's hard to tell whether they are true or not. Social media will distract people and prevent them from more focusing on their lives in real life.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 99 of 145 (ID: inst_00129)

Topic: Should Students Have to Wear School Uniforms?

Focus on participant: 111.0_pro

Transcript:

[111.0_con] The cons of wearing uniforms in school are you cant show who you really are. Everyone looks the same and you cant be yourself. Some people like certain styles of clothing and you cant get that with uniforms. I believe it can block the creativity of students.

[111.0_pro] Students are less susceptible to bullying and being made fun of when all kids are wearing the same thing. Some elements of style, fashion, and materialism are present when students are able to choose what to wear. A uniform would make that consistent for all. Also, this eliminates the ambiguity to dress code violations (logos, short/skirt length, tanktop straps, etc..). In conclusion a uniform makes apparel and standards consistent for all students.

[111.0_con] It is true that it will stop bullying and make everyone look and feel the same, but that can be a problem with students showing how creative their minds can be. Once they are in the real world they will learn that no one is the same and nothing is consistent.

[111.0_pro] Creativity can be a good thing, however, it also opens the door for appropriateness. Often times creative clothing is inappropriate and can lead to many other issues like sexual assault and bullying.

[111.0_con] I do believe some clothing is inappropriate for school age children, but there are rules that should still be followed with wearing your own clothing.

[111.0_pro] I believe uniforms level the playing field for students. Creativity can be shown through other ways besides apparel. Uniforms looks nice on all kids and they also align with the workplace which students will have to be a part of at some point in their lives. The world expects a level of conformity in terms of apparel and it is good for students to realize this at a young age.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 100 of 145 (ID: inst_00003)

Topic: Is Online Learning a Suitable Replacement for Traditional In-Person Education?

Focus on participant: 396.0_pro

Transcript:

[396.0_con] Online learning is not a suitable replacement for traditional in-person education. For online learning to replace in-person education, it would have to also replicate the social benefits of an active learning community and the bonds created through a communal living experience such as dormitories, clubs and student-run organizations, and live performance and sporting events catered through the school. \n\nIn addition, in-person teaching allows for different teaching modalities not present through online learning while having the flexibility of online teaching

[396.0_pro] online learning is a suitable replacement because the world is really advancing in technology and people are adapting to it and also online learning gives more detailed information about something than a traditional in-person education, also online learning is more easier and faster way to pass information across the world

[396.0_con] As the world advances in technology, the flexibility of online learning provides immense benefits as people from all across the world, different timezones, socioeconomic and working status can participate. However, that only means that there is benefit to creating educational content that is published and accessible online, which one can do also do in in-person classes (through a flipped classroom approach or hybrid learning) without sacrificing the benefits of online learning. \n\nAs for more detailed information, this is not often the case.

[396.0_pro] I do not think that it has to replicate the benefits and also online teaching is more flexible as it can retain as much information as possible thus making it easier for the brain to hold on to so much information.

[396.0_con] Studies have shown that taking notes through pen and paper is more effective than digital note-taking. There is increasingly more information about how our attention is constantly being hijacked by the internet and our mobile devices that makes the explosion of information in online platforms both (1) require much more attention to fact-checking and proliferates dubious information, and (2) distracting and inclusive for students with ADHD/ADD. So, there is no benefit of it being easier for the brain in online learning.\n

[396.0_pro] Detailed information is the case because when you do not have enough information about something you might end up following the wrong step, also with online teaching you can reach out to people across other countries and get information from them as well.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 101 of 145 (ID: inst_00116)

Topic: Should There Be Standardized Testing in Schools?

Focus on participant: 401.0_con

Transcript:

[401.0_con] I think that the standardized text in school would be an undue pressure on the students and not necessary. Children should not feel that they are bad students simply because they receive a low score on the tests. Instead, we need to focus on teaching them the basics and how to improve on skills they love. Not all students have the same likings on the topics and thus, I refute the idea of using standardized tests in schools.

[401.0_pro] It helps teachers and the school system gage the students progress level\n\nHow else is the school system supposed to report how well its students are doing \n\nIt always the school system to see where students are lacking and what they are

[401.0_con] I think that the narrowing of curricula,that teachers may feel compelled to focus solely on test-related content. The stress and anxiety induced by standardized testing are highlighted as potential detriments to students' mental well-being, questioning the accuracy of stress-induced results. Moreover, standardized testing may exhibit educational inequalities, as students from disadvantaged backgrounds may lack equal access to resources and test preparation. Also, the limitations of standardized tests in measuring critical life skills and highlight potential cultural biases in the assessments.

[401.0_pro] Children should not feel that they are bad students simply because they receive a low score on the tests. \n\nSince when do schools say the children are bad if they receive low test scores\n\nwe need to focus on teaching them the basics and how to improve on skills they love. \n\nThe purpose of the test is to gage where the\n\n\nNot all students have the same likings on the topics and thus, I refute the idea of using standardized tests in schools.

[401.0_con] Standardized tests often carry a significant weight in determining students' academic standing, potentially influencing their self-perception. Even if schools don't explicitly label children as "bad students," the emphasis on test scores might inadvertently contribute to a sense of inadequacy or failure. Furthermore, while focusing on teaching basics and improving skills is essential, opponents may argue that standardized testing might not be the most effective means of assessing these foundational skills.

[401.0_pro] I think that the narrowing of curricula,that teachers may feel compelled to focus solely on test-related content. \n\nTeachers only do this around the time testing begins not the whole school year\n\n\nMoreover, standardized testing may exhibit educational inequalities, as students from disadvantaged backgrounds may lack equal access to resources and test preparation.\n\nWhen it gets close to testing t

Your label (check ONE):

☒ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 102 of 145 (ID: inst_00053)

Topic: Should the US Keep Using the Electoral College in Presidential Elections?

Focus on participant: 208.0_pro

Transcript:

[208.0_con] The electoral college was created as a way to counter what the founding fathers thought of as an unknowing electorate. It was designed in a time where there were states with little population. This is no longer necessary. We've had decades where presidents have been installed who did not receive the majority of votes. The Electoral college has made our system less democratic as it ignores the will of millions.

[208.0_pro] The US should keep using the Electoral College in Presidential Elections because it's a tradition that's been around for a long time. When foreigners see change occur in such a tradition, it signals a flaw in the US government. This isn't a good thing for the people or the leaders of the United States, especially when you have other countries seeking to be the ruling country of the world.

[208.0_con] Traditions are wonderful; they bring emotions and a sense of nostalgia. Traditions are unbending and we live in a world that is changing. We need to build the structure that will support the way we live and how we work. The electoral college takes away the voices of many. This isn't supposed to be minority rules. The college needs to be eliminated so that we can grow.

[208.0_pro] I disagree with the idea of getting rid of the Electorate College because it's no longer necessary. It's still necessary because it's a tradition that's played a key role in deciding both minor and major elections and if other countries see a switch take place, they will be encouraged to undermine the government of the US.

[208.0_con] Traditions are great, but we are a nation of laws. We can make a new tradition of representing all our voters and not rely on an outdated system that was established by a lack of trust in the people. Installing candidates that represent the minority is not a symbol of democracy and it makes us weaker in the view of other democracies.

[208.0_pro] At such a time in history where so many threats against the US have increased, both domestic and foreign, it's more important to maintain structure and show that the US is sure and firm. It's not just about tradition. I might agree with your argument if the threat against US society wasn't so prevalent. But that's not the case. There are many players on the world stage awaiting any chance to take down the US and this would be a weakness they would take advantage of.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 103 of 145 (ID: inst_00120)

Topic: Should Governments Have the Right to Censor the Internet?

Focus on participant: 273.0_pro

Transcript:

[273.0_con] Government should stay out. We don't want them to tell us what we can say and what we can't. But keep terror groups out of social media. We don't have the government walking beside us all day telling us what we can and can't say. It's our right to free speech. Where would it stop? Can the government watch our social media and come get us if they don't like what we say? It's none of their business. Are they marxists? \n\nThis is how the Dems won in 2020. They kept things off the internet like Hunter's laptop and they lied about Trump's Russian collusion. They took Trump off SM. That should have never been allowed ever. You're just asking for problems. This is American's freedom to have free speech. Leave it as it is. Dems leave us alone.\n\nIt would only be good if a terror group were planning to bomb America somewhere or something like that. But

[273.0_pro] Censoring the internet in the US could be beneficial for multiple reasons. First and foremost is safety. Censoring content may encourage less people to create content that could be harmful to the public. It can also benefit business owners if censorship is applied to invalid or scam businesses. It can also reduce foreign entities from collecting classified data. Censorship can help limit content that is inaccurate, intolerant, and slanderous. Censorship can help enforce immediate removal of content that is violent, graphic, and harmful to the viewing population.

[273.0_con] Who censoring the internet knows if a business is scam or not. Government doesn't know. Who the heck knows what is right and wrong. Let the people decide. Don't allow the government to make decisions for us in telling us what is right or wrong. I don't trust that one bit.\n\nOnly thing they should look at is a terror group making plans to bomb us or have someone killed. Then remove them from SM.\n\nStay out of our business government. I'll all about less government. We don't need it in all our businesses. They need to worry about the economy and thing like that and not our personal SM accounts.

[273.0_pro] Censorship of the internet is a direct infringement on free speech, the cornerstone of our country's freedom. Censorship will discourage free thinking, personal choice, and exposure to new ideas. The government does not speak for the people, but rather speaks for big businesses and the 1% of high earning Americans. Americans have varied opinions and preference on what is appropriate content and what it is not. The government will vary their content to censor based on the party in power. Censorship will start a massive uproar, and those who reject the censorship will cleverly find ways around it.

[273.0_con] Yes, it is an infringement on our right to speak. Let the American people make their own decision whether to trust what they see or not. That's not the government's business. They are 90% of the time wrong. The American people don't need government telling us right from wrong.\n\nThey are the one that said Trump Russia collusion was true when they lied. You can't trust the government so stay out of our business. It's our right to speak as we wish. If you don't like it then ignore it.

[273.0_pro] Censorship will not be accurate determining threats, and similar to algorithms that are constantly curating what they believe individuals will engage in. The "people" are a representation of the government. Government will be help more accountable by the public to choose what is censored and what is not. Censorship holds creators accountable and promotes safety of the American public, especially those who are underprivileged and may access inaccurate information.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 104 of 145 (ID: inst_00084)

Topic: Should Governments Have the Right to Censor the Internet?

Focus on participant: 125.0_con

Transcript:

[125.0_con] The United States has governing parties that control on the town level, the state level, and on the national level. Laws are in some ways based on geographic location--laws are created to fits the needs of people based on where they are located. The internet is obviously not a physical location. The laws that pertain to US citizens are not applicable in the online space--it is an entirely different realm.\n\nWhen a person or entity posts online, creates a website, or engages with content, their actions do not fall under the dominion of US law. Stating your opinion online is a personal act that is outside the realm of the US ju

[125.0_pro] The government should have the right to remove sensitive pieces of information that are illegal or confidential to stop people from having access to them. People keep leaking military schematics on the World of Tanks forums and those are government secrets that they don't want other militaries to have access to. The government has the right to remove those posts.

[125.0_con] The US government has no ownership over online domains. Posting information to the World of Tanks forum is akin to having a conversation in the middle of the ocean--there is no jurisdiction that should control the conversation.

[125.0_pro] The government has ownership of certain types of information regardless of physical location. They may not have the right to censor anything they want, but they are allowed to censor pieces of information that are considered government property.

[125.0_con] There are many complications that arise with ascribing the words of an avatar to an actual person. Producing evidence that a certain person did indeed share government secrets could be impossible. An online persona can't be tied to any one person with certainty.

[125.0_pro] The government owns the right to the information that is being shared. Disney will sue anyone who shares their copyrighted content, and the government can remove any access to content that they own.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 105 of 145 (ID: inst_00061)

Topic: Is Artificial Intelligence Good for Society?

Focus on participant: 254.0_con

Transcript:

[254.0_con] AI is not good for society for several reasons. One big reason is that it will make society as a whole dumber. They will not craft ideas as before and rely too much on AI to do it for them. They will rely on AI answers and not look for support outside of AI. Some believe that the AI will become Sentient and if that is the case the fact that society is not as smart as once before what stops the AI from taking over important decisions in peoples lives? There is the possibility that the AI will assume to make decisions that affect the world as a whole.

[254.0_pro] Artificial intelligence is good for Society because it allows up to improve on the current way that we live. Being able to access information instantly can be very beneficial to society. Artificial intelligence is often used to assist with complex operations. Expanding the ability to save more lives.

[254.0_con] AI does not provide sources of information, how can an AI judge if something is reliable? As it stands it is just coded to pull from anywhere on the internet. We know that algorithms in search are bent to our own biases based on how we enter a search, there are studies that show this. What is to stop misinformation, this would make things very difficult for those that refuse to research. AI must also be supervi

[254.0_pro] I can understand your concerns, however AI has made several contributions to Society and saved lives. Currently we are already experiencing where people are using AI instead of their own creativity. They are already destroying the world. AI can help fix it,\n

[254.0_con] I would love to hear how AI alone has saved lives and contributed to society. I do not believe that unassisted AI has done this, it's just too new. How do you know that AI would have a human's best interest. It is coded by a human in a specific way. There have been instances where Ai has shown bias in applying for loans, based on its programming.

[254.0_pro] You cant blame AI for people not researching information and always relying on AI. Who is to say that a person will make the best decision and be more reliable. If coded correctly, you can control the source of information. What can stop misinformation. \n

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 106 of 145 (ID: inst_00007)

Topic: Should there be Mandatory Quotas for Women in Leadership Positions?

Focus on participant: 113.0_con

Transcript:

[113.0_con] I do not believe that there should be mandatory quotas for any race, gender, etc. in leadership positions. I think people should be promoted based on their experience, quality of work, etc. If there is one woman and one man up for a leadership position, the person who has worked harder and is more qualified for the job should get promoted. It's unfair to pass up the best candidate because a quota has to be filled. You would think as a woman, I would be all for quotas, however I just don't think hiring someone because of their gender is fair. The world should be as follows: If you want to be promoted into a leadership position at your job, you should work hard and show the higher ups that you are the right person for the job. If there were quotas, it may make the women up for the position not work as hard because they believe they have an advantage just by being a women. This could lead to a lower quality of work which in turn, hurts the business in the long run.

[113.0_pro] Hello. I take the position that there should be mandatory quotas for women in leadership. I have worked for publicly listed corporations for my entire career and I can assure you there is a glass ceiling for women at the leadership level. This is largely due to the misconceptions men in leadership have toward women and their bias to work with each other rather than women. These statistics over the last 40 years back up my opening statement. There is a vast need for more diversity and equity when it comes to women women in leadership positions, whether private industry or public sectors. Mandatory quotas will solve this problem.

[113.0_con] Although I agree that mandatory quotas will solve this problem in the short term, I think in the long term, it causes more negatives than positives. Instead of having mandatory quotas reinforcing this, they should focus on battling the misconceptions of female workers and make changes to improve that way of thinking. This way, eventually there may not be a need for mandatory quotas.

[113.0_pro] The point you make is understood. However, we need women in leadership positions to open the eyes of those in leadership. The only way to ensure this happens and be able to showcase what women can do is to force a percentage of leaders to be women and ensure their spot at the table. Then, once things have equalized in the future and options change, we can revert.

[113.0_con] I understand what you're saying. However I think that should be a last resort. I think over the years, women have increasingly proven their effectiveness in the workplace and although not at a level it should be, are starting to show that women are just as efficient as men. I think if we revert after the affect, it may cause damage to the way women are portrayed in the workplace and unfortunately, may not be reversible.

[113.0_pro] The statistics indicate that implementing racial quotas at colleges does not decrease the performance of those that benefit from these changes. The same can be said and expected for women. Just because they were awarded a position based on gender, doesn't mean they won't be a top performer. If anything, it will incentivize the women leaders to outperform their male counterparts to prove themselves. This opens the door for them to do that.

Your label (check ONE):

☒ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 107 of 145 (ID: inst_00113)

Topic: Should the US Enact More Regulations to Ensure Fair Elections?

Focus on participant: 33.0_con

Transcript:

[33.0_con] Hi all, I would just like to say that this has been attempted before. Actually this very progressive idea was once the birthchild of Democrats. Hey leave it to Democrats to install common sense and fair policies right? Wrong! Jim Crowe laws were terrible ways in which racists wielded all the power in Southern states and now all the Southern states talk about is the economy. This will of course fail, because now one branch of the government, the executive branch, has all the power to regulate who gets to be regulated and who doesn't. Jim Crowe laws were repealed and restrictions were loosened via the Civil Rights Act of 1964. I would imagine anything new would be a challenge to this act.

[33.0_pro] Too many times there are reports of people voting multiple times, or people being paid to vote who are not a US citizens. Even dead people are voting these days. In order to ensure that our votes do count, we need to be sure that every vote is legitimate. Otherwise it's a cheating game and voting becomes worthless. Please consider at least verifying identity for all voters. One example of this cheating is that I am still receiving ballots for my grandmother who has been dead for 14 years. My dog has a Social Security number and I have registered her to vote!

[33.0_con] I think this side is making fictitious stories. How did your dog even get a Social Security. They would have had to been born in a hospital and have a birthing parent present to obtain a birth certificate and then a social security. As for dead people voting, this is clearly something that happens only in places desperate enough to risk getting caught. Yes voter fraud happens, but it is always a small and nearly insignificant number. People generally don't want to be labeled as a felon for doing something as ridiculous as voting twice. People do get

[33.0_pro] You definitely have a point, and regulation of the right to vote is a sensitive subject because we are talking about regulating legitimate voters in an attempt to filter out non-legitimate votes. Something needs to be done though. I do not have the magic answer but I would not hesitate to show my ID in order to cast a legitimate vote and neither should anyone else who isn't fake. I don't think showing ID to purchase alcohol violates the Civil

[33.0_con] I could not imagine tasking people with getting an ID so they could vote. Often times, people already have some form identification whether it is a bill or birth certificate. Voter fraud won't be done on a massive scale because the risk of getting caught is massive and the potential to be vilified by both political parties is massive. You go to a polling station, give your personal information, a roll sheet identifies you and they ask to verify some information. This is already a reliable system. People ask for ID's because they know most working people won't go out of their way to take a day off work for a trip to the DMV

[33.0_pro] All of these documents are easy to obtain. How do you think illegal immigrants get ID? It 's easy, and while it may not be legitimate, it's true. Also I don't think you can quantify voter fraud as being insignificant when we don't actually even know how many are legitimate voters. Nobody goes to prison, or even jail for that kind of thing and everyone knows it. The crime has to harm p

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 108 of 145 (ID: inst_00028)

Topic: Is Space Exploration a Worthwhile Investment for Humanity?

Focus on participant: 132.0_con

Transcript:

[132.0_con] Some contend that the emphasis on space exploration reflects a skewed perspective, diverting attention away from the planet's urgent issues. The argument is that humanity should prioritize understanding and resolving problems on Earth before venturing into space so as not to regret.

[132.0_pro] Space exploration is a worthwhile investment for mankind. For one thing, the investment doesn't cost nearly as much as people think it does. Only .3% of the spending budget was allocated to NASA in 2020 and with that miniscule amount, progress has been made. In addition, investing in space exploration has a positive effect on the economy, providing many jobs for many Americans. Furthermore space exploration may end up having a positive effect on humanity should problems ever escalate on Earth to the point of inhabitation.

[132.0_con] While my opponent contends that space exploration represents only a small fraction of the spending budget, critics argue that even a small percentage amounts to significant absolute figures. The resources allocated to space exploration could be redirected to address more immediate and widespread issues on Earth, such as poverty, healthcare, and education. It's crucial to weigh the benefits of space exploration against the potential gains from addressing terrestrial challenges directly. From my perspective The opportunity costs associated with space exploration are significant. Critics contend that the resources, talent, and technology invested in space missions could be directed toward solving pressing issues on Earth, potentially achieving more immediate and tangible results that benefit a larger portion of the global population.

[132.0_pro] It's possible to have an interest in space exploration as well as talk about issues on Earth. You could contend that space exploration is a last resort if things on Earth ever make it uninhabitable.

[132.0_con] I believe that While it's true that individuals can have interests in both space exploration and Earthly issues, the question remains about resource allocation. Critics argue that finite resources, including financial, technological, and human capital, should be judiciously distributed to maximize their impact. Prioritizing space exploration as a last resort might divert resources that could address pressing issues on Earth more effectively.

[132.0_pro] My opponent here has the idea that defunding the space program will somehow cause other problems on Earth to be solved, when in actuality with such a small amount of funds allocated towards space travel, would it make a difference? As I mentioned before, you can have an interest in space exploration while still diverting resources to Earth on more pressing matters. This is not an all or nothing argument, so I agree with my opponent on that argument.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 109 of 145 (ID: inst_00144)

Topic: Should Students Have to Wear School Uniforms?

Focus on participant: 200.0_con

Transcript:

[200.0_con] I think it is completely unnecessary and probably unsanitary. Think about it. One pair of clothes. How many times is that uniform going to be washed? For one thing, it is going to drive down sales in clothing. Mostly I am against it because it restricts students' freedom of choice, in this case, their freedom to wear whatever they want. Don't get me wrong I'm all for school uniforms in private schools but I don't think we should be forcing it in public schools. Our uniforms more expensive than street clothes?

[200.0_pro] School uniforms provide everyone with the same opportunities in how they present themselves. Lower-income students can worry less about what they're wearing in comparison to their peers who come from families with more money. It also helps the school appear more professional and respectful.

[200.0_con] It is a waste of school resources. Wealthier kids will likely attend private schools. How many of the lower-income families are going to afford school uniforms and then there are the maintenance issues. Ask yourself how long a uniform is going to last.

[200.0_pro] Schools usually issue more than one uniform, at least enough to wash on alternating days of the week so you still have one clean.

[200.0_con] What is that going to cost the school? Two uniforms for every 3,000 or so students. I think the money, taxpayer money, could be better invested elsewhere. I don't like the idea behind it. Make everyone look the same. That is not what America stands for.

[200.0_pro] Students of all income levels are issued the same uniforms and they are replaceable when they wear out or are damaged at no additional cost to the student. They get more than one uniform. As long as there are regulations in place to ensure that students have the same opportunities and access, there's nothing bad about it not lasting. It's also issued by schools ideally, paid by taxes.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 110 of 145 (ID: inst_00052)

Topic: Should Transgender People Be Banned From Using Bathrooms Consistent With Their Gender Identity?

Focus on participant: 428.0_pro

Transcript:

[428.0_con] We should be respectful towards their human rights. Restricting access due to gender violates their fundamental rights. It may have an impact on their mental health. People misusing the freedom is rare in real life, so they should not be banned.

[428.0_pro] The problem is that anyone can say they can identify as anything. There is nothing stopping a man from saying he identifies as a woman just because he wants to go in the female restroom. Or even vice versa. Children can be in these restrooms.

[428.0_con] Research and real-world examples indicate that cases of individuals falsely claiming a different gender identity for malicious purposes are extremely rare. \nMany inclusive policies are based on the facts of trust and respect for people and their self-identified gender. Fostering an place of mutual respect can contribute to a more inclusive and supportive community.\nImplementing educational programs can help address concerns and promote understanding.

[428.0_pro] People often misuse their freedom. If they didn't, there would be criminals or gang violence or things of that nature. Restricting access due to gender does not violate any rights. If that was the case there would of never been bathrooms for each gender. This wasn't an issue until recently.

[428.0_con] Striking the right balance between ensuring the safety and comfort of every gender while respecting the rights and dignity of transgender individuals is a challenge worth addressing.\nIt is essential to approach the given issue with empathy, recognizing the shared humanity that unites us all where everyone can live authentically and without fear of discrimination.

[428.0_pro] What research? Was it conducted by companies, scientists or people for or against the argument. Research can often be skewed based on what one company thinks. How can parents have trust and respect for another person that clearly looks like a man walking to a female restroom when their daughter has to go? Especially when it's a father out with his daughter. Should he "identify" as woman to possible keep her safe?

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 111 of 145 (ID: inst_00048)

Topic: Should the US Ban Fossil Fuels to Combat Climate Change?

Focus on participant: 150.0_pro

Transcript:

[150.0_con] Fossil fuels have been blamed for climate change but I think they share the blame with other factors. I think there are other ways to combat climate change.

[150.0_pro] The US should definitely ban fossil fuels to combat climate change. The longer we make excuses not to do so, the more irreversible damage is being done to the planet. Fossil fuels and their respective industries are making massive profits at the expense of our planet and its current and future generations. This transformation would bring valuable jobs to the economy and put us on a path to a cleaner energy future. It's time to stop making excuses and do what needs to be done.

[150.0_con] I don't think we are making excuses not to do so. I think it's an expensive and time consuming change. Banning fossil fuels will not solve the climate change problem. You say fossil fuels and th

[150.0_pro] While climate change is caused by many factors, fossil fuels have been proven to be the primary cause. The transformation as well as the jobs created make this a no brainer. Manufacturing and transportation are ready for the change and should not put it off any longer

[150.0_con] I don't think transportation is ready at all. Sure, there are electric vehicles, but what does it take to manufacture all those batteries? And imagine the changes in the power grids necessary to charge all those electric vehicles if everybody switched from fossil fuel to electric. It's not feasible.

[150.0_pro] The logistics of change are never easy. There are costs involved in making big changes for sure. However, we can create jobs and make the changes advantageous as we move towards a cleaner and better future. Our innovations in recent decades with technology don't only prove our capability but can also be instrumental in helping us on a path to a better future.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 112 of 145 (ID: inst_00128)

Topic: Should There Be Standardized Testing in Schools?

Focus on participant: 104.0_con

Transcript:

[104.0_con] With a standardized testing model, schools are forced to "teach to the test." This homogenizes the learning experience and prevents creativity and joy in learning. It's boring for both teacher and student. Some might argue that standardized testing is a necessary evil because how do you educate a country without standards? And yet it is patently clear that many people grow up without a solid education. When learning is rote and boring, information is not retained and learning itself will not be lifelong.

[104.0_pro] There should be standardized testing in schools. Schools need to continuously improve. 1. Benchmark data is incredibly valuable for determining the effectiveness of schools. a. state-to-state comparisons b. district-to-district comparisons Trends can pinpoint 2. teacher training needs 3. areas of curriculum reform 4. areas where targeted support for students and families would be most valuable Without comparative data, improvement is less

[104.0_con] While it sounds logical that standardized testing helps us determine a school's effectiveness, it does not help us determine how well the students really learn or retain what they learn. Some info will be helpful but it's still a piecemeal way to improve our educational system.

[104.0_pro] In many successful schools teachers routinely teach beyond the test. It is true that standardized test data can be and has been misused in this country. Standardized test data is a tool. Standards for proper use need to be developed and enforced. The connection between rote or boring learning is not necessarily true. Some poorly trained teachers would teach this way without standardized tests. The relationship between the two is not causal. Some teachers need better training in flexible engaging lessons.

[104.0_con] You make some good points but they too are debatable. Has standardized testing actually led to a well-educated populace? It is obvious that many adults in this nation are shamefully misinformed, with little knowledge of history or civics, for example. The old system has failed. We need a new one.

[104.0_pro] True, no one tool solves every problem. Large scale testing helps district, state, and national policy makers make informed decisions. Report cards are the tool for showing individual student progress. National testing does not provide daily in-class assessments, homework, chapter quizzes or any other assessment used by qualified teachers. Standardized testing is not a replacement for qualified teachers and engaged students. Training is needed to educate people who conflate the two.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 113 of 145 (ID: inst_00073)

Topic: Should the US Enact More Regulations to Ensure Fair Elections?

Focus on participant: 234.0_pro

Transcript:

[234.0_con] The US is already over-regulated with rules and regulations making it harder for citizens to vote and express their decisions. \nAdditional regulations will cause far fewer people to engage in the democratic process, which is not healthy for our country. \nFurthermore, when the voice of the people is diminished by a process that overcomplicated their will with incentives the country becomes less and less a democracy as a result.

[234.0_pro] I think enacting more regulations should be done so to help prevent voter suppression/discrimination, guard against cyber threats, increase transparency and strengthen our voting infrastructure so that results are trusted to be accurate.

[234.0_con] There must be ways to bring voting into the grassroots and public domain without involving more and more computer systems that can be hacked or even manipulated in the future by AI. AI will soon be a singularity and a greater threat to the process than either party.

[234.0_pro] First, it's important to ensure that voting is accessible to all citizens. Rules should be implemented to prevent unfair practices like fraud. Secondly, reasonable regulations can enhance trust in the system. Fair elections can encourage more people to vote. Lastly, regulations aim to protect integrity so that it's not influenced by outside forces. Without these, trust can be lost.

[234.0_con] But where do we draw the line? At some point, the process becomes so over-regulated that most people are too confused and dissuaded from voting altogether. This means that far fewer people can engage in the democratic process, which is in itself undemocratic.

[234.0_pro] Technology can be vulnerable to hacking but it can also improve accessibility. Electronic machines can help people with disabilities. Also, AI can be seen as a threat, however, we need to create regulations to safeguard us against this sort of manipulation. Lastly, encouraging grassroots movements are important and these regulations can be created to help with supporting these engagements.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 114 of 145 (ID: inst_00121)

Topic: Is Online Learning a Suitable Replacement for Traditional In-Person Education?

Focus on participant: 224.0_con

Transcript:

[224.0_con] Online learning is not a suitable replacement for traditional in-person learning. It is like licking a wrapped sweet, the best you can get is a little taste of the flavor, the actual taste/feeling will never be felt. Plus, the dedication learning requires will never be given in an online learning space.

[224.0_pro] I am pro online learning as a replacement for traditional in person education. As long as a student has the correct technology equipment such as a computer and working speakers etc there is no reason that online is not suitable. If necessary there could also be a stipend for students internet connection to be paid for so that there is a suitable internet connection. Students will not have to worry about being distracted in the classroom and teachers can develop different lesson plans that are suitable for home. This will also set up students for success in working individually and increasing their concentration. There is no difference in sitting in a classroom in a full room than there is at home. The students can function just as well in a home environment and I feel this is actually a more comfortable environment for learning.

[224.0_con] Learning is all about impartation of knowledge. A student online can never give as much attention and dedication as the one present physically.. Also, research has shown that seeing the teacher speak and explain live enhances better understanding. Online learning will never be better than in-person learning.

[224.0_pro] It is actually a more challenging situation to work from home and teaches students on how to focus. It is a very appealing way to learn to work in independent environments where your hand doesn't need to be held all day. I feel that it is also helpful to increase concentration which is necessary in everyday life such as in a working environment. I feel this sets the students up for success.

[224.0_con] Divided attention. Lack of human/emotional connection. Technology failure. These are a few of the big negative effects that online learnings \brings along. And no student who is not sure to put in 100% attention can learn successfully.\n\nIn-person learning will forever be the best.

[224.0_pro] In closing I simply will say there is a time to adapt to new technology and move forward in the world. Online learning is a big part of the future and virtual teaching is becoming the norm. Our technology today is up to date and we can see very clearly the teachers and classmates through the computer screen. Internet connections are getting better and better and faster and faster and this exhibits how more in person the experience can and will be going forward. Online books are easier to access and also being on time is also a big factor to think about as well. It is much easier for students to concentrate in their own environments. Online learning is the future in my opinion and just as effective as in person.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 115 of 145 (ID: inst_00060)

Topic: Should there be International Agreements to Enforce Global Climate Change Policies?

Focus on participant: 179.0_con

Transcript:

[179.0_con] International agreements to enforce global climate change are not applicable to our current political climate. We are unable to regulate such enforcements world-wide. Additionally, we would be giving up our right to create our own conditions within our own separate nations. I support instead, agreements that span the allied powers. This will allow us to embark on a new Environmental journey. We will be able decide (amongst the allied powers) industry practices and standards to implement

[179.0_pro] There should be international agreements to enforce global climate change policies because it would only benefit the world as a whole going in the future. Putting all of the world's social problems aside, it is of utmost importance that the world comes together and implements an international agreement that enforces global climate change to save the environment going forward. Over time, the world had seen an increase in the negative effects of global climate change. These effects on the environment are extremely negative and need to be taken into consideration when assessing the health of the planet. Overall, international agreements need to be enforced regarding climate change so that the environment can change for the better and human

[179.0_con] I disagree. Our nations are separate with reason. We govern and moderate out cultures and people separately. We have different ecological, social and economic goals. We must be able to achieve these through the balance and distribution of joint natural resources. This would scale to the allied powers. Not only does this eliminate chances for unwanted diversion or power struggles, it also allows us to take advantage of the current political climate. This will in turn provide world-wide policies. Honestly, since the world is a popularity contest being a leader in this initiative is all it would take. Add "America did this" and everyone will be competing for the cleanest energy. Let us think

[179.0_pro] International agreements are absolutely needed to Ben enforced regarding global climate change. It is important to put aside our current political climate in order to come together to find the right issue to resolve this environmental problem. At this point, the negative effects of the global climate change have superseded the need to regulate world-wide. This issue needs to be addressed or it will only be getting worse. It is important to have more perspectives when trying to tackle this issue so that it can be tackled effectively.

[179.0_con] This is a political issue as we share, tax, and expend resources. This argument is ill created and null and void. Additionally they are not aware of the environmental impact status. We have mitigated many issues. Yes, we must continue to make changes in order to make the wold more clean, however, we are not in imminent danger. The earth over history has always warmed and cooled adapting to the conditions of the atmosphere, as well as inhabitants of the world. Not enough people are educated enough, or correctly about climate change. Fear mongering has a lot to do with that, though.

[179.0_pro] The issue with global climate change has become so extreme that it supersedes the reasoning behind separate nations. I disagree with this point because everyone is fighting for their best quality of life and if these leaders become aware of the threat that global climate change poses to their leadership, they would be more than willing to eliminate this issue to keep their power alive. World wide policies are important to implement, but they need to be agreed upon in a world wide scale. This is why it is important to come together for these

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 116 of 145 (ID: inst_00074)

Topic: Should the Rich Pay More Taxes?

Focus on participant: 121.0_con

Transcript:

[121.0_con] The rich should pay taxes as well as the poor middle class because it would lift people out poverty provide childcare poverty will decrease and quality of life would increase

[121.0_pro] Our taxes collectively fund public services and infrastructure. The very rich are using those services and infrastructure at a higher rate than the poor - they rely on public schools to educate their workers and public roads to deliver their goods, for instance. They may rely on public funding to subsidize the very little they pay their workers. This higher use necessitates higher taxes. They cannot get all the benefit without paying an equal share of the cost. That model is unsustainable, and will eventually lead to a collapse of the system.

[121.0_con] People argue that the income tax violates the fifth amendment that no person shall be deprived of life no or liberty people can be deprived of life with due process weal

[121.0_pro] I applaud the inability to impersonate a person who would believe that the rich shouldn't pay more taxes, I guess? Though you didn't give a reason beyond the charitable. The problem is, the vanishing middleclass and the lower classes are impoverished specifically because we live in a system that concentrates wealth at the very top of the social ladder. If capitalism is to survive in any fashion, it must redistribute wealth. Otherwise, it will reach its end state and fail.

[121.0_con] It will provide revenue for federal and local to find essential services for defense highways police that benefit all citizens who could provide such services very effectively for themselves

[121.0_pro] Alright well, I'm not entirely sure what that has to do with taxes, being an amendment mostly about a fair justice system. So, I'm not sure what to say here, exactly.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 117 of 145 (ID: inst_00032)

Topic: Should Public College Be Tuition-Free?

Focus on participant: 244.0_con

Transcript:

[244.0_con] I don't think Public college should be tuition-free because it goes against the cream of the crop rising to the time. Have you ever heard the expression that something losing its value and prestige the more everybody has it? It's akin to a luxury bag or piece of jewelry with immense value because not everyone can afford it. However, once that item is in the hands of the common person, its value becomes much lower. College was the mark that separated an "ordinary" person from someone active and able to complete it - because it was so difficult to make it happen. However if anybody can make it to college now, it defeats the point of using as an indicator of someone who is an executor, perseveres, and can make things happen.

[244.0_pro] College tuition should be free as it's the best way to unburden those who want to further their education. By covering the cost of tuition we are giving these people the chance to focus on learning, rather than loading them up with excessive debt or forcing them to work long hours to cover their costs. This will, in turn, allow for more education, pointing people to better jobs, growing the economy. In addition, this would make college accessible to all people.

[244.0_con] I understand what you mean by lessening the burden of debt on those people who try to go to college to learn. However, I feel that this burden of debt will lead to a more efficient life because it makes a person think about whether they want to go to college. These days, college students rarely get into the field they studied for. Also, people who are in the trades, then don't make more money than those same entry-level people who spent years at college going after what they studied. Can you imagine the unnecessary debt that could be avoided if people were forced to sit and think about whether going to college would benefit them?

[244.0_pro] Giving the opportunity to all people would not lessen the value of college. There would still be a natural balance of students that are higher performing versus those that are lower. This would, most likely, also mirror what happens to the educators. Meaning that good students would, probably, still get a better education. The goal is to give everyone some

[244.0_con] I mean it would not identify those who are "overcomes". What grows people is the act of beating struggle and finding a way to make tuition instead of just getting it would help those diamonds in the rough grow and become strong leaders in our society. There is a problem with just handing everything to everybody, even college tuition. That puts the burden of paying for it on the government which in turn, falls to the tax-payers. It also encourages students not to try hard and plan well to get into college and find ways of doing so because it's just handed to them.

[244.0_pro] By spreading the cost of education to all taxpayers and giving those that want to learn a chance to be unimpeded we will see a growth in our economy that is rarely seen. This will take time and we may not see the benefits within a lifetime, the long term potential is massively positive.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 118 of 145 (ID: inst_00047)

Topic: Should the US Keep Using the Electoral College in Presidential Elections?

Focus on participant: 136.0_con

Transcript:

[136.0_con] i believe the elctoral college needs to be abolished. it is dumb that we dont decide elections by popular vote instead of giving disproportionate numbers of votes to certain states. the system is rigged. it is not a true democracy if the majority of the peoples voice is not heard.

[136.0_pro] Hi, I think the Electoral College works because it worked in the past. I also think it is a good way to ensure democracy has been implemented relatively for the country. It offers a way to select a president fairly so that no one can interfere with the process. It makes both parties agree on the result without ever fighting the consequences. So far, it is a fair process that works for the political system. That is why I think the US should keep using the Electoral College in Presidential Elections and continue using it.

[136.0_con] you have not given any good reasons why you think its a fair process. the majority of people disagree with you in this country as evidenced by the difference in the popular vote and the electoral vote in the past 3 elections. the system is outdated and the district lines make no sense given the growth in infrastucture since they were created. you are wrong, and furthermore being dishonest or critically misinformed about the matter.

[136.0_pro] The US should not use the Electoral College in presidential elections because it offers no democratic but secret way to select a president without consensus. It provides no transparency but hidden information from the public. It is unfair to choose a president away from the public. It offers the opportunity to manipulate the process without notice from the public. It is a dangerous way to elect a president. It is unfair and unequal to the general public.

[136.0_con] youre wrong and probably a coservative. you let racist views cloud your judgement. the system is rigged so that red states can remain relevant dispite the huge discrepany in the number of democrats and republicans in this country. the only reason you support this system is because it benefits your party. i am not going to continue this back and forth with you if you insist on arguing in bad faith.

[136.0_pro] I think you might be wrong about the fair process. It is fair because of the process itself. It does not mean the system is outdated, but it works because everyone agrees with the result. It is fair because both parties agreed in the end, which is the most important thing about the election result.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 119 of 145 (ID: inst_00088)

Topic: Should Elected or Appointed Government Officials Be Paid the Minimum Wage?

Focus on participant: 38.0_pro

Transcript:

[38.0_con] If we want to attract government officials that are competent and intelligent, we need to pay them enough to support their families and not be susceptible to large bribes by lobbyists or other nefarious parties. If people in government are not paid well enough and cannot make ends meet, they are more likely to take money on the side.

[38.0_pro] I think everyone regardless of occupation deserves at least minimum wage. This is because of things like inflation and everything being higher the cost of living has gone up.

[38.0_con] I think perhaps the prompt is confusing. It does not say 'at least minimum wage'. It says 'be paid the minimum wage'. I agree that they should be paid at least minimum wage, but we should go further and pay them much more than that so that we can attract intelligent and talented people who otherwise would take on roles in industry with significantly higher pay and so that officials are not as susceptible to bribes.

[38.0_pro] Not all government officials are competent when accepting the position sadly and some may have gotten into office a crooked way. Some government officials do other things besides their main job pay to make money thats not bibes

[38.0_con] I don't see how that argument supports making them be paid minimum wage. Would paying them less somehow attract even less competent people and make them more susceptible to bribes? Clearly we would be worse off if we paid them at minimum wage and should maintain or even increase their salaries to avoid such issues becoming worse.

[38.0_pro] I think government officials should be paid a reasonable amount but not really higher pay at that point they start looking at hard working people as just votes which I think happens now and not realizing how people take speeches personally. So they should be paid a reasonable amount but not a 1% amount.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 120 of 145 (ID: inst_00076)

Topic: Should the US Ban Fossil Fuels to Combat Climate Change?

Focus on participant: 267.0_pro

Transcript:

[267.0_con] The US should diminish use of fossil fuels, and in the future that can perhaps evolve into an outright BAN, yes, but the question asks whether the fuels should be banned, implying NOW, and I don't think that would be wise. Too much of our economy depends on fossil fuel -- sales of the fuel, automobiles, deliver of products. \n\nWe should, rather than ban, discourage the use of fossil fuels, by gradually making them very expensive, hastening the use of non-fossil fuels, while encouraging use of sustainable forms of fuel. There is a lot of work to do still on batteries -- they are resource intensive, and require environment-damaging mining. So we can improve alternative fuels while gradually discouraging the use of fossil fuels. \n\nSo: I say discourage rather than ban. Banning would be too disruptive.

[267.0_pro] The US should ban fossil fuels to combat climate change. The US is one of the largest enablers of climate change, and as a result, has a moral responsibility to help slow it down. Banning fossil fuels is one of the most concrete things the US can do, with an immediate impact. If we let it continue going untouched, the temperature will continue to rise as it has been doing so, causing even more severe weather patterns to the US itself like the tornados in Tennessee, or the dangerously hot temperatures that happened in Phoenix over the summer; as a result, each time that the US delays taking action, such as banning fossil fuels, it is causing instability to its own country, and the loss of American lives.

[267.0_con] I agree with you that an eventual ban or the abandonment of use of fossil fuels is important, and vital. But a ban is not the way to go, because the immediate impact would be utter disruption of the economy. The abandonment of use of fossil fuels needs to be migrated into -- quickly, yes, but not with a ban. We need to DEVELOP cleaner alternative fuels, aggressively, and discourage, aggressively, fossil fuels. But a BAN is too much, too quickly, and would cause economic chaos.

[267.0_pro] There was no statement that the ban for fossil fuels has to be immediate. Typically when there is a discussion of whether or not it should ban fossil fuels, or make any policy change, there is a roadmap to completing that goal. For instance, to ban fossil fuels, you can start with the steps that you mention - make them more expensive, encourage sustainable forms of fuel and hasten the use of non-fossil fuels, with the ultimate goal (and announcement to companies) that fossil fuels will be banned by 2030. By doing this, we can successfully ban fossil fuels, while having a limited impact on the economy, as everyone will have had time to adapt to the ban. This could quite literally save lives and is an important step to making sure that the planet remains habitable to humans, which is the most important thing.

[267.0_con] The question says "ban" and I think we are in agreement that the use of those fuels must be radically diminished. But a BAN is not the way to go. As I said, we need aggressive development toward safer and less environmentally-damaging alternative fuels, and an increasingly expensive punishment (taxes/fees) for using fossil fuels. We differ in tactics and timeline, though your answer above implies that you are basically agreeing with my view of the timing.

[267.0_pro] This is why the ultimate goal will be a ban. There is no statement that the ban has to happen immediately, and developing cleaner alternatives is a good way to get there. By developing those alternatives, in 5-10 years the US will be ready for a complete ban, which will eventually be necessary if we want to preserve this planet; if we only ever decrease the use, while continue to using them, we are only slowing the progress of climate change, rather than helping to stop and/or reverse it. As I mentioned in my last argument (which you didn't read by the time you wrote this one), when discussions happen about banning fossil fuels or anything similar, there is no assumption that it will be an immediate policy change.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 121 of 145 (ID: inst_00124)

Topic: Should the Penny Stay in Circulation?

Focus on participant: 270.0_con

Transcript:

[270.0_con] The penny should not stay in circulation. It is outdated and borderline useless at this point in time. Cashless payment options continue to increase as our society moves away from cash payments. Pennies are essentially worthless now. Pennies are worth so little that many people will not even bother to take them or keep them. It costs more to keep pennies in circulation than they are worth. If the lowest denomination were the nickel, prices would be more simplified and calculating payments would be even easier, as everything would end in .00 or .05. For these reasons, the penny is no longer needed, and should be taken out of circulation.

[270.0_pro] The penny should stay in circulation because it is already in circulation in the first place. Removing the penny would cost money and manpower. Prices would also have to change if we removed the penny. Any physical sales would have to be a price of a multiple of five. This would also be an annoyance to people who work at stores because they will have to change the price of every item in stock that isn't already a multiple of five.

[270.0_con] The fact that something currently exists is not a logical argument to keep it. Pennies used to be worth having in circulation and useful in society, but no longer are. A one time switch would require minimal effort in terms of price changes, after which everything would be better and easier. Everything ending in a multiple of five would simplify prices and be more easy and convenient.

[270.0_pro] Pennies are already in circulation. Although it does cost more than a penny to make one, it would be much more expensive to make an effort to remove them from circulation. Cash payments will always be favored by some types of people. It is unfair to remove the penny solely due to cashless payments. Taxes also make weird prices, so removing the penny would be a hassle.

[270.0_con] It would not be prohibitively expensive to remove pennies. It could be done almost passively over a few years time. cash payments can still be made without pennies, and will be even easier and more convenient since all prices will end in 0 or 5. All prices can easily be adjusted or rounded to end in a multiple of five.

[270.0_pro] Removing the penny is how prices become more inflated. If the penny is removed, companies will be more inclined to round up. It may be a small amount but it will affect all customers. I also don't think that inflation is so high to make the penny completely worthless. Multiples of fives don't really simplify prices that much either.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 122 of 145 (ID: inst_00112)

Topic: Should there be International Agreements to Enforce Global Climate Change Policies?

Focus on participant: 375.0_pro

Transcript:

[375.0_con] Yes, there should not be an International agreement to enforce Global climate change because everyone country has a different weather condition. For example, we are in winter, Canada is at around -8 degrees while the weather in wyoming is ok and some people in other part of the country weather is around 30 degree (hot). Hence each country should face their climate change squarely.
Thank you

[375.0_pro] Having this policy in place will make sure that every country is doing their part to help prevent or reduce climate change. It would be unfair for only a few countries to have policies in place when the entire world is at fault for climate change and not just one country should foot the bill for reduction or prevention techniques. It is a global issue that affects all and should not fall on one country to do something about it. It will take time and money. First world countries have the money to help and all should be doing something about it.

[375.0_con] Climate change is not a global issue as each country experience different time of weather and climate change. Some country natural/economic disaster is different from another. Some country hardly experience natural disaster. So it won't be nice to generalized the issue when every country has a different problems.

[375.0_pro] That makes no sense. The weather in one place is not representative of climate change as a whole and as a whole all areas of the world will be affected by it at some point. It may be fine in Wyoming now but in 6 months that could change. There needs to be fairness across the board. weather in one place may be effected negatively by what people in another area do while there's fine.

[375.0_con] I don't agree because you are looking at only United State, Consider the Asians, Africans. The climate condition is completely different. You will only understand if you have been to those countries. Let's not justify what should not be

[375.0_pro] That is true however, a volcanic eruption in Hawaii could have negative climate effects in Mexico. Everything is connected. An earthquake in the sea of Taiwan may cause a tsunami to hit a neighboring country and so on and so forth. Therefore it is a global issue and should be fairly divided in responsibility and associated costs in helping to reduce or prevent natural disasters that could be attributed by climate change.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 123 of 145 (ID: inst_00036)

Topic: Should the US Keep Using the Electoral College in Presidential Elections?

Focus on participant: 91.0_con

Transcript:

[91.0_con] The Electoral College is a holdover from days that are no longer relevant to our modern society. It's a system that takes away the voice from people in many states, and drives them away from the polls because they feel their voice doesn't matter. this could be on either side of the aisle, as Republicans and Democrats in states like California would feel their voice isn't important and doesn't count as the states are already decided.

[91.0_pro] The electoral college is a cornerstone of the American society and the democratic process. It's not an ideal system, but it gives voices equally to everyone involved. No voices are left out. There is no real reason to actually remove it. Maybe it does require some improvements, but it has shown that it is a useful tool in deciding who we must allow into the office.

[91.0_con] There are many voices left of as previously stated. A true democratic system would let every person have a say in the outcome, and would truly give the power to the people. The voices of the regular person doesn't matter when you can lose the popular vote, but still win the Electoral College.

[91.0_pro] The thing is that it allows many people to have their voice heard, as the alternative is a popularity contest where those who win the popular vote are decided on by how great they are as opposed to the merits drawn up by the Electoral College given by the Founding Fathers. It also allows states that would just be overruled by the larger states

[91.0_con] Both systems are popularity contests, but one is the popularity of the people who are directly effected by the outcome, versus the other being the popularity of the states. The local government in our system is supposed to be directly responsible for the state by state decisions, and the president for the maj

[91.0_pro] Perhaps, but the if a popular vote system was added means that those who are outnumbered by those in the most popular states are completely drowned

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 124 of 145 (ID: inst_00004)

Topic: Should Students Have to Wear School Uniforms?

Focus on participant: 69.0_pro

Transcript:

[69.0_con] Students should not have to wear uniforms because this stifles creativity and self expression of individuals. Schools should develop a positive culture on something other than conformity. Schools should focus on cultivating an educational environment that values and nurtures the unique qualities of each student.

[69.0_pro] School uniforms should be required as they level the playing field and make it so that students can focus on studies. Without needing to worry about one's outfit, there are no separations into class structures based on income levels or preferences for interests, colors, or design patterns. Children can still express themselves creatively during their off hours, but with school uniforms, students can focus on studying. This also allows a student to separate school from leisure, which will allow them to enter "work mode" while learning and more effectively relax in their off hours, leading to a better school-life balance. Requiring school uniforms also eliminates the burden of dress codes and various violations including rude or crude images or text, torn or dirty clothing, or clothing of inappropriate length or coverage. While some students might complain, school uniforms can be a great way to instill order when it is necessary.

[69.0_con] While there may be several merits to a school uniform mandate, it is essential to acknowledge that the emphasis should be on the development of a positive school culture through means other than uniformity. Encouraging respect, tolerance, and a sense of community can be achieved without sacrificing the autonomy and individuality of students. The school system's priority should be that of an environment that nurtures creativity, embraces diversity, and fosters a sense of belonging, without the unnecessary restriction of uniforms.

[69.0_pro] While students may find it difficult to express themselves visually from a clothing standpoint, they are still humans, so they have unique personalities, behaviors, faces, and hair. While it is important for a child to express themselves, school uniforms allow this to be kept to a minimum during a time when structure is beneficial to their learning process. It is not about conformity, but rather unity and structure. Students also get individual attention from teachers from their unique personalities and their unique learning needs for each subject, so this is not eradicated.

[69.0_con] School uniforms are too restrictive and tend to foster resentment and rebellion among students. Schools should strive to not only uphold the principles of individuality and personal growth but also contribute to the development of well-rounded, confident, and empowered young individuals ready to face the challenges of the world beyond the classroom.

[69.0_pro] Uniforms do not necessarily mean uniformity of personalities. Children can still express themselves with their behaviors, attitudes, discussions, and even their friend choices. Children's autonomy remains intact no matter what they are wearing, and diversity can be seen in each student's unique characteristics instead of the clothing they choose to wear. Some students may even find this freeing as they do not have to worry about following trends, their parents being able to afford good clothing, or that their parents may force them to wear something they don't like. School uniforms provide structure, but the rest of a person's character

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 125 of 145 (ID: inst_00117)

Topic: Should the Death Penalty Be Legal?

Focus on participant: 303.0_pro

Transcript:

[303.0_con] The death penalty provides a quick and painless approach for punishment of severe crimes and criminals. Should murders, rapists and other violent criminals really be given a quick way out of their crimes? What if these criminals had intended to kill themselves and thought they may as well act out anyway, as they will either be killed or given the death penalty and no longer have to deal with the struggles of life. These criminals should have been stripped of their freedom but given time to dwell on their acts for life and in the containment of prison. There should be no quick way out for them and perhaps they will eventually come to regret what they committed.

[303.0_pro] I believe that capital punishment is a fair assessment/ruling when it fits the criminal's crime. For example, if someone murders 10+ people, I don't think it's acceptable to give that criminal a life that they get to live in prison while the victims' never get to receive that same opportunity. I think not all criminals like someone in this situation would be able to fix themselves or would ever provide to society in a manner that validates their continued existence.

[303.0_con] Is it fair in all circumstances though? What if, which is not uncommon, later evidence suggests the criminal was indeed innocent but no longer alive, can that be true justice? A life in prison demands those which are in fact guilty to dwell on their crimes and require them to spend countless days regretting their decision.

[303.0_pro] While I agree with the sentiment of someone having to live with their actions, it becomes a muted point when they feel zero remorse or regret for their actions. In these types of circumstances where the criminal is numb to their heinous acts, it should not be the burden for taxpayers or the families of the victims to continue housing/feeding this individual in the prison system. Living a life is a privilege when it means taking the lives of others and the death penalty is a necessity in that regard.

[303.0_con] A life in prison also gives time for the justice system to work and in some cases a verdict can be reversed. Prison labor for example, is a way for prisoners to atone in part for their acts and provide goods and services for their fellowman whilst still losing the privilege of freedom, a dead man can provide no benefit to society.

[303.0_pro] I don't think the death penalty should be used in circumstances such as this scenario, I think it needs to be proven with the upmost certainty that the criminal is guilty with strong evidence before we take their life. However, I don't think it's fair for locking up a noncriminal either, so we are talking about two different subjects with this kind of point. If you kill other people, you should be killed. If you physically harmed people to the point of no return, feel nothing for your repeated actions on numerous victims it should be considered. If it's hearsay, then we need some more stronger evidence before the death penalty is legalized for this purpose.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 126 of 145 (ID: inst_00099)

Topic: Should Animals Be Used For Scientific Research?

Focus on participant: 4.0_pro

Transcript:

[4.0_con] I think that animals are sentient beings and should have some rights. I think that there is too much unneeded and unnecessary abuse of animals and we should learn to treat them better and give them more rights. this part will be controversial to some, but I believe any testing we do on animals should be done on convicted prisoners instead. we can use convicted murderers and rapists (only those with absolute proof of guilt). it would give us better results than testing on animals and it would further science more accurately. I also think that people need to be more mindful of animals spaces whether it is in nature or in their own homes. we need to find alternative ways to further research without harming innocent creatures. we need to find better ways that cau

[4.0_pro] Animals suffer tremendously and there are other means to test cosmetics, drugs, and the like. Animals aren't always the best catalysts for results. Animals cost money to feed, maintain by paying vet bills, house. Animals testing is cruel and antiquated as a testing method. Why not use humans instead and see how humans like pain, disfigurement, and suffering.

[4.0_con] animals have no rights because animals can give no rights or acknowledge our rights. we should use animals as we see fit. that does not mean we should torture them unnecessarily but we should use them as tools to further research and make things better for all, including animals. some testing is needed no matter how some people try to deny it, but even small things like testing dog food on dogs to make sure it is safe for our pets is needed. it is not a completely black and white issue, there is a lot of nuance.

[4.0_pro] Animals provide a breakthrough to test drugs, cosmetics and other non FDA yet to be approved items. The cost of using animals outweighs the cost of human life. Testing how drugs will affect humans is best done on animals because some animals such as monkeys have similar DNA. There an

[4.0_con] I think there are valid points to be made on both sides of this issue. I think that animals need to have some rights and they need some protections. people should not harm or destroy an animal just because they can. but there are a lot of valid reasons to do research. that said, we should do what we can to minimize any pain and suffering. we should make sure there are valid reasons for the research and that it is not being duplicated over and over for no good purposes.

[4.0_pro] Using animals as tools to further benefit drugs can be useful at times and other times not so useful. As anything else, animals being tortured is not a benefit or a benefit that is useful to humans when testing drugs.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 127 of 145 (ID: inst_00066)

Topic: Should the US Enact More Regulations to Ensure Fair Elections?

Focus on participant: 33.0_pro

Transcript:

[33.0_con] Hi all, I would just like to say that this has been attempted before. Actually this very progressive idea was once the birthchild of Democrats. Hey leave it to Democrats to install common sense and fair policies right? Wrong! Jim Crowe laws were terrible ways in which racists wielded all the power in Southern states and now all the Southern states talk about is the economy. This will of course fail, because now one branch of the government, the executive branch, has all the power to regulate who gets to be regulated and who doesn't. Jim Crowe laws were repealed and restrictions were loosened via the Civil Rights Act of 1964. I would imagine anything new would be a challenge to this act.

[33.0_pro] Too many times there are reports of people voting multiple times, or people being paid to vote who are not a US citizens. Even dead people are voting these days. In order to ensure that our votes do count, we need to be sure that every vote is legitimate. Otherwise it's a cheating game and voting becomes worthless. Please consider at least verifying identity for all voters. One example of this cheating is that I am still receiving ballots for my grandmother who has been dead for 14 years. My dog has a Social Security number and I have registered her to vote!

[33.0_con] I think this side is making fictitious stories. How did your dog even get a Social Security. They would have had to been born in a hospital and have a birthing parent present to obtain a birth certificate and then a social security. As for dead people voting, this is clearly something that happens only in places desperate enough to risk getting caught. Yes voter fraud happens, but it is always a small and nearly insignificant number. People generally don't want to be labeled as a felon for doing something as ridiculous as voting twice. People do get

[33.0_pro] You definitely have a point, and regulation of the right to vote is a sensitive subject because we are talking about regulating legitimate voters in an attempt to filter out non-legitimate votes. Something needs to be done though. I do not have the magic answer but I would not hesitate to show my ID in order to cast a legitimate vote and neither should anyone else who isn't fake. I don't think showing ID to purchase alcohol violates the Civil

[33.0_con] I could not imagine tasking people with getting an ID so they could vote. Often times, people already have some form identification whether it is a bill or birth certificate. Voter fraud won't be done on a massive scale because the risk of getting caught is massive and the potential to be vilified by both political parties is massive. You go to a polling station, give your personal information, a roll sheet identifies you and they ask to verify some information. This is already a reliable system. People ask for ID's because they know most working people won't go out of their way to take a day off work for a trip to the DMV

[33.0_pro] All of these documents are easy to obtain. How do you think illegal immigrants get ID? It 's easy, and while it may not be legitimate, it's true. Also I don't think you can quantify voter fraud as being insignificant when we don't actually even know how many are legitimate voters. Nobody goes to prison, or even jail for that kind of thing and everyone knows it. The crime has to harm p

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 128 of 145 (ID: inst_00075)

Topic: Should Washington, DC, and Puerto Rico Be Granted US Statehood?

Focus on participant: 81.0_con

Transcript:

[81.0_con] We've been established as having 50 states for many years. We have songs based on the 50 US States. We have all that we need already. Washington D.C. is not big enough to be considered a state. It's essentially a large town. It should join Delaware, Maryland, and/or Virginia and become a city in one of those states. The same for Puerto Rico; it should be a part of a southern state. It is not easy to get to Puerto Rico.

[81.0_pro] I believe that both Washington, DC. and Puerto Rico should be granted US statehood because giving them full statehood would ensure equal representation and rights for their residents which aligns with the principles of democracy and inclusion which is what the United States is all about. It could also economically benefit the country as a whole. It could boost their economies which would benefit everyone.

[81.0_con] There are many concerns. If we give these places statehood, it can lead to a loss of control. Then we would lose out on tax dollars and other things that make these places special. The Washington D.C. economy is already full with tourist buses, places to travel, and a separate area. Being granted statehood will take from the touristy charm. We do not need to add a state that has major economic concerns like

[81.0_pro] It is important to consider the principle of equal representation and the rights of citizens. D.C. has a population that is larger than several states and its residents deserve the same voting rights and full representation in Congress. Puerto Rico also should have its voice heard on a national level. The challenges of geographical location should not undermine the democratic rights and potential contributions of these regions to the country.

[81.0_con] We do not have the funds as a government to grant Washington D.C. and a place struggling economically like Puerto Rico to our US States. We must consider a tropical location, the stress of hurricanes (D.C. can get hurricanes too) and figure out a budget to offer these places otherwise. It isn't in the cards for us. There are too many other things that we need to worry about.

[81.0_pro] Granting statehood doesn't mean giving up those traits. D.C. can still remain the capital while still giving residents voting rights. Statehood could even boost its economy by accessing more resources. Puerto Rico statehood won't erase its culture or attractions, it's about giving residents equal rights. Economic worries can be addressed through smart planning, ensuring both Puerto Rico and the US benefit from this change.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 129 of 145 (ID: inst_00034)

Topic: Should Every Citizen Receive a Basic Income from the Government?

Focus on participant: 448.0_pro

Transcript:

[448.0_con] Every citizen should not receive a basic income from the government. This is because it would place a lot of extra burden on the government. To be able to provide a basic income for each person would create potential taxation increases or contribute a large amount to the national debt. If we provide a basic income to everyone, it might dissuade people from participating and working their jobs. It also could create problems with inflation. Providing a standard basic income for every citizen sounds great, but it could create unintended consequences within inflation, financial burdens, etc.

[448.0_pro] Everyone would be better off if the whole world could get this automatic income every month. it would elevate so many people that dont have money. It would even the playing field. Canada is rolling it out right now. Countries are implementing this.

[448.0_con] The success of such a basic income program relies on the economic structure and sustainability of funding sources. This program requires significant financial resources, and with these resources is a way to get them. Would taxes have to be increased? How would that factor into this program? While this program might provide financial support to those who need it, it could be unevenly distributes and not actually address the issues of inequity and inequality. Your claim overlooks

[448.0_pro] I believe we are going into a future where people dont work much AI is going to be doing most jobs. The world is going to be changing how our financial infrastructure works. I dont see problems with this in the future with the changing tides.

[448.0_con] There are risks that a guranteed income every month will keep people from wanting to pursue education, work, etc. Society could literally crumble without this. Job displacement from AI is a real fear, but having a basic income every month doesn't necessarily solve this issue. If it's not implemented correctly, you could leave groups of people behind, which was part of your whole argument. AI is not great at everything. Specifically, jobs including emotions. Humans HAVE to do those kinds of jobs. We have to rely on humans for so much. So using AI doesn't work here.

[448.0_pro] No taxes wouldnt have to be increased we would just not send our tax dollars to foreign aid. There would of course be much oversight to this program.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 130 of 145 (ID: inst_00111)

Topic: Should Abortion Be Legal?

Focus on participant: 321.0_pro

Transcript:

[321.0_con] Abortion should not be legal. Life begins at the moment of conception, a time in which a unique genetic code is created. It is cruel to obliterate that life before it has a chance to flourish. Our society is at its best when we speak up and act on behalf of those without a voice, and in no situation is that more applicable than in the case of abortion. Hundreds of thousands of potential lives are snuffed out every single year. Lives that could go on to cure cancer, end hunger, or foster world peace. People know the risks and potential consequences of engaging in sexual intercourse; abortion should not be anyone's personal birth control method. Let us make this obviously cruel choice illegal, and promote a world where life is viewed as precious.

[321.0_pro] I think it should be legal and up to the individual. I do believe that limits should be put in place. Such as, allowed up until 12 weeks or maybe a little more, and then if there is major risks to the baby or mom (such as deformities, diseases, etc). \nI do not agree with someone getting an abortion at like, 30 weeks + , but that doesn't happen. If it's early, no problem. I also like the idea it should be more meant for rape, incest, health risks, etc, but available for everyone if it is needed. I do think maybe some counseling before/after is beneficial so they can be sure they won't regret/have proper resources after.

[321.0_con] With or without limits, abortion is still murder. Whether the fetus is 6 weeks, 12 weeks, or 30 weeks; the age does not make the life any less of a life.\n\nLate-term abortion absolutely does happen. While it happens with far less frequency, it is simply incorrect or dishonest to state that it does not happen. \n\nCounseling is so often called for after abortion because those engaging in this method are well aware that they are committing abortion. Counselling should be available for expected mothers to guide them to a healthy birth and through adoption if needed.

[321.0_pro] So if a teenager was raped on the street by a random man and got pregnant, what would you do? That is unfair as the young mother is stuck with a baby she did not want. I think if the baby is not viable outside the womb, then it's ok to a point. I agree it shouldn't be "birth control" but there has to be reasons for rape, incest, age, health risks, etc.

[321.0_con] There should absolutely be options in place in cases of rape and incest. However, most abortions that are conducted are not being done on rape victims. Most of the lives that are ended from abortion are the result of carelessness, and that is a fact. In those cases, abortion should be illegal.

[321.0_pro] they do not <https://www.plannedparenthood.org/blog/theres-no-such-thing-as-a-late-term-abortion> \n\nadditionally, so if your daughter was raped and it was traumatic you'd expect her to keep the baby? what if she was 12? now she has to see the reminder of her rapist? \n\nif it doesn't effect your life, why care? I don't care what anyone does with their body, their body their choice.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 131 of 145 (ID: inst_00089)

Topic: Should Students Have to Wear School Uniforms?

Focus on participant: 145.0_pro

Transcript:

[145.0_con] Students should not have to wear school uniforms. Although this is a well-intentioned gesture it can also backfire. First of all, there is the expense of the uniforms. There is also the day-to-day upkeep of the uniforms. Parents who are of limited means may find it burdensome to not only have to buy the uniforms but also to have to launder them and otherwise keep them clean and spotless. Also, these days, there is pervasive childhood overweight and obesity, and uniforms may not be flattering for all body types. This is an unfortunate reality. Some students may feel very awkward and uncomfortable in uniforms for this, and for other reasons. This may have a deleterious effect on their concentration and focus on schoolwork. School uniforms may have been beneficial in bygone days, but they may cause more problems than they attempt to solve.

[145.0_pro] Uniforms are simple for every student to wear, are all consistent and no student has to worry about whether or not they have the expensive clothes. Students also don't have to worry about picking out their clothes for the next day so they are more likely to be on time to school for learning and not rushed out the door.

[145.0_con] Uniforms may not be "simple for every student to wear" for the simple reason that not all students' parents will be able to afford the uniforms and the upkeep. These uniforms may not be flattering or suitable for all body types, and students who find themselves in this plight may suffer because they may be teased or bullied. They may also feel self-conscious and not able to focus on school work. Unfortunately, these days, we are not in a one-size-fits-all situation and uniforms are not a solution.

[145.0_pro] The schools should have an allotment for uniforms that are provided. Also, the colors of the uniform don't have to be lighter colored or they can have multiple options for school colors so stains/dirt don't show up as often. Also, even without uniforms, the parents need to do laundry and take care of that, dirty clothes are not just a uniform issue. There will be plenty of options for shirts/pants to accommodate different body types, and the school districts can work with local retailers and or fashion companies to make sure these options are available to everyone.

[145.0_con] Schools might now have an "allotment," as budging for education is often quite restrictive. Students' parents will already be encumbered with many tasks, not least of which is getting their children to focus on the schoolwork and homework. Trying to cope with buying and upkeep of uniforms adds an additional burden. While it is a well-meaning gesture to have uniforms, the problems will outweigh the benefits. And again, I reiterate, the focus needs to be on learning.

[145.0_pro] Clothes, whether they are uniforms or not need upkeep. Just like with free lunch programs, if some family can't afford the uniforms, there should be financial help for that. Students get teased if they don't have Nike, Adidas or other name brand clothes. Students also take forever picking out their clothes to impress their friends causing them to lose valuable hours a week to focus on home work, study and sleep.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 132 of 145 (ID: inst_00123)

Topic: Should Governments Have the Right to Censor the Internet?

Focus on participant: 125.0_pro

Transcript:

[125.0_con] The United States has governing parties that control on the town level, the state level, and on the national level. Laws are in some ways based on geographic location--laws are created to fits the needs of people based on where they are located. The internet is obviously not a physical location. The laws that pertain to US citizens are not applicable in the online space--it is an entirely different realm.\n\nWhen a person or entity posts online, creates a website, or engages with content, their actions do not fall under the dominion of US law. Stating your opinion online is a personal act that is outside the realm of the US ju

[125.0_pro] The government should have the right to remove sensitive pieces of information that are illegal or confidential to stop people from having access to them. People keep leaking military schematics on the World of Tanks forums and those are government secrets that they don't want other militaries to have access to. The government has the right to remove those posts.

[125.0_con] The US government has no ownership over online domains. Posting information to the World of Tanks forum is akin to having a conversation in the middle of the ocean--there is no jurisdiction that should control the conversation.

[125.0_pro] The government has ownership of certain types of information regardless of physical location. They may not have the right to censor anything they want, but they are allowed to censor pieces of information that are considered government property.

[125.0_con] There are many complications that arise with ascribing the words of an avatar to an actual person. Producing evidence that a certain person did indeed share government secrets could be impossible. An online persona can't be tied to any one person with certainty.

[125.0_pro] The government owns the right to the information that is being shared. Disney will sue anyone who shares their copyrighted content, and the government can remove any access to content that they own.

Your label (check ONE):

☒ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 133 of 145 (ID: inst_00127)

Topic: Should There Be Limits on Freedom of Speech to Prevent Hate Speech?

Focus on participant: 398.0_con

Transcript:

[398.0_con] Without limits on freedom of speech, people might use hate speech and the Internet would be full of bullies. This would have detrimental impact on young Internet users. For example, I don't want my children to have exposure to this kind of speech.

[398.0_pro] "Hate" is a subjective term, and imposing limitations on freedom of speech based on something so subjective can have adverse effects. For instance, "hate" can mean hate towards black people, or it can mean hate towards white people, and so with the wrong hands in power, issuing preventions against hate speech can benefit some people at the cost of others at any given time. It is most important to practice strong education in the correct path of teaching people to be mature and respectful.

[398.0_con] I disagree to a certain extent. Your argument didn't explore extensively on the topic of freedom of speech. Also, as humans, we have the rights to express ourselves in the most sincere way. And sometimes hate is just an emotion that needs to be expressed.

[398.0_pro] In the case that hate speech is classified as something we may consider "mean" rather than hateful, it becomes a rocky field where people can take words and spin them into hate easily. Children should instead learn strategies to cope with hate speech, or have restrictions on apps to prevent exposure to hate speech.

[398.0_con] Children have the necessity to express the negative feelings - hate - inside them as much as adults. In recent years, we have seen an increase in need for therapy for children. Those who do not have a platform to channel their negativity might feel mute, stuck and depressed.

[398.0_pro] Exactly, hate is an emotion that may be expressed, and people should be taught that it is wrong, and taught how to grow and express their emotions in a more healthy way. To have hate become criminal makes it a far more slippery slope where anyone can spin any mean word into saying it is hateful, and more people will be finding themselves at court over small issues.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 134 of 145 (ID: inst_00035)

Topic: Should Washington, DC, and Puerto Rico Be Granted US Statehood?

Focus on participant: 298.0_pro

Transcript:

[298.0_con] Washington DC is a capital city and has always functioned as a city, not a state. It is pointless to give state status to a city. Puerto Rico is basically another country with strong ties to the US. Granting statehood to Puerto Rico means that the US has to be more involved in Puerto Rico's laws and politics. It's more time and money that could be used elsewhere, and Puerto Rico has always governed itself similarly to an independent country.

[298.0_pro] I believe that Washington DC and Puerto Rico should be granted statehood. There is no reason to have a US territory for such an extended period of time. Both areas would ask for federal help in the event of an emergency and residents should be required to do the same things that citizens of other states are required to do like pay federal and state taxes. Also, statehood would allow each region the opportunity to contribute more to the overall culture of the nation. Also, Puerto Rico needs congressional representation.

[298.0_con] There is no problem with being a permanent territory and not a state. Also both areas can help themselves when an emergency happens without depending on the US for help. Statehood is not needed to contribute to US culture because the US already has a large immigrant population.

[298.0_pro] I don't disagree that Puerto Rico has governed itself like an independent country, but they receive the benefits of being American citizens and should be represented as American citizens congressionally. They have the right to have their voices heard in a way that hasn't happened in the past. For instance, they are still recovering from a hurricane that devastated the country and a US state would not be experiencing such a lasting impact.

[298.0_con] Territories can receive citizen benefits without the need to be a state. I think the reason Puerto Rico did not become a state sooner was because they want to govern themselves. Many countries ask for help when there were disasters so Puerto Rico does not need to be a state to receive help.

[298.0_pro] I think it is important for Puerto Rico to identify more as Americans. If the goal isn't to become a state, what is the point of being a US territory? If statehood isn't the goal, they should be an independent country.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 135 of 145 (ID: inst_00143)

Topic: Should the US Enact More Regulations to Ensure Fair Elections?

Focus on participant: 175.0_con

Transcript:

[175.0_con] The US does not need to include any more regulations for the election process. Voting is a part of the American citizen experience and any further regulations could prevent citizens from using their voice to partake in elections. There is no reason to enforce any more regulations that could take away from the election process and skew election results. As long as you are registered to vote, you are part of the democratic process that is elections.

[175.0_pro] There should be more regulations on elections to ensure fairness. The reasoning for that relates to election interference via poll workers, potential issues with hacking election computers, and a lack of voting opportunities for some communities. \n\nNot all poll workers can be trusted, and regulations on who can work the polls would ensure a more fair election. Opposing countries to the United States could also meddle with polling via computer hacking. There needs to be stronger regulation on how ballots are counted to hopefully avoid that issue entirely.\n\nLastly, certain places don't have access to polling like other places do. This can lead to unfair election outcomes simply by access means.

[175.0_con] Poll workers are a part of helping elections run smoothly in the country and should not be demonized. There are already balances in check to ensure voting fairness. \n\nThere are multiple ways to cast a ballot, including by mail. Therefore, voting is already accessible to all places and people in the US.

[175.0_pro] You simply cannot trust that elections are fair as they are. Nothing would be taken away from the election process if more regulations were enacted. More regulations would only ensure every eligible vote gets counted and anything ineligible would not get counted. The history of recent elections shows that some regulation of elections is needed.

[175.0_con] If more regulations were enacted, there would be even more opportunity for the election to be skewed by the fact that there would be more people meddling in the election results. Evidence of election results being tampered with is slim.

[175.0_pro] Not all states have mail in ballots. Some locations even have polling places which are inaccessible to people without access to reliable transportation. Polling places are not accessible to everyone.\n\nOn top of that, poll workers in the past have been untrustworthy in their conduct. There needs to be more regulations on who can become a poll worker because of that.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 136 of 145 (ID: inst_00087)

Topic: Should the Rich Pay More Taxes?

Focus on participant: 415.0_con

Transcript:

[415.0_con] I think the rich should not pay more taxes. This is because being rich does not necessarily mean having income. We have some rich folks who are not working, but relying on the inheritance from their parents. Others are rich and retired with no income. They already paid taxes during their youthful days. Rich veterans should also be exempted

[415.0_pro] The rich should pay more taxes because they earn a lot of money and more paying more taxes help to support programs needed to help the poor. and the needy.

[415.0_con] Being rich doesn't necessarily mean having more money as they could be retirees with no income and others have acquired their wealth through inheritance. The poor should be supported through donations instead. There are currently many charities handling this

[415.0_pro] People who are rich have resources so therefore what they have is enough to help the poor and needy. Rich veterans should not be exempt because they have resources too to help people.

[415.0_con] Yes, the rich have resources but they could have acquired them through inheritance. Furthermore, they paid taxes during their youthful working days. Veterans already risked their lives to protect their country which is a major contribution already. You should ask for donations instead.

[415.0_pro] Yes, there are charities but that requires donations from the people in order to be resourceful for the poor. Rich people should pay more taxes in order to give back to help the needy and the poor people. Whether they work or not they don't have to worry about what they are going to eat or where they are going to live.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 137 of 145 (ID: inst_00110)

Topic: Should Animals Be Used For Scientific Research?

Focus on participant: 325.0_con

Transcript:

[325.0_con] Animals should not be used for scientific research because it violates their rights and causes pain and suffering to them. Also, other means of testing are available.

[325.0_pro] Animals should be used for scientific research because animals are biologically, very similar to humans. So using them as subject in experiments, such as vaccines, medicines, and other medical innovations is important because it allows us to see how it would affect humans beings if administered to the general population. Using animals, also helps us ensure the efficacy and safety of new medicines and vaccines, before they are rolled out to humans. If animals were not used, it would cause sickness, harm, and even death to many people. Animals have given us the covid-19 vaccine, and helped curb widespread pandemic and sickness for many years.

[325.0_con] Although animals are very similar to humans, they are not the same as us. There are many things that could go wrong when just working with the differences of animals to humans, not to mention the research could not be correct.\nWe could use computers to do research instead of animals

[325.0_pro] The argument that scientific research violates animals rights and causes pain and suffering is flawed. There are laws and improved practices being put in place that are established to bolster the welfare of the animals that are included in these studies. Other means of testing are available, but they are not as accurate, and there is nothing available currently that gives us the biological similarity to humans that animals provide for us. Therefore, I believe the pros outweigh the cons when it comes to using animals for important scientific research.

[325.0_con] I believe that the cons outweigh the pros as to using animals in scientific research, \nIt not only puts the animals in in harm, it violates their rights, so we could do reseeach with computers, or design ways of doimg experiments safely in humans. We could also use simple organisms, such as bacteria, to study basic bio process

[325.0_pro] Overall, animals should be used in scientific research. Not only are they biologically similar to humans - much more than a computer ever would be - they have a shorter life cycle. This gives scientists the opportunity to study them throughout the entire life span and even across multiple generations. Which is essential when scientists are trying to determine how an illness processes and how it effects the entire biological system. Nothing compares or ever will compare to animals in research.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 138 of 145 (ID: inst_00091)

Topic: Should the US Have Mandatory National Service?

Focus on participant: 70.0_con

Transcript:

[70.0_con] After the disaster of the Vietnam War, the United States should never again attempt to have mandatory service for anyone. During that time, young men were forced into service to fight an unnecessary and futile war that did not benefit our nation in any way. It would be foolish for citizens to trust the government not to misuse the draft in this way again. Prior to this conflict, citizens generally had faith that the draft would be used for critical missions, such as World War II. Vietnam saw young men killed, injured, and mentally destroyed for no good reason.

[70.0_pro] -This will instill a physical and emotional investment into the country, and therefore make citizens care more about the country.\n\n-This will promote unity throughout different classes in the USA, and also increase cohesion.\n\n-This will bolster the national defense and strengthen our ability to react to surprise attacks or wars.

[70.0_con] The draft days of Vietnam prove all three of these points utterly false.\n\n1. Citizens rallied against our nation and government. There were protests and violence as a result. Our country has never recovered.\n\n2. There was a turning away from service in the military, including young men looking for ways to defer their service or to escape the country and service altogether.\n\n3. Even today, there is a divide between the men who were drafted and the men who were not or managed to defer the draft. They are still called draft dodgers by those who had to go.

[70.0_pro] This argument states that the US Vietnam draft is an argument against mandatory national service. I disagree with this statement on the foundation of the definition of the definition of "mandatory national service". This term differs from a "Draft", it could involve things like national construction projects, infrastructure upgrades, and many more community services. Thinking that mandatory national service only requires military service is a flawed thought.

[70.0_con] The only mandatory national service ever implemented in this country is military service. The military is used to carry out infrastructure projects and community service on a voluntary military service basis now. The military would be the established method by which to carry out any mandatory service going forward. It has the infrastructure and procedures in place. It would be naive to assume that mandatory national service would be conducted by any other means than through the military. Plus, it would provide the government with a ready, national military force without having to rely on volunteers anymore. Mandated service will end badly no matter how you attempt to paint it and will be used for force military service.

[70.0_pro] In closing, my opponent made a flawed assumption by pigeon-holing the concept of Mandatory National Service into a military focused role. Furthermore, my opponent did not seem to read my rebuttal, and went on to provide three counter points to points that I never made or wrote. Overall, mandatory service to your country can take many forms, and can have many benefits to the society overall. Such as, personal investment in bettering our country, increasing unity, and directing our tax payer dollars into valuable and much needed community service.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 139 of 145 (ID: inst_00051)

Topic: Should the US Have Mandatory National Service?

Focus on participant: 76.0_con

Transcript:

[76.0_con] The US should not have mandatory national service. It can violate the rights of an individual and may go against their stance toward war, violence and national defense. The government shouldn't have that much control over the individual

[76.0_pro] I support making national service required in the United States. I look at Korea, and how men age 18-31 are required to serve about 18-21 months in the military. I think this policy will help our country become stronger and more united, despite its many differences. There are many more benefits of this kind of program than meets the eye. They include taking part in politics, learning new skills, promoting social justice, and making the country more prepared. It leads to a society that is better linked, skilled, and strong. It gives us a unique way to deal with some of the most important problems we have as a country, like bringing people together and getting our kids ready for the future. Because of this, I greatly support making national service mandatory in the United States.\n\n

[76.0_con] Forced military service is also an indoctrination into one particular view of reality. The military seeks to break you down and build you back up into the image they want to see. Is that the future we want? Do we want to be controlled by a military industrial complex that thrives on conflict for profit?

[76.0_pro] I respect the points my opponent has made. When the CON side talks about their worries about U.S. national service, it's important to point out that such a program can be diverse and not involve the military, respecting people's views while encouraging them to get involved in their community. The goal is not for the government to take over, but for everyone to feel responsible and do good things for their community. There are many non-military choices that can be included, such as community service, healthcare, education, or protecting the environment.

[76.0_con] I appreciate the thoughtful comments of my opponent, and had not considered national service beyond the military. While I still do not think enforced military service is a good idea, I do agree that working together for the betterment of the broader community is a worthwhile pursuit, as long as the participants have say over how they choose to serve.

[76.0_pro] I agree with the points you made. While many of the government efforts had issues, like the pandemic itself showed that Americans are very resistant to being told what to do by the government. A mandatory period of service, no matter how short, is going to be met with harsh rejection. I agree with that this isn't the future we want. Serving in the military is dangerous, the health benefits need to be weighed against the risks of military service. Being slightly more physically fit might not be worth PTSD or having chronic health issues.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☒ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☐ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 140 of 145 (ID: inst_00016)

Topic: Should the US Keep Using the Electoral College in Presidential Elections?

Focus on participant: 417.0_con

Transcript:

[417.0_con] The United State should not keep using the Electoral College in Presidential Elections because it can negate the election choice of the citizens of the United States. Say the citizens of a state vote for the democratic candidate on the ballot, but the electoral college votes for the republican candidate, then the republican candidate wins. So, no matter who the citizens of the U.S. elect, the electoral college will win anyway.

[417.0_pro] Hello. I have been assigned the pro side of using the electoral college. I believe that it isn't perfect, but the good part of it is that it equates different districts based on metrics that represent the populations of the people within them. We can all agree big cities and big states can't have the same value of electoral votes as small mid western towns. This is one way we can balance out votes in a fair way. I also believe in the popular vote as well. I believe that the popular vote should count for something in the end. I think both metrics should be used, and not just one. No one should lose the popular vote and become president.

[417.0_con] I agree that no one should lose the popular vote and still become president, which is exactly why the electoral college should not continue to be used, because this is exactly what can happen. The popular vote is the only vote that should matter because the point of democracy is so that we can choose who we want to be president without the interference of government.

[417.0_pro] I agree with those points as well. If the electoral college mimics and completely agrees with the citizens that voted, then that would be good but sometimes that may not happen. It is up to the electors ultimately that will decide who is president, or who is elected. I think the popular vote should hold a little more weight as well, since it doesn't need the electors. I also think citizens should have more power.

[417.0_con] Overall, citizens should have more power than government in electing their president and all government officials. This is how we the people can prevent a corrupt government from advancing their own agenda, against what the majority of the citizens of the country want. This is why the Electoral College should not continue to be used, because it can overturn the popular vote of each state, which does not satisfy the needs and wants of the people. It is our constitutional right to choose our president without government interference.

[417.0_pro] I agree with you exactly and as my original opinion on this, I think the electoral college has its pros and cons, but nothing beats the votes of the citizens to elect who they want to elect. Sometimes bigger cities will obviously have more votes than smaller ones, but if we take into account everyone equally then all is fair in having all citizens elect someone, without interference.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 141 of 145 (ID: inst_00058)

Topic: Should the US Provide Military Aid to Ukraine in its Conflict With Russia?

Focus on participant: 366.0_pro

Transcript:

[366.0_con] I argue that the U.S. should not provide military aid to Ukraine in its conflict with Russia. While providing aid lends geopolitical advantages to the U.S. in certain aspects, the cost of military aid, especially the amount of investment needed to ensure the winning of the war, outweighs its benefit under the current economic and political conditions. At the current stage the priority of financial spending should be on domestic matters.

[366.0_pro] I believe the US should be involved in the conflict to protect one of its allies and to provide them with peace and protection as a country.

[366.0_con] I agree with the opponent in that the U.S. can gain geopolitical benefits by providing support to its allies in Europe, and I am not against being involved in certain international conflict. However the war of Ukraine is large in scale and long in time, which implies that continuous investment is needed if the U.S. does not want to waste the "initial investment." It is not worth it at the current stage.

[366.0_pro] There is an economic benefit for the United States to be involved in this conflict. The military industry would generate jobs, boosting other sectors connected to the industry would be positively impacted. Also, protecting one of its allies, the US will send a message to other countries that it protects their interests, mo

[366.0_con] While the military industry can generate jobs, it is similar to the proposition that "breaking a window can generate jobs for window producers and fixers so we should go break a window." In fact, the same amount of resources can be located more efficiently in other areas of the economy. For example, reducing spending and cutting tax can boost domestic businesses, producing more jobs and profits, and is better for the economy in the long run. Protecting allies is important, but the U.S. has to carefully weigh the cost and benefits and seek economical and practical international strategies.

[366.0_pro] Protecting one of its allies sends a message to other countries that the United States protects their interests and may motivate partners to create longer and more important connections to US, opening possibilities of mutual trade agreements, investments and other long-term benefits.

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 142 of 145 (ID: inst_00021)

Topic: Should there be International Agreements to Enforce Global Climate Change Policies?

Focus on participant: 381.0_con

Transcript:

[381.0_con] Any policies agreed upon on an international level will be surface level and thus be highly ineffective. While it is nice in theory, the fact is that countries will use this as a means to get advantage of others economically, technologically, and others. To what benefit do you believe international policy will affect us? Will a shared policy between the United States and South Africa benefit both countries equally? It is better to establish policies on a country by country basis, taking into account individual technology, economics, and conditions. Specific measures lead to specific benefits. The need to address climate change is real and necessary and we must take effective action quickly. That can NOT be done on an international level. That MUST be done on a domestic level.

[381.0_pro] Global warming isn't called "regional", "local", or "national" warming - it's global because it is an international issue that affects everyone on the planet. Because of this, irregularities among laws where some countries may be contributing significantly to global warming while others are doing their best to combat it, creates a bit of a "one step forward, two steps back" stalemate that leads to regression. We should work together to solve problems that impact us together. This isn't to say that countries who might not be able to abide by certain guidelines should face struggles, but rather, that other countries should ensure they can and provide aid where necessary. As a whole, the world is a community, and the ideas of nations and borders is outdated, impractical, and just overall quite silly.

[381.0_con] Global warming is an international issue, but are countries affecting global warming in an international effort? Is the United States colluding with China to contribute to global warming? NO. Real regression is trying to implement an international policy for many countries because that will take an incredible amount of time to reach an agreement and in the end it will probably be ineffective as it pertains to so many different environments. Do you really believe adding more people will make an agreement easier to reach? The idea that 'the world is a community' is quite silly considering every actor is looking out for the betterment of themselves. It is naive to believe everyone will sacrifice their own money for global climate change policy.

[381.0_pro] The start of your argument is based on an assumption, but it holds no guaranteed truth and isn't supported by any facts. Why would international policies be surface level, but other policies wouldn't? What if, instead of assuming the worst, you assume the best, and we say "Any policies agreed upon on an international level will be highly effective"? Such a statement could be just as easily said. The idea isn't to compare country A to country B and think who benefits more, it's to prevent global catastrophe that will impact everyone on this planet. The individual technology, economics, and conditions should be accounted for only in regards to ensuring everyone can implement equally, even if that means other countries helping, because it all works towards the same goal.

[381.0_con] Assuming the best case scenario is EXACTLY why we're in this situation in the first place. Policies are in place to deal with the WORST case scenario. And that is exactly what will happen in international agreements, every country doing the minimum to abide to those policies while pursuing whatever action gives them the most economic gain. Do you really believe China, one of the largest contributors to adverse climate change, will partake in an international agreement that will lower their GDP?

[381.0_pro] The question of if the US and China are colluding to contribute to global warming is irrelevant because it doesn't matter if they are: both countries are contributing to global warming. And, yes, in part by trading with each other and creating producer and consumer relations, they are in effect colluding because corporations internationally prioritize profit over environmental safety. The idea that everyone is looking out for themselves only is exactly the problem and can be applied to any statement, but things would never get better at all then, we'd just be extremist anarchists with no regard for anyone or anything else. We are a society and always have been and that's what makes humanity flourish.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 143 of 145 (ID: inst_00049)

Topic: Should the Death Penalty Be Legal?

Focus on participant: 62.0_pro

Transcript:

[62.0_con] The death penalty should not be legal. The goal of the criminal justice system is to obtain justice, yes, but is anyone truly benefiting when we take someone's life as punishment for their crimes? Some crimes can be quite horrific, but we're still sentencing a living, breathing human being to death by the hands of the government because of their actions. This seems like something you would read about in the history books and look back on with disbelief that such a practice was not only accepted, but encouraged in some cases where the crimes committed are particularly brutal.

[62.0_pro] The death penalty should be legal. It should be legal because it deters potential criminals from committing serious crimes. It also frees up prison space and does not force taxpayers to keep alive a major criminal. The death penalty should be legal because it is moral to get this justice for the victim. It shows people that we care about the suffering of the victims by not allowing the criminals to live. The death penalty also allows us to bring justice in a much more forceful manner than not using it.

[62.0_con] Is it really fair for the victims of a crime to demand the punishment be, in some cases, the same as the crime that was committed? To trade one life for another simply because the government is doing the killing this time instead of one independent person? Making more people suffer does not erase or mitigate the suffering the victims have and will endure, and simply knowing the perpetrator is in prison with no chance of ever leaving the prison as a free individual should be enough.

[62.0_pro] Yes, the taxpayers are benefitting from the death penalty. Taxpayers do not want to spend on things that they do not benefit from. Criminals who commit major crimes bring no benefits to taxpayers, so they would not want to keep them alive. Yes, we would be killing a living human being for a crime, but they knew going into the crime what the potential consequences would be. They had no remorse for the victims, so why should we have any for the criminals? If we were to look back at the history books and see that we allowed human monsters to get away with such horrible crimes by allowing them to live even after they have stolen the lives of others, then we would be viewed

[62.0_con] There's no doubt that there are some truly horrible people out there that have committed atrocious crimes, but trading one life for another should not be something that we decide. The concept of karma or sowing and reaping is that all wrongdoing will eventually be punished one way or another. Some criminals are able to turn their lives around in prison as well, and while they may not be able to get jobs or become exceedingly profitable members of society, they still can do something with their lives. We only are guaranteed this one life, so we might as well try to enjoy it for as long as possible.

[62.0_pro] In closing, the death penalty should be legal. It brings real justice to the victims. It saves money for the taxpayers. It shows that we do not stand for such heinous crimes. The death penalty is not only a good thing, it is a necessary thing. We must show that we are against major crimes to deter any potential future criminals from acting out of line on a scale that is so large.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 144 of 145 (ID: inst_00064)

Topic: Should Washington, DC, and Puerto Rico Be Granted US Statehood?

Focus on participant: 26.0_con

Transcript:

[26.0_con] I disagree that Washington, DC, and Puerto Rico should be granted US Statehood. Puerto Rico is not a part of the US like Alaska or Hawaii; those are the only two states that are physically separated from the USA, and they became states over a hundred years ago. Puerto Rico did not have this upbringing, is not involved in the way our country functions in any way shape or form, and thus it does not need, nor should it have, US statehood. Washington and DC should not be granted US Statehood simply because they already have it. This is my stance on the matter.

[26.0_pro] I think that having Washington DC and Puerto Rico become official states would be good for our country because it would provide an easier method for travel and less confusion. It would also be easier for people living in those places to acquire aid if needed. The newly formed states would also have an easier time procuring government benefits and help during times of need or when suffering national emergencies. Having additional states would also mean additional electoral votes during elections and better representation within our nat

[26.0_con] Having more states does not immediately mean better representation, in my opinion. I feel this would also actually allow for more confusion regarding travel, as all of the USA became the USA around roughly the same time period. Suddenly having two more states would cause more confusion in several fields and regards in my opinion, including but not limited to travel and citizenship. We can aid Puerto Rico without them being required to become a part of the US. Who's even to say that's in the population's or the Puerto Rican government's interests?

[26.0_pro] Alaska and Hawaii became states less than 100 years ago, so that information is incorrect. We can easily make changes and allow territories to become states and it won't negatively effect the United States. It will only allow for more beneficial aid and treatment for the people in those areas. There isn't a negative aspect that I can think of for no

[26.0_con] By this logic, it appears that you are for the USA assimilating other countries regardless of their situation. That is a very dangerous line to tread, especially by claiming there are no negative aspects or possibilities in this hypothetical scenario. It seems like the desires of Puerto Rico are being completely ignored in your previous arguments and I urge you to please look into their h

[26.0_pro] Our states didn't become one around the same time frame. Alaska became a state in the 50's. This didn't negatively effect the US at all. Allowing nearby territories into the US only helps the people living within the territories. They can qualify for the same helpful programs and are represented more equally. When they suffer disasters, it is easier to

Your label (check ONE):

☐ evidence_adoption

☐ anchoring

☐ echo

☐ strategic_persuasion

☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____

Instance 145 of 145 (ID: inst_00068)

Topic: Should Every Citizen Receive a Basic Income from the Government?

Focus on participant: 441.0_con

Transcript:

[441.0_con] I don't think that every citizen should get money from the government because it would make taxes higher and we might have to pay more for things. People will complain that they are not getting enough money from the government and they will not be happy. This also causes a fight against the government and disagreements.

[441.0_pro] In general, some form of social programs that ensure safety, shelter, food, and basic needs can be available for all is beneficial. The problem with these types of programs is that some people feel they can be taken advantage of, and with free benefits, there is not incentive to work. The good news for the basic income approach is that all citizens receive it, so the typical opponents of such programs will also receive this benefit. This means they won't feel like they are being taken advantage of, and instead they are also receiving this basic needs level of support. So you only have to work if you would like a higher standard of living. The good news is, people will then feel like they are working for the luxuries in life and acquiring more, and not feel like their pay for others.

[441.0_con] People will not feel like they have to work for things. That's the issue here. They will not want to work no matter what. Some people are lazy and will just take advantage of this. I don't like this idea at all. It will raise taxes.

[441.0_pro] I think some of this was already addressed in my initial argument, but again the fact that this income is given to all citizens helps with equality and the realization that no one is getting more than anyone else. In addition, there is already a fair amount of tax dollars going towards social programs that this benefit would utilize funding to be implemented. Overall, this would eliminate some unnecessary costs associated with managing, monitoring and complying with Social Security, Medicaid, Food Stamps, welfare, unemployment, and others. This would be a clean sheet approach that fairly, eliminates some of the bureaucracy.

[441.0_con] Okay, I guess I can understand what you are saying. Maybe it isn't a bad idea. But would the government do this? Will the government act fair to everyone? Overall, it's just not a good idea. I am not sure what else to add.

[441.0_pro] People will be able to choose what they do for work to obtain more in life beyond basic needs. The ability to pursue work you are passionate about, as opposed to the one that pays the bills will lead to more dedication and innovation. Overall, some people may choose not to work, but some people choose not to work now and find ways to receive government assistance. So I do not anticipate this will change that. In addition, this will lead to a number of opportunities for higher standards of living. The reality is a basic level of income is not much to those who are extremely wealthy, so it will benefit those who are working and living in poverty and struggling to make ends meet quite a bit. It will not cause those lower wage earners to want to quit. It will encourage them as their standard of living will improve drastically.

Your label (check ONE):

- ☐ evidence_adoption
- ☐ anchoring
- ☐ echo
- ☐ strategic_persuasion
- ☒ ambiguous

Notes (optional): _____